FRIDAY
October 16, 2026

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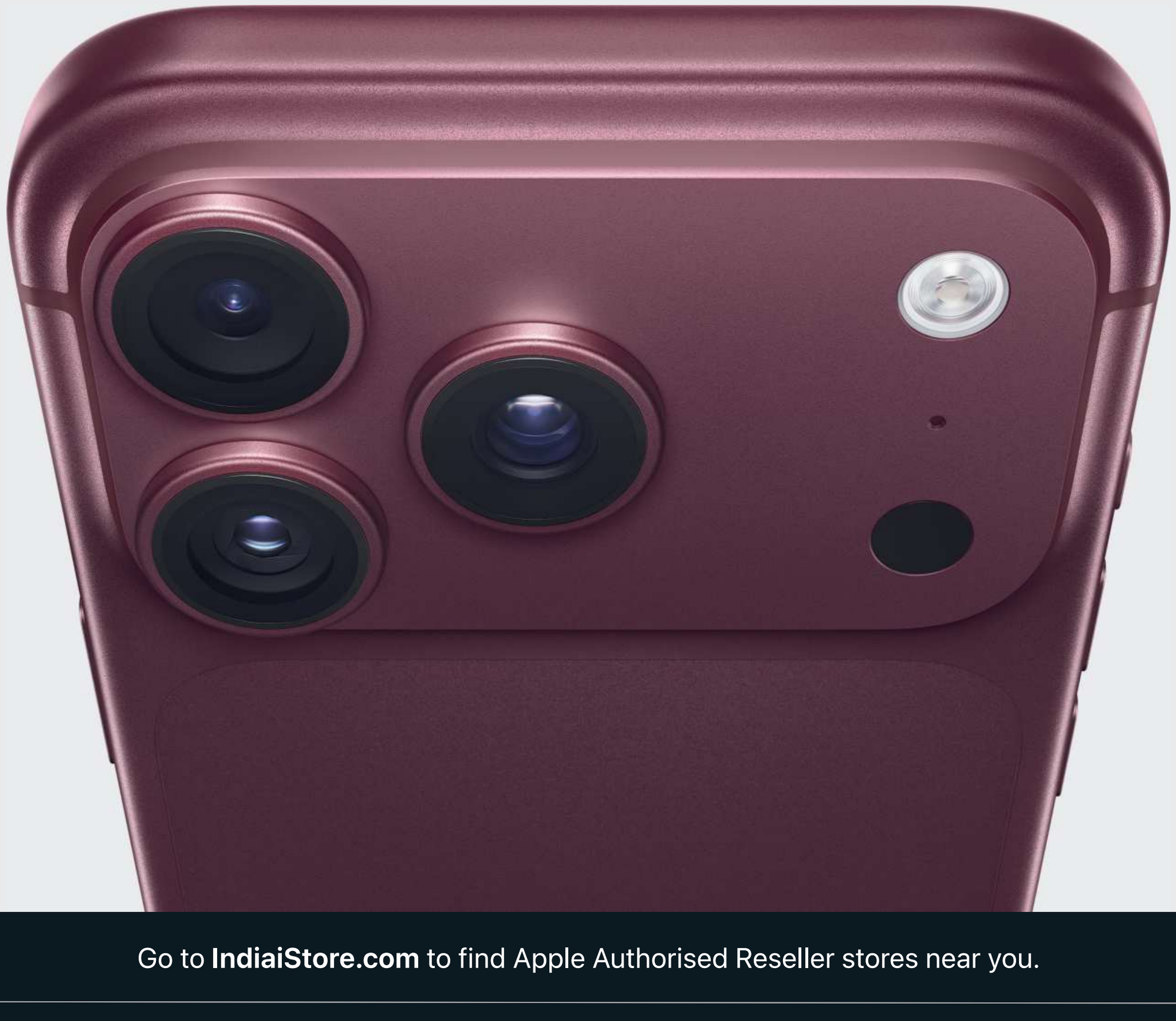

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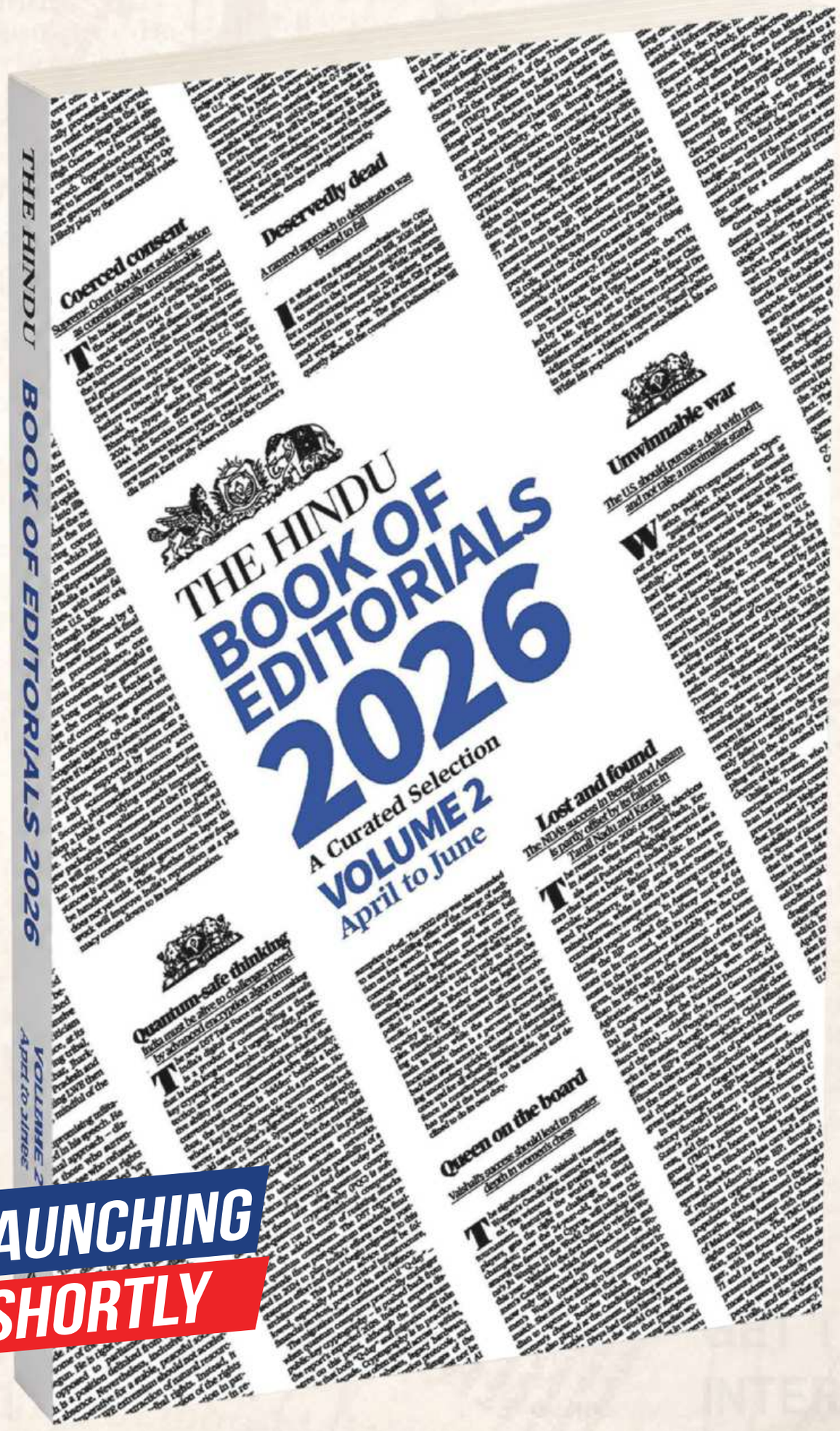

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SMRITI ERA BEGINS

Women in Blue meet Zimbabwe in T20Is

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NEARBY

Monsoon sets in over Tamil Nadu five days early

CHENNAI
The Regional Meteorological Centre in Chennai on Thursday declared the onset of the Northeast monsoon, five days earlier than its normal date of arrival. » PAGE 8

Leaders of INDIA bloc stage protest against SIR, CEC

CHENNAI
Leaders of the INDIA bloc staged a protest to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the restoration of eligible voters removed during the SIR exercise. » PAGE 8

FRIDAY REVIEW » 8 PAGES

Special summary revision of voter lists to begin soon

Annual exercise to enrol new voters and update electoral rolls was stalled last year due to launch of SIR; it will be done in 17 States and U.T.s, including poll-bound Uttarakhand, U.P. and Punjab

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

Amid protests against the special intensive revision and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, the Election Commission of India (ECI) on Thursday announced the special summary revision (SSR) of electoral rolls in 17 States and Union Territories, including poll-bound Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, and Punjab.

The SSR seeks to enrol new voters and update electoral rolls. The annual exercise was stalled last year due to the launch of the now-controversial SIR. Election Commissioners S. S. Sandhu and Vivek Joshi are understood to have raised this as an anomaly among other issues.

Roll reboot

The Election Commission has ordered voter roll revisions across 17 States and Union Territories

- Voters **need no citizenship proof** under the standard SSR process
- Candidates will **receive searchable and readable PDF** electoral rolls electronically
- Revision process **skips home visits by booth officers** and lists will be displayed locally
- ECI **limits Form 7 applications** to prevent bulk voter deletions

Unlike the SIR, applicants do not have to submit documents to prove citizenship or be mapped with earlier electoral rolls when enrolling through the SSR.

Following protests against the 13 crore SIR deletions, the ECI announced on September 29 a special drive to re-enlist voters who were left out. This re-enrolment through special camps and house-to-house visits by booth-level officers (BLOs) is being done using the original Form 6, without the declaration appended during the SIR. The commission has also capped the number of Form 7s, used for voter deletions, that an individual can submit amid reports of such applications being filed in bulk. The SSR is over and above this special re-enrolment drive.

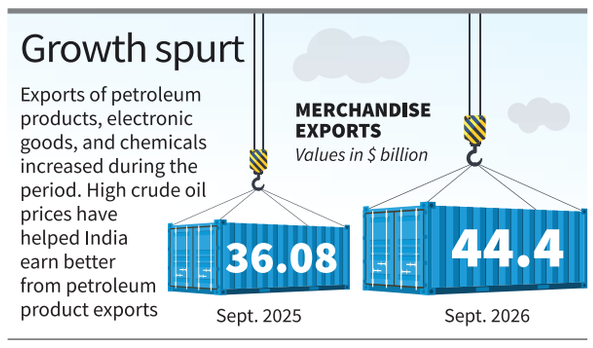
Among the firsts in this year's SSR, the ECI said that it will provide a "readable PDF" of the alphabetically arranged electoral rolls to contesting candidates and recognised political parties during elections. Opposition parties have been demanding machine-readable electoral rolls rather than image-based PDFs so that they are digitally searchable, indexable, and verifiable.

Political parties will get supplementary voter lists that were earlier kept only for record and future use.

The SSR process will not include house-to-house visits by BLOs. Instead, draft and final lists will be put up at polling booths.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 12
RELATED REPORTS ON » PAGE 13

Goods exports jump 23.04% in September



Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Healthy growth in shipments of petroleum products, electronic goods and chemicals helped India's merchandise exports rise 23.04% in September, while the trade deficit narrowed to $30.21 billion year-on-year due to a dip in imports of precious metals. In September 2025, it was $33 billion.

The country's exports rose from $36.08 billion to $44.4 billion in September 2025, government data released on Thursday said. However, the deficit widened when compared to $26.86 billion recorded during August 2026.

Exports of petroleum products, electronic goods and chemicals grew by 31.9% ($6.2 billion), 70.44% ($5.3 billion) and 24.21% ($3 billion) respectively, during the month.

High crude oil prices amid the West Asia crisis have helped India earn better realisations from petroleum product exports.

Imports rose by 8% year-on-year to $74.61 billion in September.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 12

Conversion does not automatically grant quota benefits: SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
CHENNAI

The Supreme Court on Thursday said a Hindu belonging to a Backward order cannot claim the same reservation benefits as a Muslim Backward Class member merely on conversion to another religion.

"A person who converts from a Hindu social order to a non-Hindu social order cannot claim affirmative action under Article 16 (4) of the Constitution merely on the basis of the social backwardness associated with his pre-conversion status," it held.

The court said a caste identity cannot be treated as an immutable personal attribute, irrespective of a change in religious affiliation.

FULL REPORT ON » PAGE 8

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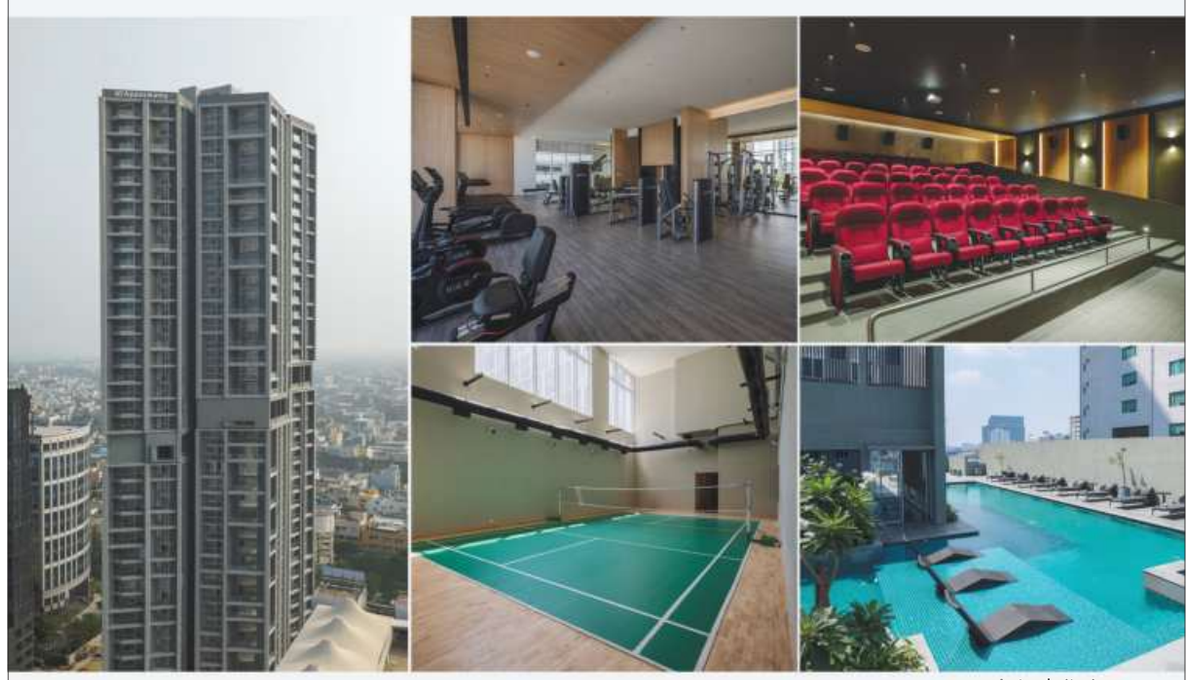

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INBRIEF

Special movie screening of *Jailer 2* for cancer survivors

Kauvery Hospital organised a special screening of Rajinikanth-starrer *Jailer 2*, released on Thursday, for cancer survivors. The medical specialists of the oncology department were also present at the special screening. The initiative was to celebrate the spirit of survivorship, togetherness, and the joy of life beyond cancer, the hospital said in a press release.

THE HINDU
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MTC revokes cancellation of tender for low-floor AC e-buses within 24 hours

Sources say the tender was initially cancelled citing administrative reasons. It extended the bid due date from October 14 to November 4. Another tender floated last year for 220 AC low-floor small e-buses to provide first- and last-mile connectivity to Metro Rail stations has not received any bids

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

In a day of flip-flops, the Metropolitan Transport Corporation (MTC) cancelled a tender floated for 1,000 low-floor 12-metre air-conditioned electric buses (e-buses), and, within 24 hours, revoked the cancellation.

In a letter written to the National Informatics Centre in Besant Nagar, the MTC Chairman stated that the tender was 'inadvertently cancelled'. It also extended the bid due date from October 14 to November 4. Sources in the MTC said the tender was cancelled on Wednesday citing administrative reasons, and the cancellation was subsequently revoked on Thursday.

Cleaner alternative: At present, nearly 750 e-buses are being operated by the MTC through the gross cost control mechanism. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

The MTC had planned to replace the aged, diesel-guzzling buses with low-floor e-buses under the gross cost control (GCC) mechanism. At present, nearly 750 e-buses are being operated by the MTC through the GCC mechanism.

Similarly, the MTC had floated a tender last year for deploying 220 AC low-floor small e-buses, which are five metres and seven metres in length, to provide first- and last-mile connectivity to Metro Rail stations.

However, it has not received any bids for the tender.

Tender extensions

The MTC has extended the tender due dates for both – the 1,000 low-floor e-buses and 220 small buses – on more than two occasions.

Social activist C. Senthil of Iyyappanthangal said with the Phase II of Metro Rail being launched between Poonamallee and Vadapalani, and the section receiving a good response, office-goers in the interior areas of Iyappanthangal, Porur, Kumananchavadi, and Karayanchavadi, do not have last-mile connectivity in the form of small buses.

Mr. Senthil wanted the MTC to expedite the deployment of small buses as early as possible to help residents of these neighbourhoods use the Metro Rail services.

Rajinikanth's flourishes elevate Nelson's rousing sequel

Bhuvanesh Chandar

Over the last two decades, numerous filmmakers have attempted to make the defining superstar film. While 2010s films, such as *Petta*, celebrated Rajinikanth in all his glory, the demands of the pan-Indian cinema market and a more action-weary, fidgety audience in the post-streaming era have reshaped what makes a quintessential Rajinikanth film in the 2020s.

Director Nelson's 2023 hit *Jailer* understood that formula (even if it was far from perfect) so intrinsically that it wouldn't be farfetched to call this style of mass masala filmmaking a definitive sub-genre tailored for its larger-than-life superstar. The allure of the first *Jailer* film might seem straightforward at first – it had a Baashha-esque no-frills plotline peppered with fan service and cameos from stars across the Indian film industry.

But what truly worked in its favour was how on-brand it was for Nelson; other than banking on the dark humour he is known for (and *Breaking Bad*-inspired ideas), *Jailer* was a pitch-perfect union of Nelson's penchant for underplaying the protagonist and modern-day Rajinism, which requires sober storytelling and verisimilitude. All shenanigans transpire only around the titular Jailer, Tiger Muthuvel Pandian.

A scene from *Jailer 2*. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

While Rajiniknath thrives in narratively earned moments of heroism, the villains and secondary characters do much of the heavy lifting, both in narrative and in mass elevation.

In *Jailer 2*, Nelson almost perfects this masala cinema formula. The prescription once again has invisible snipers punctuating the screen on cue like a well-placed Anirudh Ravichander motif, crowds of henchmen getting reduced to a pool of flesh and blood in minutes, and amid all of that, Tiger Muthuvel Pandian going about his life as if he isn't the man who is already plotting Plan Z.

Now, Rajinikanth doing Rajinikanth things should hardly surprise one, and *Jailer 2* fabulously comes into its own in the interstices between these moments. Humour is one thing, but Nelson seems to have retained and improved aspects that were effective in the first film. Beyond all of its sensational beats, *Jailer* was also a unique family drama about a man who is forced to kill his own son. And *Jailer 2* takes off from this emotional core and weaves a strong sentimental arc that anchors the storyline – especially in the second half, where the film follows its larger ambitions.

This is also why *Jailer 2* doesn't seem like a cash grab banking on its predecessor's glory; it's a proper sequel written with intent. If not for plot points, many little pleasures – like a character taking a tissue at a specific moment or one in which a weapon hidden under a vehicle's seat is used – find great callbacks in the sequel. Similarly, Shivarajkumar, whose cameo in *Jailer* single-handedly boosted its theatrical run, finds more narrative purpose in the sequel. *Jailer* finally resembles a fictional world where these superstars are simply friends.

Jailer 2 ends with a hint at a possible third film. Whether the Jailer template could sustain one more film, we can't say yet. After all, before the first film, audiences had written off Nelson as a one-trick pony. But *Jailer 2*, especially, is proof of a serious filmmaker at the helm, who is also, incidentally, the funniest. Spotting this talent and trusting him to direct such a massive project – not once but twice – is another move only Rajinikanth can make. In *thalaivar* we believe.

Man held for robbing private firm employee of ₹24 lakh

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Adyar police have arrested a 28-year-old man in connection with the robbery of ₹24 lakh from a pharmaceutical company sales manager on Sardar Patel Road on September 24.

The arrested was identified as Babu Gnanaprakasam of VOC Nagar in Adyar.

The robbery occurred around 9.30 p.m. on September 24 near the Ambika Appalam signal, when Anthony Augustine, 33, a sales manager with Asian Pharma International in West Tambaram, was returning home on his two-wheeler after collecting payments from medicine distributors.

Six-member gang

Augustine was carrying ₹24 lakh in a black leather bag when a six-member gang on three two-wheelers intercepted him and rammed their vehicles into his two-wheeler, causing him to fall.

One of the suspects threatened him with a knife, forcing him to flee. The gang then left with the cash.

Search under way

Augustine lodged a complaint with the Adyar police around 10.30 p.m.

The police are on the lookout for the other accused.

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- Shailaja Kamalathanathan

I, R.VIMALRAJ S/o. S. Ravichandran, Age 35, DOB 30/07/1992, residing at Plot No.59, Sri Mookambigai Nagar, Apple City,, Ayalcheri, Avadi, Tiruvallur–600072, have changed my name from R.Vimalraj to Vimalraj R as per affidavit dated 15/10/2026 before Notary Public, Chennai. Henceforth I shall be known as Vimalraj R S/o. S. Ravichandran only.

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Date : 16th October 2026 **Vijay Joshi**
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	Star Cast	:	Nayanthara, Sneha, Kushboo, Regina Cassandra and others
	Director	:	Mr. Sundar C
	Effective Date	:	(i) 28th day from the Theatrical Release Date of the Assigned Film(s) in Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam and Kannada; and (ii) the 56th day from the Theatrical Release Date of the Assigned Film(s) in Hindi.
	Digital Satellite Effective Date	:	90 days from the date theatrical release of the original film
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SALES MANAGER/ Executive, Purchase Executive, Accounts Executive, Office Executive Wanted with Exp. ct: Aishwaryaa Organics Pvt Ltd, Virugambakam 9994244771 info@aishwaryaa.in

REQ JUNIOR Lawyer & Typist with Computer Knwldge @ Law Firm 9841032046

WANTED – RECEPTIONIST For Psymed Hospital with minimum 2 years experience, fluent in speaking English & Tamil. Salary: Rs.25K/month. Send resume with photo to 9840114254 / psymedclinic@gmail.com

HIRING EMPOWER Leaders–team Mgr/ Fin consult/HNI/Retd/NRI Ct 8825807168

MARKETING

SALES MANAGER & Marketing Manager Wanted with Min of 2yrs Exp in The Courier & Logistics Industry. Send CV to: networkcourierindia@gmail.com

TENDERS

CHENNAI PORT AUTHORITY
MARINE DEPARTMENT

Tender Notice
No.M/OPS/F12

Tender is invited for "Retrieval of Lost Anchor at SCB - III berth at Chennai Port.

Est. Cost: Rs.80,00,000/- (excluding applicable GST)

for further details/corrigendum, if any, visit

www.chennaiport.gov.in.

https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app

Tender opening date: 04.11.2026

Sd/-
Deputy Conservator.

REAL ESTATE

BUYING

COMMERCIAL LAND

INDUSTRIAL LAND REQUIRED
5-100 Acres/Chennai Chengalpattu/Oragadam Suitable for Industrial Logistics Development. Direct Owners & Genuine Agents may
Ct:7200371487

CONSULTANTS

BUILDING PLAN Approval 25yrs Serviced & Expd in TP Dept/GCC 8825530329

JOINT DEVELOPMENT

WANTED JV Land Any Where In & Around Chennai 2–5 Ground.Ct: 9884638282

SELLING

COMMERCIAL

T.NAGAR, NEAR Burkit rd 4000 sqft Grd floor UDS 2400 sqft Semi furnished 4 covered car park Lift, 2 store rooms. Ideal for clinics, offices, gym, studios, cloud kitchens, Buyers only. 9789522759

WEST TAMBARAM, Near Bus stand Behind Henkala Hotel. 1000sft 3rd flr UDS 640 car park, lift. Ideal for office. Rent fetching 35K. Price 1.20 Cr (Neg) Buyers only Ct: 7667936936

COMMERCIAL BUILDING

6000SQFT LAND + 16000 sqft. G+3 build+5000 sft.shed for sale behind JK Mahal, Madhavaram. price Rs 9Cr (neg) Rent incme Rs 7L/mth. 9884000210

COMMERCIAL BUILDING FOR SALE
@ MADIPAKKAM
Near Ponniamman kovil
No Broker
Build Up 10000sft
Land 4000sft
Rs.12 Cr
Muraliram Group
9790184636|9444064567

COMMERCIAL LAND

Ambattur Industrial Estate 9Grds Sale Kovalam 3.5 Grd Sale 8667332977

NR UTHERAMERUR 10Acres Clear Title road touch. No Broker Ct:7604898907

14ACR LAND 400+Ft Frntge Mappedu Opp Ind Park on SH 3Cr/Acr. 9884088660

FACTORIES & SITES

VALAPURAM 50CENT 33feet rd,Nayapakam 1acre 10cent 60feet rd. 9381093477

FARMHOUSE / LAND / RESORTS

ECR MUGAIYUR Radiance Marina DTCP RERA 14400 Sft 33ft Road 9841400310

OFF ECR 9Km 25.68Acr Punjai S. Owner 11.55Cr Vasudha Estates 8807766077

RESIDENTIAL

OMR PADUR 3 Grds DTCP Apd Nr Gateway Schl Rate–3.6Cr 90X80 N/F 30ft Rd Seaview Layout.8754738710 Brk Excu

RESIDENTIAL FLAT – NEW

T.NAGAR, NR Bus Terminus, Ready for occupation, Duplex Flat, 1449 sft, Triple Bed Room, Rs.14,000/ sft, Accurate Consultants, Ct: 9585397149, 63813 99195.

T.NAGAR, POSH, 3&4BHK, Swandra Constructions, 9790915016. We Invite JV & Outright Purchase of Properties.

ADYAR KB Ngr 4BHK 2650Sft 1080UDS 4Baths, Pooja, Lift till Terrace, 2Free CCP Under Construct. 9361645390

VIRUGAMBAKKAM–SAI NAGAR 2nd Street, 'Youngman Flats' – Ready for Occupation. Only 2 flats available out of 6 flats. As per Vastu, Lift, CarParking, 1161Sqft – 3 BHK. Call Shakthi: 98410 22284

PUZUTHIVAKKAM NEW Customizable 1, 2 BHK Flats 43–L onwards 78100 25909

RAMAPURAM NEW Customizable 2, 3, 4 BHK flats 77–L onwards 78100 25909

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR NEW 2, 3 BHK Flats for sale 87–L onwards 78100 25909

VIRUGAMBAKKAM, LAMBERT Nagar Luxurious 3BHK + Powder room 2400 sqft fully furnished 1 flat per floor 1000 UDS 2 car park Power back up. Buyers only Lift +91 9789522759

RESIDENTIAL FLAT – RESALE

WEST MAMBALAM Laxmi St FF 3BH Bua 1270/Uds 510 63L & 2BH Bua 700/ 280Uds 37L – 98840 00932

T.NAGAR– PENTHOUSE– Spacious Duplex with Private Terrace–4BHK–2850Sqft–UDS 900Sqft– 2CP Cosmic Properties 96000 12555

ANNA NAGAR Firm Foundation Modern 3BHK Apt BUA 1550 Sqft UDS 660 Sqft 1 CCP Cosmic Properties 95000 35353

VELACHERY DHANDESWARAM Nagar 1650sft 4BHK 1143sft UDS 1st Flr Flat with CCP in a gated community Price Rs.10K per sft 9445887001, 9600017668

RESIDENTIAL HOUSE

RESALE DANDEESWA'RM Velachery 5BHK Ind.Home S/F 4.5C NoBrkr 7305985113

KARANIPUDUCHERY, GUDUVANCHERY Gated community, houses ranging 1158 to 1189sft.Genuine buyers (No brokers) Spl discount of 3 lak+ free 2kv solarpanel worth 1 lakhs for 1st 5 customer. Ct : 9444049292/ 9444049298

NEELANKARAI ECR seaside villa indpool L1800 buip 4500 3.80C 9941099964

AYANAVARAM: APPROVED land 833 sft, built1350sft 3BHK, study,parking 1.5Cr No Brokers. 7810010539

LUXURY BEACH Villa 2.5Cr with Private Beach access Muttukadu ECR Anugragha Builder 7845480478 / 9869845454

RESIDENTIAL LAND

GUINDY ADJACENT to 5 Furlong Rd / Puravankara Somerset 6,190sqft / J.V. / Consultants Welcome. 9940314887

ECR, PARAMANKENI 1 Acre Plot seaside Tranquil shores Right next to Pearl Beach/Kalki Ashram North facing Frontage 126ft dry land with cashew plantations. Buyers only. +91 9789522759

3GROUNDS OF Land in Sholinganallur Close to Main Rd Contact:9940029415

PONNERI PAZAVERKADU Beach Resort DTCP RERA Aprd 5.10 Laks. 9445164006

WEST TAMBARAM Varadharajapuram PTC Quarters Nr 4Grounds Available Rs.2600 Per sft 9840972961 / 9894715293

OMR NR Mambakkam Plots for Sale 600 to 2800sft Rs. 23 Lacs* 9500212205

REDHILLS SOTHUPAKKAM CMDA Approved Plot 1650Sqft 9094448443 NO Brokers

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3 Grounds
5000 sq.ft. BUA
BROKERS EXCUSE
70666 77777
COSMIC PROPERTIES

RENTAL

COMMERCIAL

THAIYUR ON Road OMR & New Bypass / Opp–SSN CLG/ Rakki Cinamas/ 8720 Sq.Ft. Ct: 9790702021

NEW BUILDING in Perungudi,300m from OMR Perungudi metro,17000 sqft,S+3,lift,10 CCP& ample OCP 9840503925

COMMERCIAL PROPERTIES 1500 sqft in 1 st floor at Kodambakkam and 3800 sqft in 1 st floor at T.Nagar available for rent. ct owner:9940188166

COMMERCIAL SPACE for Rent Nr. Nerkundrum New Bridge on First floor 1500sft & 2500sft With Good Carparking & Bike parking Facility more Suitable for Banks. Ct: 9840064490

PERUNGUDI (OMR)
Nehru Nagar 7690sqft, Independent Building, G+2, Fully Furnished, 100 Work Stations, 7 Cabins, 2 Conference Hall, Centrally Air Conditioned, Power Backup, Server Room, Fire Exit, Car / 2 wheeler Parking.
Ct: 9840028833

COMMERCIAL

ANNANAGAR, 3RD Avenue, 4000 Sq.ft. Retail space. Bysani Property Advisors: 9789000737

PORUR, RETAIL Space, 18000 Sqft . Bysani Property Advisors: 9789000737

NANDANAM OPP.YMCA, GF 1200Sft Furnished 95K Commercial. Ct: 9444570779

FACTORIES & SITES

VALLAM VADAGAL Brand New Industrial Shed 60k, 26k sft. Contact: 8056226024 & 9444331069

RESIDENTIAL

MYLAPORE

3BHK+SERV QTRS Warren Rd 2200sft S.Furn 4flr 6AC 2CCP 1.8L. 9940362768

PADI

BACHELOR ROOMS at Padi for Rent. Ct: 7200362119, 9840636662, 9789981171

PERUNGUDI

2100sqft Ind Villa 3.5,4BHK 2CP Back Side of Global Info City Park Opposite Lake Rent 43k+Maint. Ct:9884966968

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Toll Free @ 1800 102 4161

Telangana invites T.N. businesses to join its growth journey

Telangana Minister D. Sridhar Babu speaking at 'Invest Telangana Global Summit 2026' roadshow on Thursday. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Telangana government is developing an exclusive 200-acre drone park to build a complete ecosystem for the drone industry. "We will also introduce a drone policy, as some form of regulation is necessary," said D. Sridhar Babu, Telangana Minister for Information Technology, Electronics and Communications, and Industries and Commerce.

Making a pitch about the opportunities in his State at the Chennai Roadshow of the Invest Telangana Global Summit 2026, organised along with Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), the Minister said: "We have not come to Chennai to compete with Tamil Nadu. Tamil Nadu has its strengths, and they are formidable. Telangana has its own. We have come with humility, to ask you to be part of our journey."

The Minister highlighted Hyderabad's rise as a global technology hub and home to a fast-growing community of Global Capability Centres, Genome Valley's production of a third of the world's vaccines, the State's aerospace manufacturing base and T-Hub, one of India's largest startup ecosystems.

He pointed to opportunities for Coimbatore pump makers to set up their second plants in Telangana to serve central and northern India, for Tiruppur knitwear entrepreneurs to work with Telangana cotton in Warangal, and for Chennai auto component suppliers to build EV electronics with Hyderabad's engineers. "When Tamil Nadu and Telangana work together, South India grows stronger. And when South India grows stronger, India moves forward," he said. The Invest Telangana Global Summit 2026 will be held from December 7 to 9, 2026 at Bharat Future City, Hyderabad.

Despite policing, wrong-side driving persists on city roads

The problem has drawn mounting complaints on social media. Residents call for more stringent enforcement of one-way traffic rules and better monitoring to prevent accidents and ensure safety

R. Sivaraman
R. Srikanth
CHENNAI

A growing number of motorists appear to be treating wrong-side driving as a convenient shortcut, disregarding traffic rules and putting other road users at risk.

Across the city, two-wheelers routinely take the wrong route to avoid detours or beat traffic, causing bottlenecks and increasing the risk of accidents. The problem has also drawn mounting complaints on social media, with residents flagging violations at several locations. Despite the police booking hundreds of cases daily, the practice persists on busy roads, including on stretches where traffic police personnel are stationed.

In Velachery, wrong-side driving has become commonplace on Velachery Main Road near the Sarathy Nagar junction. With a private school located nearby, hundreds of parents drive on the wrong side with their children. Many parents appear undeterred by the presence of a traffic police booth at the signal junction and continue to flout traffic rules.

Utter disregard: Motorists entering Venkatachalam Street, a road with "no entry" sign board, in Royapettah on Wednesday. M. SRINATH

R. Santosh, a Perungudi resident, said traffic on Rajiv Gandhi Salai had become increasingly heavy due to Metro Rail works. Delivery personnel were among those frequently violating traffic rules, he said.

Pondy Bazaar, one of busiest shopping hubs in Chennai, also faces the problem of wrong side driving by two-wheelers. This inconveniences pedestrians, puts shoppers and commuters at risk, and undermines road safety in the crowded T. Nagar and Pondy Bazaar areas. "Strict enforcement of one-way traffic rules and better monitoring are essential to prevent accidents," said S. Krishnamoorthy, a Pondy Bazaar resident.

On Anna Salai, two-wheelers frequently enter the road from Chintadripet side in the wrong direction to reach Ritchie Street quickly. The practice is particularly dangerous as an MTC bus stop is on the stretch.

A senior traffic police officer said the department was taking sustained action to curb wrong-side driving. "We booked 700 cases for wrong-side driving today (Wednesday) alone. So far, 2,63,577 cases have been booked for violations of Motor Vehicles Rules. We have identified locations where wrong-side driving is increasingly reported and have drawn up an action plan to curb the menace completely," the officer said.

(With inputs from Sangeetha Kandavel)

Private hospital in Adyar launches clinic to treat obesity and metabolic disorders

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

MGM Healthcare Malar, Adyar, launched 'Metabolic Clinic' on Thursday.

The clinic will offer a multi-specialty programme for obesity and metabolic disorders. It will provide individualised, evidence-based treatments for excess weight management, of associated medical complications, and support for remission of several metabolic conditions. It will also address associated conditions such as prediabetes, type 2 diabetes, polycystic ovarian syndrome (PCOS), and lipid abnormalities, including elevated cholesterol and triglyceride levels.

Maduravoyal MLA Rhevanth Charan P. launched the clinic.

Meherprasad Y.D., senior consultant endocrinologist, who is leading the programme, said metabolic problems such as excess weight, high blood sugar, abnormal cholesterol levels, and conditions such as PCOS had become increasingly common, affecting adults, children, and young adults.

Maduravoyal MLA Rhevanth Charan P. and other participants at the event held to launch 'Metabolic Clinic' at MGM Healthcare Malar in Adyar. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

He said an integrated approach would enable the development of individualised treatment plans, which address multiple health challenges associated with obesity, promote sustainable weight management, and support the remission of eligible metabolic conditions.

The programme will be supported by specialists Manohar G. (cardiology), Ammaiyappan Palaniswamy C. (pulmonology), and Kavitha Sampathkumar (hepatology), along with dietitians and physiotherapists.

Kalpana Thai B., the hospital's medical superintendent was present, a press release added.

Chennai Weather

	max	min
Tiruvallur	36	24
Chennai Airport	36	27
Chennai City	35	28

Chennai Airport Today
32°C The weather will be a little warm. Night will be comfortable. Few spells of moderate rain and thundershower may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
34°C The weather will be warm. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershower may occur.

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Timings
CHENNAI

FRIDAY, OCT. 16		
RISE	06:00	SET 17:50
RISE	10:42	SET 22:08
SATURDAY, OCT. 17		
RISE	06:00	SET 17:50
RISE	11:32	SET 23:00
SUNDAY, OCT. 18		
RISE	06:00	SET 17:49
RISE	12:19	SET 23:53

सी पी सी एल
CPCL
Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited
(A Govt. of India Enterprise & a group company of IndianOil)
[CIN – L40101TN1965GOI005389]
Regd. Office: No.536, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai – 600 018

NOTICE

Further to the Notice dated 15.10.2026 published regarding Shri Karthikeyan N, PR No.803407, SEA-VIII-P&U II&III, CPCL, it is hereby informed that Shri Karthikeyan N has contacted the undersigned. The matter will be further addressed internally in accordance with the established rules and guidelines of the Corporation. This notice is issued for general information.

A.S. Rajkumar
Chief General Manager (Technical)
Disciplinary Authority

Date: 16.10.2026
Place: Chennai

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Unaudited (Reviewed) Financial Results for the Quarter/Half Year Ended 30th September, 2026 (₹ in Lakh)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations (net)	817408	742139	1685632	1485460	2974098
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	106469	102506	363962	197126	437349
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	106469	102506	363962	197126	437349
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	78564	61976	144197	122720	276786
5.	Total Comprehensive income for the period (comprising Profit/Loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)	Please Refer Note No. 2				
6.	Paid Up Equity Share Capital	1253956	1253956	1253956	1253956	1253956
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves)	1756007	1541844	1756007	1541844	1756007
8.	Securities Premium Account	504211	504211	504211	504211	504211
9.	Net Worth	2788109	2301266	2788109	2301266	2446221
10.	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	0.08	0.09	0.08	0.09	0.09
11.	Debt Equity Ratio	0.75	0.66	0.75	0.66	0.70
12.	Earning Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)					
	1. Basic :	0.63	0.49	1.15	0.98	2.21
	2. Diluted :	0.63	0.49	1.15	0.98	2.21
13.	Capital Redemption Reserve	Not Applicable				
14.	Debenture Redemption Reserve					

Notes : 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly/ half-yearly financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under regulation 33 and 52 of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the quarterly/half yearly Financial Result are available on the Stock Exchange websites. (BSE : www.bseindia.com and NSE : www.nseindia.com), Bank's website (www.uco.bank.in/Investors)
2. Information relating to total comprehensive income and other comprehensive income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to the bank.

For UCO Bank
Sd/- Vijaykumar Nivrutti Kamble, Executive Director
Sd/- Rajendra Kumar Saboo, MD & CEO (I/C) and Executive Director
Sd/- Aravamudan Krishna Kumar, Non-Executive Chairman

Place : Kolkata
Dated : 15th October, 2026

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CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
East Mada Street, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004
Saroja Parasaran Memorial Endowment "Navaratri Festival" - Oct 11-20, 2026
Today: 16th Oct: 5.00 pm: **Smt. Chaitraa Sairam** (Vocal), 6.30 pm: **Smt. J.B.Keerthana** (Vocal).
Tomorrow: 17th Oct: 5.00 pm: **Sri Mohan Santhanam** (Vocal), 6.30 pm: **Smt.Sankari Krishnan** (Vocal).
Prasadham at 8.30pm. **All are welcome.**
In Association with : Nalli

Goethe-Institut/Max Mueller Bhavan, Chennai
Invites you to MULBERRY QUINTET | 16 OCTOBER 2026, 6:30 PM | GOETHE-INSTITUT CHENNAI, 4 Rutland Gate, 5th Street, Chennai. An Evening of Western Classical Music - featuring works by Bach, Mozart, Beethoven & Brahms, alongside Indian compositions. All are welcome!

Mahalakshmi Temple & Kalyanamandapam Association No. 11, Park View Street, R.A.Puram, Chennai-600028. Ph: 9941130700
Today 5 pm Musical Concert by Students of Sir Sivaswami Kalalaya Senior Secondary School. All are welcome.

Madurai Mani Iyer Rasikas Association, Chennai-4. Phone: 9841313527
114th Birthday Special Listening session on Saturday, 17th October from 4.30 p.m. at Vivekananda Hall, P.S. High School, Mylapore. All are welcome!

Mudhra Navarathri Vaibhavam
9 days festival - Concerts based on Theme : DEVI
11th October to 19th October 2026
Watch webstreaming today (16-10-26) at PaalamTV & mudhrabhaskar YouTube Channel
@ 6.00 pm Harikatha on Goddess Lakshmi by Madurai Shri.T.N.Seshagopalan
@ 7.00 pm Concert based on DEVI Anjana P. Rao
V.Bargava Vignesh - Sunaada Krishna Amai
JOY OF GIVING Minimum of Rs.900(India) or more
For further details : 9840072821
Register Paalam Whatsapp channel for regular notifications
Powered by : Nalli

Naada Inbam, 24992672
Dr. Praveena Thodge, Dr. Sudha Iyer, Nellai Balaji. Today 6.15 p.m. at Ragasudha Hall.

Ramakrishna Mission Students' Home, Mylapore
NAVARATRI UTSAV-2026
at Vivekananda Auditorium from Oct 11 TO 20, 2026
TODAY 16-10-2026, 7.30 a.m.: Discourse on "Swami Vivekananda and Sri Anjaneya" by Swami Harivratanandaji Maharaj, Ramakrishna Mission Vidyalaya, Coimbatore.
6.30 p.m. Villupattu (Theiva Thirumoovar Arul) by Smt. Bharathi Thirumagan & Group. All are Welcome!
Best Wishes : Nalli

Shanmukhapriya (Cultural Wing of Swamy's School, Porur). Phone: 24826000, 7358649041
Navaratri Festival - Today at 5.30 p.m. Prayer and rendering of Devotional Songs by the students at Swamy's School. At 6.00 p.m. Folk play "Tridevi: The Three Divine Powers" by the students at Swamy's School. At 6.30 p.m. Students of Sri Sai Nrithyalaya present Bharathanatyam Dance Drama "Sivapuranam" (Aacharya - Smt. H N Nandhini Suresh) at Subbalakshmi Auditorium, Swamy's School, Santhosh Nagar, Porur, Chennai - 600125. Secretary: Dr. Gayathri Girish, Co-ordinator: K. Viswanathan. All are welcome.

Sri Thyaga Brahma Gana Sabha (Regd.) Vanimahal. Ph: 28152166
Today 6.30 pm at Vani Mahal NAVARATHRI FESTIVAL -2026 Vocal Concert by Ms. S. M. Vilasini, Sri Pappu Gyandev (Violin), Sri Burra Sriram (Mrud.). All are welcome.

Sringeri Bharathi Vidyashram, T.Nagar. Ph: 24348964
Navarathri Music Concerts, Today 5 p.m, Sharada Narayanan - Vocal, Avantika, Hari Prakash, 6.30 p.m. Kalaimamani Mudikondan Ramesh - Veena, R. Sowmya - Veena Duo, Sarvesh Karthik, Dr. S. Karthik. All are welcome.

Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam
15.10.2026 – 7.00 p.m. – "Sundara Kandam" Upanyasam by Pravachana Tilakam Dhamal S. Ramakrishnan.

MISCELLANEOUS

Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam
15.10.2026 – 9.00 a.m. - Sri Medha Dakshinamurthy, Dhaaranaa Saraswathi, Hayagreeva Mantra Homams; Chandi Parayanam, Veda Parayanam, Sahasranama Archanai, Suvasini & Kanya Pooja; 12.30 p.m. – Annadhanam; 6.30 p.m. – Kamadhenu Vahana Alankaram.

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ISSN 0971 - 751X

INBRIEF

Saveetha College holds international conference

The Saveetha College of Liberal Arts and Sciences organised its fifth international conference on "Transdisciplinary Research, Innovation and Excellence (ICTRIE-2026)" at the American College of Higher Education at Kandy in Sri Lanka recently. During the two-day conference, a Memorandum of Understanding was signed between Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences (SIMATS) and American College of Higher Education, paving the way for 91 academicians, researchers, and students to share their findings in global research and innovation. N.M. Veeraiyan, Chancellor, SIMATS, and Kularatne, Vice-Chancellor, American College of Higher Education, Sri Lanka, participated.

SIT granted custody of Veeramani for 2 days

A Special Court for POCSO cases has permitted the Special Investigation Team (SIT) to take Gem Granites owner R. Veeramani into custody for two days for questioning. The SIT is investigating complaints of alleged sexual abuse of minors against Veeramani. He was arrested in August in the first case and again on October 7 in a second case. The SIT had filed a petition before the Chennai POCSO Special Court seeking five days of police custody to interrogate Veeramani in connection with the second case. The judge directed the SIT to interrogate him from 7.30 p.m. on Thursday until 7.30 p.m. on Saturday.

Text & Context and Health

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (October 16, Friday), the following articles are available:

- The debate over immunity to CEC, ECs **newsth.live/immunity-to-ec**
- Shifting global focus towards inclusive assessment of threats to health **newsth.live/healththreat**

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Metro Rail's Phase II stations plagued by minor leakages

Wednesday's showers expose leaks in stations such as Poonamallee, Vadapalani, Iyyappanthangal, and Porur, less than a week since launch. Phase I network faced similar issue about a decade ago

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Nearly a decade ago, rains exposed leakages at some of the newly opened Chennai Metro Rail stations on the Phase I network. The same problem persists today at some of the new Phase II stations along the 14.6-km Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch.

During the intermittent showers on Wednesday, stations such as Poonamallee Bypass, Thelliyaragam, Iyyappanthangal, Vadapalani, and Porur Bypass faced minor leakages, sources said.

In stations such as Iyyapanthangal and Thelliyaragaram, buckets were kept to collect the rainwater dripping from the roof, and signboards warning passengers of wet floor were placed.

Recurring issue: Leakages have been reported near the staircase, walkalator, and ticketing areas. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

"Minor leakages were reported in passenger footfall areas such as the walkalator, staircase, and the ticketing areas, too. Less than a week since launch, we are already seeing such leakages. Even though they are minor, such issues should not emerge in a project for which thousands of crores have been spent," a source said.

The authorities should have thoroughly checked all the areas for such leakages and plugged them before opening the stretch to the public, sources said.

"Nearly 10 years have passed [since the Metro work began]. Yet, it is sad that the same issues persist in our stations and that a lasting solution has not been found," another source said.

According to officials of the Chennai Metro Rail Limited, they have already begun attending to the issue. "The leakages are minor and will be resolved in a day," an official said.

Information display

Additionally, the Passenger Information Display System, which displays real-time information of train arrival, either lags or does not show the time in stations such as Porur Bypass and Porur Junction.

While the timings of the trains heading to Vadapalani were displayed in both the stations, those of the trains bound for Poonamallee Bypass were not shown.

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay holding talks with Singapore Deputy Prime Minister Gan Kim Yong in Ambattur on Thursday.

Vijay holds talks with Singapore Deputy PM on economic ties

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Thursday held talks with Deputy Prime Minister of Singapore Gan Kim Yong on strengthening economic ties between Tamil Nadu and Singapore, and attracting more investments from Singapore, an official release said.

The meeting was held on the sidelines of the unveiling of the Singapore-based CapitaLand Data Centre Chennai 01 at SIDCO Industrial Estate in Ambattur.

Mr. Yong, who is also the Minister for Energy, Trade and Industry (Trade), Republic of Singapore, and Mr. Vijay participated in the event.

High Commissioner of the Republic of Singapore to India Simon Wong, Consul-General of Singapore in Chennai William Chik, Singapore Economic Development Board Managing Director Jermaine Loy, Senior Director at Singapore's Ministry of Trade and Industry Francis Chong, and Regional Director of Enterprise Singapore Jessie Ng were part of the Singapore delegation.

₹2 cr. collected in fines for traffic violations through special camps

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A total of ₹2.01 crore was collected in fines for traffic violations through special e-challan collection camps held at 15 locations across the city from September 21 to October 15.

To help motorists clear their pending fines for traffic violations, the Greater Chennai Traffic Police (GCTP) has been conducting the camps at special call centres.

Motorists were informed of their pending e-challans and provided guidance on how to pay the fines.

In response to public requests, the traffic police have announced that the e-challan fine collection camps would be conducted every month, from the 1st to the 10th, at the 15 special call centres.

The public will be provided with the necessary facilities to clear their pending fines.

CM launches semiconductor ecosystem scheme

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay launched the Tamil Nadu Semiconductor Ecosystem Scheme 2026 at the Secretariat on Thursday. The scheme aims at establishing Tamil Nadu as a leading semiconductor and advanced electronics manufacturing hub in India.

The scheme is to be implemented under two categories.

Under the first category, the Tamil Nadu government will provide additional incentives and support, over and above the financial assistance provided by the Union government, for investment projects approved under the Centre's Semicon 2.0/India Semiconductor Mission scheme.

Under the second category, the State government will provide support and incentives to eligible investment projects that may not fall under the Centre's scheme but are considered important for strengthening Tamil Nadu's semiconductor ecosystem, the release added.

TAMIL NADU GREEN ENERGY CORPORATION LIMITED
TNGECL
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of Work
HE – 2529	CE / HYDRO	E-Tender for refurbishment of rotor by replacement of rotor rim sheets and re-stacking in 100 MW Unit-III of Kadamparai Power House in Kadamparai Generation Circle.

For Details of Work / Service / Due date of Submission / Opening / Viewing and downloading of E-Tenedrs Please visit Websites from **https://tntenders.gov.in / tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app** for submission of bids. **DIPR/3155/Tender/2026**

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विज्ञापन संख्या-228(2)/47-का-3/2026
दिनाकः 15 अक्टूबर, 2026

कार्मिक विभाग
उत्तर प्रदेश शासन
महानिदेशक, डॉ0 राम मनोहर लोहिया उत्तर प्रदेश प्रशासन एवं प्रबन्धन अकादमी,लखनऊ के पद पर नियुक्ति हेतु पुनः आवेदन पत्र आमंत्रित किए जाने के संबंध में।

सूचय है कि विज्ञापन संख्या-228(2)/47-का-3-2026, दिनांक 14 सितम्बर, 2026 के माध्यम से महानिदेशक, डॉ0 राम मनोहर लोहिया उत्तर प्रदेश प्रशासन एवं प्रबंधन अकादमी, लखनऊ के पद पर नियुक्ति हेतु विज्ञापन प्रकाशित करते हुए ऑनलाइन आवेदन पुनः आमंत्रित किये गए थे, जिसकी अन्तिम तिथि 30.09.2026 थी।

2. महानिदेशक, डॉ0 राम मनोहर लोहिया उत्तर प्रदेश प्रशासन एवं प्रबंधन अकादमी, लखनऊ के पद पर नियुक्ति हेतु ऑनलाइन आवेदन पुनः आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं। इच्छुक आवेदक नियुक्ति एवं कार्मिक विभाग की वेबसाइट ww.niyuktionline.upsde.gov.in पर दिनांक 16.10.2026 से दिनांक 30.11.2026 तक ऑनलाइन आवेदन कर सकते हैं।

3. उक्त पद से संबंधित शैक्षिक एवं अन्य अर्हता, वेतन व भत्ते एवं चयन की प्रक्रिया एवं अन्य संबंधित विवरण नियुक्ति एवं कार्मिक विभाग की वेबसाइट www.niyuktionline.upsde.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है। किसी भी दशा में ऑफलाइन आवेदन स्वीकार नहीं किये जायेंगे।

4. जो आवेदन पूर्व में किए हैं, उन पर भी विचार किया जाएगा और उन्हें पुनः आवेदन करने का औचित्य नहीं है।

(अभिषेक गोयल)
विशेष सचिव,
नियुक्ति एवं कार्मिक विभाग,
उत्तर प्रदेश शासन ।

UPID RO: 258430 Dt:15/10/2026 www.up.gov.in

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़
रामगढ़ थाना के सामने, गांधी चौक, रामगढ़ कैन्ट,
जिला– रामगढ़, झारखण्ड– 829122,
ई-मैल– eercdramgarh-jhr@nic.in

एस०बी०डी० आधारित अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
ई–निविदा प्रसंग संख्या :– RCD/RAMGARH/1525/2026-27
दिनांक :– 10-10-2026

1.	कार्य का नाम	Construction of 2-Lane Road with Paved Shoulder from Barlanga to Gola-Muri Road including ROB Under Road Divison, Ramgarh for the of Year 202 6-27
2.	प्राक्कलित राशि (रूपये में)	रुपये 49,50,00,000.00 (उनचास करोड़ पचास लाख) मात्र
3.	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	12(बारह) माह
4.	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशित होने की तिथि एवं समय	28 / 10 / 2026 10:30 बजे अपराह्न
5.	निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	10 / 11 / 2026 12:00 बजे दिन तक
6.	प्री–बिड मीटिंग की तिथि एवं समय	04 / 11 / 2026 12:30 बजे दिन तक
7.	निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़
8.	प्रोक्योरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क नम्बर	98351–25637
9.	ई–प्रोक्योरमेट सेल का हेल्प लाईन नम्बर	0651–2401010

➢ निविदा की अन्य शर्ते वेबसाइट http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखी जा सकती है।
➢ पथ निर्माण विभाग, झारखण्ड में निबंधित निविदाकारों को UCAN से संबंधित प्रमाण पत्र की छायाप्रति संलग्न करना अनिवार्य है।
➢ निविदा की राशि घट–बढ़ सकती है।
➢ Cost of bidding document (Non-refundable fee) & Bid Security as indicated shall be payable online through http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in.

कार्यपालक अभियंता
PR 391742 (Road)26-27*D पo निo विo पथ प्रमण्डल रामगढ़

TNRDC
TAMIL NADU ROAD DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LTD
TENDER NOTICE (Online only)
Tender Notice No: TNRDC/CD/007/2026 Date:08.10.2026
The Managing Director, M/s. TamilNadu Road Development Company Ltd. (TNRDC), Guindy, Chennai - 600 025 invites bids under single cover system through online only for implementation of the following work in East Coast Road (ECR), Tamil Nadu upto 02.11.2026, 2.00 PM.

S. No.	Description of Works	Indicative value of work exclusive of GST(Rs)	EMD / Bid Security value (Rs)	Period of completion
1	Appointment of Service Agency for toll collection at Uthandi and Kovalam Toll plazas at East Coast Road (ECR) for two years	189.31 Lakhs (for 2 years)	1,89,300/-	2 Years

Details of works, tender documents and all other details are available from 17.10.2026 to 02.11.2026, 2.00 PM in the NIC portal website https://tntenders.gov.in. In case of any changes / corrections etc on the above, the same will be published in the above website only. The deadline for submission of bids through online is fixed as 02.11.2026, 2.00 PM The bids are scheduled to be opened on 02.11.2026 at 03.00 PM.
Managing Director
TamilNadu Road Development Company Ltd.
DIPR/ 3153 /TENDER/2026

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM
Under noted amendment is hereby made against tender No. 26265154A due on 15.10.2026 Tender Notice No. 13 dt. 03.09.2026 (Item No. 14) **Item No. :- 14., Item Description:-** NIT Conditions (Commercial- Compliance Sr. No.04) **Existing Entry:-** Documents uploading Not allowed **Amended as:-** Documents uploading-Allowed. **Item Description:-** Tender Opening date-with time **Existing Entry:-** 15.10.2026 11:30 am **Amended as:-** 30.10.2026 11:30 am Description may be viewed at IREPS website. All other terms and condition will be remained unchanged. **Note:** Above information may be seen on N.E. Railway Website **www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in** & Govt. of India's website **www.tenders.gov.in**
Principal Chief Material Manager
CPRO/S-73 Gorakhpur
Do Not Smoke Bidi/Cigarette in train

Government of Jharkhand, Jharkhand Flying Institute
A Society Regd. Under Department of Cabinet Secretariat & Vigilance (Civil Aviation Division)
State Hangar, Birsa Munda Airport Road, Hinoo Ranchi-834002
E-mail-jfi.govtfly@gmail.com/jfi@jharkhandaviation.in • Website-www.jharkhandaviation.in

Jharkhand Flying Institute (JFI), Govt. of Jharkhand invites applications from qualified and experienced candidates for the following positions on Contract basis:-

1. Advertisement No.: **-JFI / Employment-25/2025-913, dated-15.10.2026**
2. Name of the Post & details:-

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Age (Maximum)	No. of Post	Lump sum monthly emoluments	Type of Service	Qualification/ Experience
01.	AAI Consultant	65 Year	01 (One) UR	Rs. 1,00,000/- to 1,50,000/-	Contractual	B.Sc & 10 years Experience in Airport Management or Air Traffic Management, Experience in Aerodrome Licensing and operationalisation of RCS Airports, Experience of Airport and ATS Automation Operations. Experience in Aviation Safety . or Rtd. from AAI as AGM with the same experience as stated above.

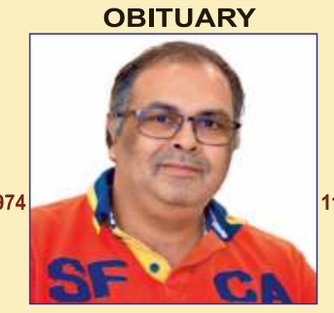
3. Reservation is applicable as per existing state government rules
4. Place of the duty : JFI, Ranchi/ JFI, Dumka, Dumka Airport, Dumka/ Any Base of JFI.
5. **Last date of application : 26th of October 2026**
6. Managing Director, JFI reserves the right to cancel/postpone this notice wholly or partially without assigning any reason. No Claims will be admissible in case of such cancellation/postponement.
7. Direction for submission of application:-
Candidate fulfilling all the required qualifications can send their application along with complete bio-data and prescribed format to Managing Director, State Hangar, Birsa Munda Airport, Hinoo, Ranchi, Jharkhand – 834002 through e-mail to *employment.jfi@gmail.com.* Please apply by e-mail and include the title of the post in the subject of the mail. Shortlisted candidate will be called for the selection process on scheduled dates.

Sd/-
(Capt. S. P. Sinha)
Managing Director
Jharkhand Flying Institute
PR 391877 (Civil Aviation) 26-27 (D)

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY



15.10.1974 — 11.10.2026

M. SIVARAMAKRISHNAN

"He gave more than he asked for, brought laughter wherever he went, and leaves behind more love than words can ever express".

"Chairman, UCAL Group; Managing Director, UCAL Exports, with Associations including Galatta Media Pvt. Ltd., Madras Motor Sports Club and MCRT-94.

A devoted family man, Siva leaves behind his beloved mother, Radhamani; his wife, Aruna Radhakrishnan; his cherished twin sons, Aarya and Rudra; and his sisters, Meenakshi and Lakshmi, along with his extended Family and many dear Friends.

Forever loved. Deeply missed.

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
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BIRTHDAY REMEMBRANCE

Mrs. Saroja Sundaram (Amma)
Fondly remembering you on what would have been your 93rd Birthday (October 15th, 2026)
- Ram, Jaya, Ravi, Shubha, Akhila, other family members & friends

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

25th Year Anniversary

GEETHA HARAN
DOD: 16.10.2001
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Husband
Daughters & Relatives

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Bangalore Electricity Supply Company Limited
(Wholly owned Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
(CIN - UO4010KA2002SGC030438)

Short Term Tender Notification
(Through KPP Portal)

BESCOM invites tenders vide Enquiry / Indent No. BESCOM/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT1175/CALL-2 for "Repairs /Rectification of faults in the HT/LT Under Ground Cable in BRAZ area of BESCOM for a period One Year on Total Turnkey on Percentage Quoting basis." Bid Documents available from: 16.10.2026. Last date for Bid Submission: 30.10.2026, 17:00 Hrs. Opening of Bid Document: 31.10.2026, 17:15 Hrs. The Tenders can be obtained through KPP portal web-site http://kppp.karnataka. gov.in. Aspiring Bidders need to register on KPP portal. Further Bidders can take assistance with KPP help desk contact numbers (+91-8046010000, +91-8068948777) or email at support@eprochelpdesk.com.Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Chief General Manager (Ele.,), Procurement,
Corporate office, BESCOM, 2nd Floor,
K R Circle, Bengaluru-560001.

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Govt. of Bihar

Information and Public Relations Department

NOTICE

Sealed proposals are invited from interested Film/Audio Makers Agency for empanelment for making Video spots/Audio jingles/Short Films/Documentaries/Docu-Dramas etc. for Information and Public Relations Department and other Government Departments as and when required. Information and Public Relations Department will empanel the suitable Film Makers/Agencies for a period of 3 years or till the time of next empanelment. The Criteria and necessary conditions for empanelment can be seen on the departmental website https://state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar or https://eadvtprd.bihar.gov.in//PublicAdView.aspx.

Existing Panel Communicated vide office order No-552, Dated 03.10.2025 will remain valid simultaneously along with Empanelment done through current notice.

IPRD keeps discretionary right to assign work order to any empanelled Film Maker/ Audio maker Agency. This means empanelment does not give any right to Film/Audio Makers Agencies to claim work order from the department.

The last date of submitting the proposal is up to **04:00 PM on 28.10.2026** The proposal will be opened **on 05:00 PM at 28.10.2026** in the presence of Empanelment Advisory Committee for stage- 1 evaluation. Agency which succeed in stage- 1 will be call for stage- 2 evaluation (presentation) latter on.

The applicant film Maker/Agency may remain present in person or through its authorized representative at the time of opening of proposals.

The Secretary, Information & Public Relations Department reserves the right to accept or reject any or all proposal without incurring any obligation to inform the applicant Film Maker/Agency of the ground/grounds of rejection.

This information is available on **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar also**

(Gunjan Singh)
Director
Information and Public Relations Department
Bihar, Patna

PR. No. 013765 (I & PRD) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

Jharkhand Education Project Council
JSCA, Stadium Road, Sector-3, Dhurwa, Ranchi – 834004
Phone : 0651-2444501, 2444502, Fax – 2444506,
e-mail: jepcranchi1@gmail.com

Letter. No.: QU/40/139/2026/4102 **Date: 15/10/2026**

E-Tender Notice

JEPC, Ranchi invites E-Bids for **Rate Contract for General Printing Works.** Bidders can download bid documents from website ***https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in*** from 16.10.2026 (11.00 AM), onwards. Last date/Time for receipt of bids through e-tender is 07.11.2026 up to 04:00 PM. The pre-bid meeting will be held on 23.10.2026 at 03:30 PM.

Sd/-
(Shashi Ranjan)
State Project Director

PR 391861 Jharkhand Education Project Council (26-27)_D

Jharkhand Education Project Council
J.S.C.A Stadium Road, Jagannathpur, Sector -3,
Dhurwa, Ranchi - 834004 Phone - 0651-2444502
E-mail: jepcranchi1@gmail.com

Tender Notice
E-Tender for Printing and supply/sale of textbooks for the academic year 2027-28
Class I to VIII
Tender No: MRE/33/311/2026-27/4091

Jharkhand Education Project Council (JEPC), Ranchi invites e-bids in two bids system (Technical & Financial) from reputed and eligible printers for the printing and supply/sale of textbooks for class 1 to 8 for the academic year 2027-28. Important dates/details are as under:

Sl. No.	Activity	Start Date	Time	End Date	Time
1	Online availability of bid document	15.10.2026	11.00 am	05.11.2026	03.00 pm
2	Pre-Bid Meeting	22.10.2026	03.00 pm	-	-
3	**Online Bid Submission**	15.10.2026	11.00 am	05.11.2026	03.00 pm
4	Submission of Paper sample	05.11.2026	11.00 am	06.11.2026	01.00 pm
5	Opening of Technical Bid	06.11.2026	03.00 pm	-	-

Interested bidders may view and download bid documents from the website http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in.

Sd/-(Shashi Ranjan)
State Project Director

PR 391804 (Jharkhand Education Project Council)26-27*D

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा

ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना सं0–06 / 2026–27
ई–निविदा प्रसंग–RCD/JAMTARA/844/2026-27

1	कार्य का नाम	Construction of HL Bridge over Local River at Ch. 5+000 Km of Jamtara-Karmatand via Combined Building Road under Road Division, Jamtara for the Year 2026-27
2	प्राक्कलित राशि	रू0 790.19075 लाख (सात करोड़ नब्बे लाख उन्नीस हजार पचहत्तर रूपये) मात्र
3.	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	30 (तीस) महीना
4.	ई–निविदा प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि एंव समय	12.11.2026 के दोपहर 12:00 बजे तक
5	ई–निविदा का वेबसाईट पर प्रकाशन की तिथि एंव समय	22.10.2026 के अपराहन 4:30 बजे से
6.	ई–निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एंव पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता, पथ प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा।
7.	ई–प्रोक्यूरमेंट अधिकारी का संपर्क नं0 / मोबाईल नं0	9279626462
8.	ई–प्रोक्यूरमेंट सेल का संपर्क सहायता नम्बर	**0651-2401010**

नोटः– प्राक्कलित राशि घट–बढ़ सकती हैं। निविदा संबंधी अन्य जानकारी http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है। ह0 / –
कार्यपालक अभियंता ,
PR 391894 (Road)26-27*D पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा

DEPARTMENT OF SPORTS
बिहार सरकार

Address: Secretary Cell, Room No- 416, 4th Floor, Vikas Bhawan,
New Secretariat Building, Patna-800015
Contact Email: secy-sports-bih@gov.in
Request for Proposal (RFP)

RFP No- 5 / खेल 8–18 / 2026

बिहार सरकार के खेल विभाग द्वारा राज्य खेल अकादमी, राजगीर के परिसर में 'स्पोर्ट्स साइंस सेंटर' (उच्च प्रदर्शन खेल प्रशिक्षण एवं इन्जुरी सेंटर) के अधिष्ठापन एवं संचालन, रखरखाव, उपकरण, मानव संसाधन के लिए गुणवत्ता–सह–लागत आधारित चयन (QCBS-Quality-Cum-Cost Based Selection) के माध्यम से एजेंसी का चयन करने के उद्देश्य से प्रतिष्ठित राष्ट्रीय स्तर की कॉर्पोरेट संस्थाओं एवं स्पोर्टस मैनेजमेंट फर्मों से Request for Proposal (RFP) आमंत्रित किए गए है।

इच्छुक एवं पात्र संस्थाओं / फर्मों / एजेंसियाँ RFP दस्तावेज में उल्लेखित पात्रता मानदंडों, तकनीकी आवश्यकताओं एवं अन्य शर्तों का अध्ययन कर निर्धारित समय–सीमा के भीतर ऑनलाइन माध्यम से अपनी RFP प्रस्तुत कर सकते हैं। चयनित एजेंसी राज्य खेल अकादमी, राजगीर के परिसर में 'स्पोर्ट्स साइंस सेंटर' (उच्च प्रदर्शन खेल प्रशिक्षण एवं इन्जुरी सेंटर) के अधिष्ठापन एवं संचालन, रखरखाव, उपकरण, मानव संसाधन से संबंधित कार्यों का निष्पादन करेगी। चयनित एजेंसी 'स्पोर्ट्स साइंस सेंटर' (उच्च प्रदर्शन खेल प्रशिक्षण एवं इन्जुरी सेंटर) के अधिष्ठापन एवं संचालन, रखरखाव, उपकरण, मानव संसाधन की जिम्मेदारी निभाएगी।

RFP के अंतर्गत कार्यों का विस्तृत विवरण, तकनीकी दिशा–निर्देश, सेवा–क्षेत्र (Scope of Work) एवं आपेक्षित डिलिवरेबल्स वेबसाइट **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in** पद पर उपलब्ध हैं।

इच्छुक एवं पात्र एजेंसियाँ दिनांक–16.10.2026 से 23.11.2026 तक निर्धारित अवधि तक प्रस्तुत कर सकते हैं।

(निरंजन कुमार)
संयुक्त सचिव
खेल विभाग, बिहार, पटना

PR- 013815 (Sports) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट//state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

Jharkhand Education Project Council
J.S.C.A Stadium Road, Jagannathpur, Sector -3,
Dhurwa, Ranchi - 834004 Phone - 0651-2444502 E-mail: jepcranchi1@gmail.com

Tender Notice
E-Tender for Printing and supply of textbooks for the academic year 2027-28
Class IX to XII
Tender No: MRE/33/313/2026-27/4090

Jharkhand Education Project Council (JEPC), Ranchi invites e-bids in two bids system (Technical & Financial) from reputed and eligible printers for the printing and supply of textbooks for class 9 to 12 for the academic year 2027-28. Important dates/details are as under:

Sl. No.	Activity	Start Date	Time	End Date	Time
1	Online availability of bid document	15.10.2026	11.00 am	05.11.2026	03.00 pm
2	Pre-Bid Meeting	22.10.2026	03.00 pm	-	-
3	**Online Bid Submission**	15.10.2026	11.00 am	05.11.2026	03.00 pm
4	Submission of Paper sample	05.11.2026	11.00 am	06.11.2026	01.00 pm
5	Opening of Technical Bid	06.11.2026	03.00 pm	-	-

Interested bidders may view and download bid documents from the website http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in.

Sd/-
(Shashi Ranjan)
State Project Director

PR.NO.391807 Jharkhand Education Project Council(26-27):D

Government of Jharkhand
District Engineer, District Board, Simdega.

e-Procurement Tender NoticeNo.01SBD/2026-27
NITNo.-01SBD/2026-27 Date :-14.10.2026

1.	Name of the work	CONSTRUCTION OF PROPOSED MODEL ZILA PARISHAD OFFICE BUILDING, SIMDEGA, JHARKHAND.
2.	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs.**8,01,13,200.00**
3.	T ender Fee and Bid Security	Tender document fee:-INR10000/-(Rupees Ten Thousand Only) Non-Refundable. Bid Security: Rs**1605000.00**(Rupees sixteen Lakh five thousand Only).
4.	Time of Completion	24month
5.	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	23.10.2026at 11:00AM
6.	Start Date of Submission of Bids	23.10.2026(Online)at 11:00AM
8.	Pre Bid Meeting	04.11.2026at 01:30PM
9.	Last Date/Time for receipt of bids Online	19.11.2026(Online)till0 3:00PM
10.	Date andTime of Technical Bid Opening Online.	21.11.2026(Online)from 03:30PM
11.	Name & address of office Inviting tender	**District Engineer, District Board, Simdega Address:Zila Parisad Office Simdega.**
12.	Helpline number of e-Procurement cell	**8083010040**
13.	e-mailid	**simdegazp@gmail.com**

NOTE :-(i) cost of bidding Document (not refundable) & Bid Security (Security Deposit) Shall be payable online through http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.
(ii) Any Change/Information can be seen on Website on http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.
(iii) Any other Information can be seen on Website on http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.

District Engineer,
District Board, Simdega.

PR.NO.391760 Simdega(26-27):D

बिहार सरकार

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
सोन उच्चस्तरीय नहर प्रमण्डल, भभुआ।

अतिअल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या 03/2026-2027
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

1. कार्य का विवरणः–

क्र सं0.	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रू0 में)	अग्रधन की राशि (रू0 में) (ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय)	परिमाण–विपत्र का मूल्य (अप्रत्यर्पणी) (केवल ऑनलाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू0 में	बेल्ट्रॉन को देय बिड प्रोसेसिंग फी (अप्रत्यर्पणी) (केवल ऑनलाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू0 में	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	अभियुक्ति
01	सोन उच्चस्तरीय नहर प्रमंडल, भभुआ अन्तर्गत सुअरा बाया नहर के 1.60 कि0मी0 (बार्यो) पर Box Culvert का जिर्णोद्धार कार्य।	49.80	99600.00	5000.00	1000.00	20.03.2027	

2. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता :– कार्यपालक अभियंता, सोन उच्चस्तरीय नहर प्रमंडल,भभुआ। मो0–9304561983
3. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि :– 13.10.2026
4. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधिः– 29.10.2026 से 04.11.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपहरान् तक। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
5. प्री–बीड मीटिंग का समय स्थान एवं तिथि :– दिनांक 02.11.2026, समय 3:00 बजे अपराहन में, अधीक्षण अभियंता का कार्यालय, सिंचाई अंचल, भभुआ के कार्यालय कक्ष में।
6. तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक 06.11.2026 समय 3:30 बजे अपराहन। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
7. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोशित की जायेगी (सिर्फ वेबसाईट ww.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
8. निविदा खोलने का स्थान :– www.eproc2.bihar.gov.inपर
9. निविदा की वैधता अवधि :– 120 दिन
10. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in एवं wrd.bihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
सोन उच्चस्तरीय नहर प्रमण्डल, भभुआ

विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
PR. No.013702 (WRD) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

Uttar Pradesh New and Renewable Energy Development Agency (UPNEDA)
(Deptt. of Additional Sources of Energy, Govt. of U.P.)
Vibhuti Khand, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow, U.P. - 226010 Tel. No. 0522-2720652,
Telefax: 0522-2720779, 2720829, Website: www.upneda.org.in, Email: compneda@rediffmail.com

UPNEDA

Opportunity for Investors & Project Developers for setting up Floating Solar Projects

Online Applications can be made by Investors/Project Developers for allotment of identified Dams/Reservoirs for setting up Floating Solar Projects.

Key information for the application is as follows :

(a)	Dam/Reservoir lease charges for public sector	Rs. 1/Acre/year
(b)	Dam/Reservoir lease charges for private sector	Rs. 15000/Acre/year
(c)	Link for Standard Operating Procedure (S.O.P) and Govt. order No. 372/87 dated 14.03.2024	https://solar.upneda.in https://upneda.org.in
(d)	Online Registration Fee	Rs. 23600.00 (including Taxes)

Detailed application & proposals will be evaluated on First Come First Serve basis according to the standard Operating Procedure (S.O.P) dated 28.03.2025 & 30.07.2026 and Govt. order No.372/87 dated 14.03.2024

Note. All applications submitted till the last day of each month will be considered as one group. Evaluation will be done on a monthly basis.

Nodal officer Details: Sh. Narendra Singh, Senior Project Officer-II,
Mob No: 94156 09007

Director, UPNEDA

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice-Kota Division-Civil Engineering
No-W.623/15 Dt. 13.10.2026

Sr.Divisional Engineer (Coordination), West Central Railway, Kota for and on behalf of President of Union of India invites following open E. tenders. **Sr.No.01-Tender No.-**182-2026, **Description of work-**Kota Division: Comprehensive repair of facade, Administrative building, conference room & section offices and Construction of male changing room and rooms above PPIO in' Electric Loco Shed Tughlakabad. **Approx. Cost-**2,70,53,921.90, **Earnest Money-**5,41,100.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 30.10.2026, **Sr.No.02-Tender No.-**183-2026, **Description of work-**Kota Division: Improvement of Utsav railway institute located in Tughlakabad. **Approx. Cost-**70,66,905.33, **Earnest Money-**1,41,300.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 27.10.2026, **Sr.No.03-Tender No.-**189-2026, **Description of work-**Provision of new type II quaters (SGZ-6, GOH-04, LNR-04) On replacement account in ADEN/SGZ section. **Approx. Cost-**2,90,94,338.77, **Earnest Money-**5,81,900.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 30.10.2026, **Sr.No.04-Tender No.-**190-2026R, **Description of work-**Kota Division: Cleaning of Manhole, inspection chamber, dug well, septik tank and sewage line in Railway colony & ELS TKD at Tughlkabad for 3 years. **Approx. Cost-**8,48,667.77, **Earnest Money-**17,000.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026, **Sr.No.05-Tender No.-**191-2026, **Description of work-**MAKHOLI-MATHURA -Section -TRR(P)-4.307 kms with 60kg rails, TTR(FS) - 06 sets, TFR - 11.604 Kms and TFR(R) - 1.934 kms. **Approx. Cost-**90,45,679.51, **Earnest Money-**1,80,900.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026, **Sr.No.06-Tender No.-**192-2026, **Description of work-**(1) Replacement of old/dilapidated type-II quarters (RNT-04 No., RWJ-04 No total 08 No.) at KOTA -SWM Section. (2) SWM- Improvement of SRH and ORH at SWM., (3) Construction of service building for railway Magistrate court / offices at SWM station.(4) Improvement to road Latiya nallah to TRD colony at SWM railway colony. **Approx. Cost-**3,02,02,371.70, **Earnest Money-**6,04,100.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026, **Sr.No.07-Tender No.-**193-2026, **Description of work-**NAD-KOTA Section: Improvement to track drainage system by provision of RCC drain along the track between Alaniya-Daddevi stations under the jurisdiction of ADEN-RMA. **Approx. Cost-**3,88,77,259.46, **Earnest Money-**7,77,600.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026, **Sr.No.08-Tender No.-**194-2026, **Description of work-**GAROTH DEPOT :- Supply of 100000 cum. 65mm. size machine crushed stone ballast of approved quality and loading into hoppers/wagon at. **Approx. Cost-**6,66,76,096.00, **Earnest Money-**13,33,500.00, **Last Date and Time of Submission of Tender-**15.30 Hrs. on date 03.11.2026. Complete details are available in the E- tender notice uploaded on the railway web site www.ireps.gov.in and also placed on the notice board of the Sr. Divisional Engineer (Coordination), DRM Office, West Central Railway Kota's office.

(SD.)
Sr. Divisional Engineer (Coordination) WCR/KOTA

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान, एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

Directorate of Urban Transport
Room No.305, 3rd Floor *Urban Training & Research Centre & Directorate of Local Bodies*
Sector - 7, Gomti Nagar Extension, Lucknow: 226 002

DIRECTORATE URBAN TRANSPORT
Government of Uttar Pradesh

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

Procurement, Supply, Operation and Maintenance of 1225 Electric Buses under the Gross Cost Contract (GCC) Model

- Fleet Size: **1225**; 9m (725 Nos.) & 12m (500 Nos.);
- Coverage: 18 major Urban Areas;
- Infrastructure: Maintenance Depot & Behind-the-Meter infra by the Authority;
- Concession Period: 12 Years;
- Purchase Subsidy: ₹35.00 Lakhs per 9m Bus and ₹40.00 Lakhs per 12m Bus;
- Payment Security: Revolving Letter of Credit equivalent to 3 Months' O&M Fee and Escrow coverage equivalent to 3 Months' O&M Fee;
- 100% Non-Fare Box Revenue for the Operator

Download the RFP Document
October 15, 2026 onwards
https://etender.up.nic

Bid Due Date: November 26, 2026

For clarifications
Directorate of Urban Transport
Room No.305, 3rd Floor, Urban Training & Research Centre and Directorate of Local Bodies,
Sector - 7, Gomti Nagar Extension, Lucknow: 226 002

Contact persons
Dr. Ajit.K.Singh: 94150 49719
Manoj Panda: 98719 79370
Vivek Yadav: 96310 06600

Join the Pre-Bid Meeting
October 27, 2026; 15.00 hrs.
The meeting link is provided below:
https://us02web.zoom.us/j/82750286022?pwd=XSCtgH2Jld3fG5uaWeTr1OHYau02X5.1
Meeting ID: 827 5028 6022; Passcode: 122189

UPID No.: 258326 R.O. Dt: 14/10/2026 Website: www.up.gov.in

The Directorate reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids or to annul the bidding process without assigning any reason thereof

ई–प्रोक्योरमेन्ट सेल,
पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता विभाग, झारखण्ड, राँची

ई–प्रोक्योरमेन्ट सूचना, (प्रथम आमंत्रण)

Tender reference No- DWSD/Dhanbad-2/14/2026-27 दिनांक – 14.10.2026

ग्रुप सं0	विवरणी	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रू0 में)	अग्रधन की राशि (लाख रू0 में)	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (रूपये में)
1	Extension of pipeline 100 mm. DI-K-7 in Nagrikala South Panchayat Nagrikala village in Baghmara block of Dhanbad district under D.W.& S.Div No-2, Dhanbad.	286.14605	2.87	10,000.00
2	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	6 Months		
3	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि –	17/10/2026 / 4:00 PM		
4	प्री–बिड बैठक का स्थान एवं तिथि	23/10/2026 / 11:30 AM Office of the Engineer in-Chief D.W & S Department, Nepal House, Doranda Ranchi-2.		
5	बिड प्राप्ति के लिए अन्तिम तिथि / समय	30/10/2026 up to 4:00PM		
6	सरकार के सचिव, सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी एवं ई–गवर्नेस,झारखण्ड मंत्रालय, के ज्ञापांक 120 दिनांक 03.10.2023 के आलोक में विपत्र का मूल्य एवं अग्रधन की राशि **Online** जमा करने की अन्तिम तिथि एवं समय	30/10/2026 up to 4:00PM		
7	तकनीकी बिड खोलने का तिथि / समय	02/11//2026 up to 4:00PM		
8	निविदा प्रकाशित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमण्डल सं0–2, धनबाद।		
9	प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क संख्या	**7292898986**		
10	ई–प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट सेल का हेल्पलाईन संख्या	**0651-248045**		

- किसी भी प्रकार का बदलाव http://Jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।
- अन्य किसी भी प्रकार का बदलाव http://Jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।
- निविदा में प्राक्कलित राशि घट–बढ सकती है। तत्पश्चात अग्रधन की राशि मान्य होगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
PR 391839 Drinking Water and Sanitation(26-27)#D पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमण्डल संख्या–2, धनबाद

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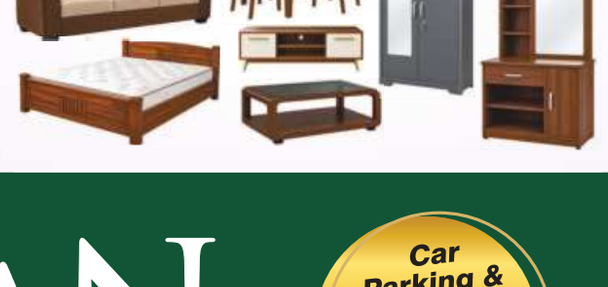

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INBRIEF

Arlekar assumes office as full-time Governor of T.N.

Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar, who earlier served as Governor of Keralam, took charge as the full-time Governor of Tamil Nadu at Lok Bhavan in Chennai on Thursday, following his appointment to the gubernatorial office by President Droupadi Murmu. While serving as Governor of Keralam, Mr. Arlekar had been additionally discharging the duties of the Governor of Tamil Nadu since March 5, after then Governor of Tamil Nadu R.N. Ravi was appointed Governor of West Bengal. Sajjansingh R. Chavan, Secretary to the Governor, and officials of Lok Bhavan were present on the occasion. Later in the day, Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay met Mr. Arlekar and extended his greetings on his assumption of office as Governor of Tamil Nadu.

Secure release of fishers held in the Maldives: CM to Centre

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Thursday wrote to External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar, seeking his intervention to secure the release of 25 fishermen from Thoothukudi, who had been arrested by the Maldives Coast Guard. In his letter, the Chief Minister said the fishermen, sailing on three mechanised boats, were apprehended by the Maldives Coast Guard in the early hours of October 13. He requested the External Affairs Minister to take up the matter with the Maldivian government through diplomatic channels, and facilitate the early release and safe repatriation of the fishermen and their boats.

Governor, CM pay tributes to Kalam on birth anniversary

Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Thursday paid tributes to former President A.P.J. Abdul Kalam on his birth anniversary. Quoting the Governor in a post on X, Lok Bhavan said, "Dr. Kalam's remarkable contributions to India's space and defence programmes strengthened the nation's scientific capabilities and self-reliance. Fondly remembered as the 'People's President' and the 'Missile Man of India', he inspired generations through his humility, dedication, and unwavering commitment to the nation." In his tribute, Mr. Vijay recalled the former President's simplicity, integrity, and contribution to India's scientific progress. He said Kalam had inspired students and young people, and guided them in their pursuit of their aspirations. Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar and Ministers P. Venkataramanan, Rajmohan, and J. Mohamed Farvas paid tributes to Kalam's statue and his portrait on the Anna University premises.

SC holds that conversion does not automatically grant quota benefits

A person who converts from a Hindu social order to a non-Hindu social order cannot claim affirmative action under Article 16(4) of the Constitution merely on the basis of the social backwardness associated with his pre-conversion status, says court, dismissing an appeal filed by Tamil Nadu govt.

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday declared that a Hindu belonging to a Backward order cannot claim the same reservation benefits as a Muslim Backward Class member, merely on conversion to Islam or other religions.

"A person who converts from a Hindu social order to a non-Hindu social order cannot claim affirmative action under Article 16 (4) of the Constitution merely on the basis of the social backwardness associated with his pre-conversion status," it held.

The court clarified the law while dismissing a Tamil Nadu government appeal seeking confirmation of an order issued by the State government in March 2024 to provide reservation benefits to members of the Backward Classes, Most Backward Classes, De-notified communities, and Scheduled Castes who had embraced Islam. The policy of the State was intended to create a level-playing field by preserving affirmative action despite the change of religion.

A Bench headed by Justice Prashant Kumar Mishra held that a member of a Backward Hindu community does not automatically become a member of a notified Backward Muslim community merely through conversion.

It said a caste identity cannot be treated as an immutable personal attribute, irrespective of a change in religious affiliation. It said the constitutional benefits of reservation under Article 16(4) cannot be made to travel from the religion in which the backwardness arose to a religion of which the basic theological structure did not recognise caste as its foundational basis.

"No statutory benefit, protection, reservation or other entitlement under Article 16(4) of the Constitution, the enjoyment of which is predicated upon a particular Hindu social order, can be claimed or extended merely on the basis of such antecedent membership after the person has converted to Islam, Christianity or any other non-Hindu social order. Conversion severs the legal foundation of an entitlement specifically conditioned upon membership of that Hindu social order," the court held.

The court says a caste identity cannot be treated as an immutable personal attribute, irrespective of a change in religious affiliation.

The State's appeal was based on a Madras High Court decision to reject the petition of Sameer Ahamed, a convert to Islam. The Thoothukudi resident, born to Hindu parents, changed his faith to Islam in 2015. He was issued a certificate of conversion by the Sunnath Jamath. He had subsequently applied for a community certificate certifying him as 'Muslim Lebbai', but the request was declined by the Tahsildar.

Confirming the High Court's decision to deny him quota benefits, the top court explained that the identity of a Backward Class Muslim community was historically constituted by social membership. A mere declaration of conversion cannot be treated as proof of such membership. "A Jamath may certify that a person has embraced Islam. However, it cannot, merely by issuing a testimonial, conclusively determine a statutory Backward Class status," Justice Mishra, who authored the judgment, held.

'Fundamental defect'

Justice Mishra said the fundamental defect in the March 2024 government order was that it treated the historical disadvantage of a person in one religion as sufficient proof of membership of a particular Backward Class in another religion.

The government order did not explain why a Hindu belonging to one Backward Class community or a Most Backward Class community or a De-notified Community or a Scheduled Caste should, upon conversion to Islam, became a member of one or another of seven pre-existing Backward Muslim communities, he said.

Besides, the court said that a Scheduled Caste status of a person could neither be altered nor recreated by a mere executive order of a State. The Scheduled Caste status was specifically governed by Article 341, which mandated that only the President could notify a group as Scheduled Caste.

Besides, the court pointed out that Paragraph 3 of the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950, expressly provided that a person professing a religion other than Hinduism, Sikhism or Buddhism would not be considered a member of a Scheduled Caste. "Thus, upon conversion to a religion outside those specified in Paragraph 3, a person cannot continue to claim Scheduled Caste status merely by reference to his caste of origin. Consequently, upon conversion to a religion not specified therein, such person ceases to possess the Scheduled Caste status," the court said.

Northeast monsoon arrives early in Tamil Nadu

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The wait for Tamil Nadu's major rainy season is over, with the Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC) in Chennai on Thursday declaring the onset of the Northeast monsoon, five days earlier than its normal date of arrival, and coinciding with the withdrawal of the Southwest monsoon.

The RMC has issued an orange alert for six districts, including the Nilgiris and Madurai, forecasting heavy to very heavy rainfall of up to 20 cm on Friday. Heavy rainfall may occur at isolated places in various coastal and interior districts. Wet weather will prevail till October 21, with heavy rainfall in some places.

RMC officials said the monsoon arrival was declared as it fulfilled various criteria, including the onset of northeasterly winds and fairly widespread rainfall across the State.

While the Southwest monsoon ended with a 20% rainfall deficit in Tamil Nadu, the Northeast monsoon is forecast to bring normal rainfall. The Delta and southern regions have a reason to be optimistic, with above-normal rainfall forecast for these areas. While the north coastal areas may receive normal rainfall, north interior areas could see below-normal rainfall.

Bracing for rain: The RMC has issued an orange alert for six districts, forecasting heavy to very heavy rainfall on Friday. C. VENKATACHALAPATHY

V.R. Durai, head of the Regional Weather Forecasting Centre, RMC, said that while El Niño was expected to strengthen further this year, its impact on rainfall in Tamil Nadu would also depend on other climatic factors, including weather systems in the Bay of Bengal and cyclone tracks.

"The Bay of Bengal churns out fewer cyclones and low-pressure areas during El Niño years, even though it is associated with above-normal rainfall. Strong El Niño conditions would prevail till February, after which it may begin to lose strength," he said.

On forecasts of extreme weather events, he said such events cannot be predicted a month ahead under the current circumstances, as atmospheric conditions changed with each passing day. While coastal areas could face severe weather events, weather tools cannot estimate the exact amount of extreme rainfall well in advance, he said.

A few coastal areas, including Karaikal, Puducherry, and Nagapattinam, fell within the zone of uncertainty in model predictions, he said.

Meanwhile, meteorologists said an early monsoon onset does not offer significant advantage in terms of seasonal rainfall. Y.E.A. Raj, former Deputy Director-General of Meteorology, said an early onset, seven or eight days ahead of schedule, does not guarantee good rainfall.

Citing weather data since 1901, he said that in the 12 years when the Northeast monsoon set in between October 1 and 10, Tamil Nadu received above-normal rainfall in only half of those years, including 1996 and 1977. However, in the six years when the monsoon set in late in November, including 2000 and 1992, Tamil Nadu ended the season with a rainfall deficit, he added.

'All steps taken'

Minister for Revenue and Disaster Management K.A. Sengottaiyan on Thursday said the Tamil Nadu government had taken all precautionary measures for the Northeast monsoon.

Speaking to reporters at Ezhilagam in Chennai, Mr. Sengottaiyan said his department had conducted a series of review meetings on monsoon preparedness, and nearly 98% of the preparedness works had been completed.

Hospitals and medical facilities had been kept ready. The preparedness of Amma Unavagams to provide food, and educational institutions designated as rehabilitation centres, had also been reviewed, he said.

In Chennai, a team of Ministers headed by Minister for Public Works Aadhav Arjuna had been appointed to oversee monsoon preparedness and rescue efforts in various zones. IAS officers had also been appointed to coordinate the efforts in all 15 zones, he said.

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Thursday inspected the flood mitigation and desilting works being undertaken at Captain Cotton Canal in Vyasarpadi, and at the confluence of Otteri Nullah and Buckingham Canal in the Basin Bridge area.

M.K. Stalin

Stalin urges TVK govt. to appeal against SC judgment on BC quota for converts

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Thursday urged the Tamil Nadu government to file a Special Leave Petition (SLP) in the Supreme Court to protect the reservation for members of the Backward Classes (BC) who had converted to Islam.

"Social backwardness does not arise in a day or a generation. It is the result of a social system built over thousands of years. Conversion to another religion does not erase it," he said in a statement.

Mr. Stalin said the Supreme Court's order on Thursday, upholding a Madras High Court verdict denying reservation to Hindu BC members who had converted to Islam, was contrary to the principle of social justice.

He said the former DMK government, under the 'Dravidian Model', had adopted a resolution seeking reservation for Adi Dravidars who had converted to Christianity, and called for an amendment to the Constitution. "The TVK government should carry forward these efforts," he said.

On price rise

Mr. Stalin said Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, who had visited London, Andhra Pradesh, and Karnataka, should also visit local markets and grocery shops to understand price rise.

"Please do not ask the Food Minister. He will say everything is normal," he said in a social media post.

INDIA bloc leaders from Tamil Nadu stage protest against SIR, seek CEC's resignation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The leaders of the INDIA bloc in Tamil Nadu staged a protest in Chennai on Thursday, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and the restoration of eligible voters removed during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls. They alleged that SIR threatened democratic rights, and called for the agitation to be expanded across the State.

Addressing the protest, School Education Minister Rajmohan said his party, the TVK, had opposed SIR even before coming to power, and had challenged the exercise in the Supreme Court. He said the party had consistently opposed the removal of voters, including 97 lakh in Tamil Nadu.

United stand: Leaders of INDIA bloc parties staging the protest at Egmore in Chennai on Thursday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Citing the principle of inclusive democracy, he alleged that women, young people, members of oppressed communities and first-time voters had been disproportionately affected. He said various political parties had to sustain their unity to protect voting rights and democratic institutions.

Tamil Nadu Congress Committee president Manickam Tagore said the INDIA bloc would expand the protest across the State after consultations.

TVK's participation

He said the alliance brought together parties that had different ideologies and histories, but were united by the need to protect democracy and seek the withdrawal of SIR. He also welcomed the TVK's participation in the protest, saying it had strengthened the alliance.

VCK president Thol. Thirumavalavan said the protest was part of a wider struggle to protect the Constitution and democracy. He demanded that the CEC resign, and the eligible voters removed from the rolls be reinstated. He alleged that the deletions had disproportionately affected marginalised communities, and accused the establishment of using the process to undermine its political opponents.

MDMK general secretary Vaiko said the removal of voters amounted to an attack on the foundations of democracy. Terming the protest a warning to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah, he said it would continue until the CEC was removed from office.

CPI(M) State secretary P. Shanmugam condemned the police action against protesters in Delhi. Questioning the scale of deletions, he sought the restoration of eligible voters' names, and said every citizen who had attained the age of 18 must be guaranteed the right to vote.

CPI State secretary M. Veerapandian, Social Welfare Minister Vanni Arasu, Pazha. Asaithambi of the CPI (M-L) Liberation, and former MLA K.A.M. Muhammed Abubacker of the Indian Union Muslim League also participated in the protest.

'Had warned Stalin of targeted deletion of voters in Kolathur'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

VCK president Thol. Thirumavalavan on Thursday said he had raised the possibility of targeted deletion of voters in the Kolathur constituency with former Chief Minister and DMK president M.K. Stalin, weeks before the 2026 Assembly election.

The VCK leader said Mr. Stalin, however, assured him that the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise was being conducted properly.

More than one lakh voters had been removed from the electoral rolls in Kolathur, of whom around 20,000 were classified as deceased, while the remaining names were deleted under categories such as 'permanently shifted' or 'duplicate entries', Mr. Thirumavalavan said at the INDIA bloc protest in Chennai on Thursday.

He said a woman had contacted him and warned him that a conspiracy was under way, and that Mr. Stalin could find it difficult to win from Kolathur.

After she repeated the warning, Mr. Thirumavalavan said he facilitated a conversation between her and former Minister P.K. Sekarbabu. Later, he raised the issue directly with Mr. Stalin, he said.

"I am recounting this not to accuse any individual, but to explain that the warning had reached us several weeks before the election," he said, alleging that the deletions indicated a targeted action.

INBRIEF

University of Liverpool opens campus in Bengaluru

Around 300 students have enrolled across six undergraduate (UG) and two postgraduate (PG) programmes at the University of Liverpool in Bengaluru, which was inaugurated on Thursday. Speaking to *The Hindu*, Tim Jones, Vice-Chancellor, University of Liverpool, said, "Our partnerships with universities and institutions in the city, including the NIMHANS, the Indian Institute of Science (IISc) and Hindustan Unilever, are longstanding."

Kerala HC suspends sentence of former DGP in assets case

The Kerala High Court on Thursday suspended the sentence imposed on former Director General of Police (DGP) Tomin J. Thachankary by the Vigilance Court, Kottayam, in an assets case and granted him bail. The trial court had found him guilty of amassing assets disproportionate to his declared sources of income and sentenced him to four years' rigorous imprisonment. In his appeal, the former DGP said the prosecution had miscalculated his income from other sources.

APSRTC deploys 425 buses to Tirumala for Garuda Seva

In a bid to increase the fleet strength and provide ease of commute to the devotees, the Andhra Pradesh State Road Transport Corporation (APSRTC) on Thursday announced the deployment of 425 buses to make 6,354 trips on the Tirumala ghat roads on Friday, when the most sought-after Garuda Seva will be performed as part of the ongoing Navaratri Brahmotsavams. Officials expect a 20-25% rise in passenger traffic for the current Brahmotsavam.

Kerala HC dismisses pleas by Pinarayi, kin in CMRL case

Division Bench rejects their applications against the Single Judge's direction to register an FIR; the order has not affected the applicants' right to pursue constitutional or statutory remedies, it says

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

A Division Bench of the Kerala High Court on Thursday dismissed the pleas filed by former Keralam Chief Minister and current Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan, his daughter T. Veena and son-in-law and former Minister P.A. Mohamed Riyas to file an appeal against a Single Judge's direction to register an FIR against them in the ₹278-crore CMRL-Exalogic payoff case.

Rejecting the applications against the directive issued by the Single Judge on October 9, a Bench of Justice K. Natarajan and Justice Johnson John held that the order has not affected the applicants' right to pursue their constitutional or statutory remedies against the registration of the FIR.

Legal setback: Pinarayi Vijayan and others can approach the Supreme Court against the Kerala High Court order.

"The accused in a corruption case have no legal right to be heard before registering the FIR. They are also not entitled to demand a preliminary inquiry before registering an FIR in a corruption case," the court said. The Division Bench had on Wednesday reserved its order on the pleas. The court had held that it would not stay the operation of the impugned order before deciding whether to allow the appeal, stating that it had to follow the prescribed procedure before considering a stay.

Two options left

Mr. Vijayan and others are left with two legal options: challenging the registration of the FIR against them for allegedly amassing wealth, or approaching the Supreme Court against the Kerala High Court order denying them leave to challenge a Single Judge's order directing the registration of an FIR against them.

Kumaraswamy challenges police to question him in 'sting operation' probe

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Union Minister for Heavy Industries and Steel H.D. Kumaraswamy on Thursday accused Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar of being the "*pitamaha*" (grand patriarch) of the alleged sting operation controversy and demanded that the police question him first in the investigation into a video linking former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah to the episode.

A day after the Central Crime Branch (CCB) picked up, among others, a member of the JD(S) social media wing for questioning, Mr. Kumaraswamy met Bengaluru Police Commissioner and accused the Chief Minister, Home Minister Priyank Kharge, and the police of targeting the party's social media workers. Instead of arresting the party workers, he asked the police to arrest him and conduct the probe.

Responding to Mr. Kharge's reported remark on Wednesday that he, too, could be questioned as part of the investigation, Mr. Kumaraswamy challenged the police to begin their inquiry with him.

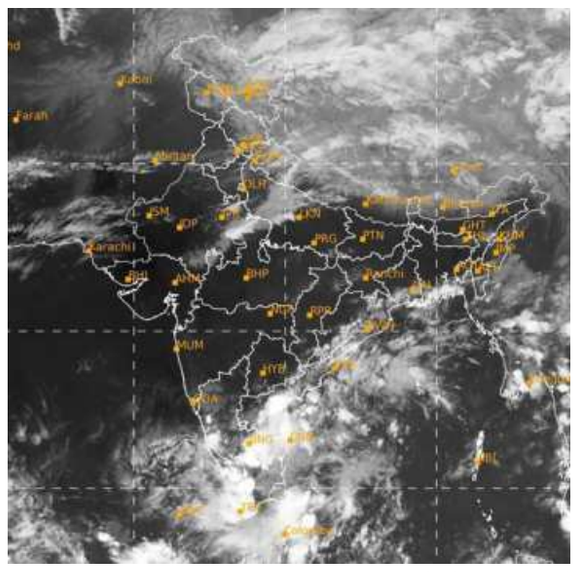
'Private meeting'

Earlier in the day, at the JD (S) headquarters in Bengaluru, Mr. Kumaraswamy sought an investigation by a sitting judge of the High Court into the controversy. He named Rakesh Shetty and Krupa Alwa in connection with the alleged sting operation and claimed that it had been carried out at the behest of Mr. Shivakumar.

On Sunday Mr. Kumaraswamy accused Mr. Shivakumar of holding a "lengthy, private meeting" with a person allegedly involved in "sting operations" in Bengaluru. He had also claimed that the Chief Minister subsequently warned five Cabinet colleagues about such operations.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Friday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Keralam and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Rajasthan, Delhi, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha, Telangana, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Lakshadweep

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	34.6	24.8	Kurnool	—	37.5	25.8
Ahmedabad	—	38.1	26.6	Lucknow	—	33.2	22.0
Aizawl	—	30.5	22.0	Madurai	4	32.0	24.5
Bengaluru	1	31.7	21.4	Mangaluru	—	33.5	26.0
Bhopal	—	32.8	17.6	Mumbai	—	37.9	24.2
Bhubaneswar	—	33.0	24.6	Mysuru	—	31.6	20.0
Chandigarh	1.8	29.2	21.0	New Delhi	—	28.3	23.3
Chennai	1.5	32.9	25.9	Patna	—	33.9	25.5
Coimbatore	—	34.6	24.2	Port Blair	3.7	31.0	25.4
Dehradun	—	24.2	18.3	Prayagraj	—	35.2	23.0
Gangtok	—	22.0	13.7	Puducherry	0.6	30.8	25.2
Goa	—	36.4	23.3	Pune	—	35.0	20.0
Guwahati	—	33.5	22.8	Raipur	—	33.4	24.4
Hubballi	—	33.0	23.0	Ranchi	—	31.4	20.0
Hyderabad	—	34.4	23.5	Shillong	—	26.0	16.4
Imphal	—	30.3	16.7	Shimla	—	23.8	14.9
Jaipur	—	34.1	24.2	Srinagar	16.4	17.4	7.3
Kochi	4	29.8	26.4	Thiruvananthapuram	—	32.5	25.0
Kohima	—	22.5	13.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	34.1	25.1
Kolkata	—	33.6	26.7	Vijayawada	—	32.5	26.0
Kozhikode	—	35.2	27.9	Visakhapatnam	35	31.3	25.4

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.12	..48	64	... 123	...175	
Bengaluru	.21	..34	48	 60	...124	
Chennai	...6	..13	54	 46	56	
Delhi	.37	..57	14	... 205	...172	
Hyderabad	...1	3	23	 97	...101	
Kolkata	...6	..50	36	 67	93	
Lucknow	...9	..32	34	... 193	...114	
Mumbai	...9	..53	56	... 102	...151	
Pune	.18	..98	47	... 139	...137	
Visakhapatnam	...5	..30	23	 8	20	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Gajraula, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 244 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir recorded a healthy AQI score of 19

Air Quality Code: Poor | Moderate | Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

BRS alleges '₹3,000-cr. scam' in coal imports in Telangana

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) working president K.T. Rama Rao has accused Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy of deliberately mismanaging coal production at Singareni Collieries Company Limited (SCCL) to create a demand for expensive foreign coal imports, alleging that the proposed procurement could lead to a ₹3,000-crore scam.

In an letter addressed to Mr. Reddy, Deputy Chief Minister Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka and Union Coal Minister G. Kishan Reddy, Mr. Rao demanded an independent probe into the proposed imports and called for full disclosure of the discussions, tender documents, draft agreements, pricing and the selection of the logistics firm being considered for the assignment.

K.T. Rama Rao

He alleged that the proposed arrangement could involve commissions of ₹1,500 a tonne, potentially translating into a ₹3,000 crore scam. Pointing out that the imports had not yet taken place, he demanded that all financial arrangements and procurement decisions be made public before the process advanced.

Mr. Rao questioned the decline in SCCL's coal production from about 70.02 million tonnes in 2023-24 to nearly 58 million tonnes in 2025-26. He sought an explanation from the government for its alleged failure to strengthen domestic production, develop mines and ensure adequate coal supplies despite the anticipated growth in electricity demand.

Mr. Rao also demanded a white paper on foreign coal procurement and detailed report on Singareni's declining production.

Keralam asks govt. to accept State's revised ESA proposal

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Keralam Assembly on Thursday unanimously passed a resolution demanding that the Union Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change accept the State government's revised Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA) proposal.

The resolution urged the Union government to issue the final notification on ESA in the Western Ghats only after considering the amendment proposal submitted by the State government so as to safeguard the interests of the people of the State.

Turn *Lakhpati Didis* into *Crorepati Didis*, says President at Saras Mela

G.V.R. Subba Rao
VIJAYAWADA

President Droupadi Murmu on Thursday called for transforming *Lakhpati Didis* (a government initiative designed to economically empower rural women by helping them earn a sustainable annual household income of ₹1 lakh or more) into *Crorepati Didis*.

Inaugurating the National SARAS Mela in Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh, the first being held outside New Delhi, she said Self-Help Groups (SHGs) had played a significant role in strengthening the rural economy and empowering women.

The President expressed confidence that India could achieve its goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047, or even earlier, through women's empowerment and the collective efforts of the Centre and State governments.

Backing ambition: Droupadi Murmu interacts with *Lakhpati Didis* as she visits stalls at the National SARAS Mela in Vijayawada. PTI

Thanking Union Agriculture and Rural Development Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan and Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu for organising the fair alongside the 'Lakhpati Didi Mela' during Dasara, she expressed hope that similar events would be held across the country.

During the inaugural event, Mr. Chouhan and Mr. Naidu highlighted the role of women's SHGs in promoting rural entrepreneurship and economic empowerment. Mr. Chouhan said the Centre was working towards creating six crore *Lakhpati Didis* across the country, with over 3.5 crore women having already achieved the target of earning at least ₹1 lakh annually.

Andhra Pradesh accounted for 23 lakh *Lakhpati Didis* against a target of 60 lakh, he said, calling for efforts to help women progress towards becoming *Crorepati Didis*.

Mr. Naidu called for SHGs to evolve from savings groups into business enterprises and eventually establish international brands.

WALK-IN INTERVIEW

Rajiv Gandhi Centre for Aquaculture (RGCA) a society under the Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) propose to conduct walk-in-interview **on 29/10/2026** for engaging **Lab Trainees under SC/ST scheme** and **Young Professional-I**.
For details, log on to **www.rgca.co.in.**

DIRECTOR i/c, MPEDA - RGCA

JNCASR
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Corrigendum-01 has been issued against **Tender No. CE/CON/NK/MB/2026/03**. For details please visit **www.ireps.gov.in**.

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CORRIGENDUM-01 & 02 FOR TENDER NOTICE NO.: CON/2026/SEP/03

Corrigendum No. 01&02 for Tender Notice No. CON/2026/SEP/03, dated: 08-10-2026 against **Tender No. CE-CON-DK-PW-2026-08** has been published. For details please visit in website **www.ireps.gov.in**.

Chief Engineer/Con/Nagaland Project/Maligaon
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ELECTRICAL GENERAL WORKS

Tender Notice No: EL/29/68_2026/K/1553; **Dated:** 10-10-2026. E-Tender are invited by the undersigned for the following work; **Tender No.:** 68_2026. **Name of Work** : (A) Electrical General work in connection with S&T work "Conversion of Relay Based Interlocking to Electronic Interlocking at Siliguri Town (SGUT) Station of Katihar Division (Balance Installation Under Priority Category-3)". (B) Electrical General work in connection with S&T work "Provision of Distributed Type Electronic Interlocking System at Siliguri Station of Katihar Division". **Tender Value:** ₹1,18,71,636/-; **Earnest Money:** ₹2,37,400/-; Date & time of **closing** of tender at **15:00** hrs. and **opening** of tender at **15:30** hrs. on **03-11-2026**. Complete information alongwith tender document of above e-tender are available in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

Sr. DEE (G&Chg.), Katihar
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बिहार सरकार

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
घोड़ासहन नहर प्रमण्डल, रक्सौल
Email-ID :eegcdraxaul@gmail.com Mob- 7463889660
अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–02 / SBD / 2026–27
राष्ट्रीय स्पर्द्धा निविदा आमंत्रण
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार बेबसाईट https://eproc2bihar.gov.in पर)
–:शुद्धि पत्र:– 02

इस कार्यालय का पत्रांक–1317, दिनांक–29.09.2026 के द्वारा अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–02 / SBD / 2026–27 जिसका PR No.-012945(WRD)2026-27 के माध्यम से दैनिक समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित किया गया है के अंतर्गत क्र0 सं0– 04 एवं 06 को अपरिहार्य कारणवश निम्न प्रकार से संशोधन किया जाता है–

क्र0 सं0	विवरणी	पूर्व में निर्धारित अवधि	संशोधित अवधि
04	निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक–10.10.2026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाहन से दिनांक : 14.10.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराहन तक	दिनांक : 10.10.2026, 10:30 बजे पूर्वाहन से दिनांक : 22.10.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराहन तक
06	तकनिकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक :–16.10.2026 समय 03:30 बजे अपराहन	दिनांक :–24.10.2026 समय 03:30 बजे अपराहन

निविदा की अन्य सभी नियम एवं शर्तें यथावत् रहेंगी।
कार्यपालक अभियंता
घोड़ासहन नहर प्रमंडल रक्सौल

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बिहार सरकार

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
त्रिवेणी नहर प्रमण्डल, रक्सौल
Email-ID :eeraxaul@gmail.com
अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–02 / SBD / 2026–27
राष्ट्रीय स्पर्द्धा निविदा आमंत्रण
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार बेबसाईट https://eproc2bihar.gov.in पर)
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इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक–1459, दिनांक–29.09.2026 के द्वारा अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–02 / SBD / 2026–27 जिसका PR No.- 012948 (WRD) 2026-27 के माध्यम से दैनिक समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित किया गया है के अंतर्गत क्र0 सं0– 04 एवं 06 को अपरिहार्य कारणवश निम्न प्रकार से संशोधन किया जाता है–

क्र0 सं0	विवरणी	पूर्व में निर्धारित अवधि	संशोधित अवधि
04	निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक–10.10.2026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाहन से दिनांक : 14.10.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराहन तक	दिनांक : 10.10.2026, 10:30 बजे पूर्वाहन से दिनांक : 22.10.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराहन तक
06	तकनिकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक :–16.10.2026 समय 03:30 बजे अपराहन	दिनांक :–24.10.2026 समय 03:30 बजे अपराहन

निविदा की अन्य सभी नियम एवं शर्तें यथावत् रहेंगी।
कार्यपालक अभियंता
त्रिवेणी नहर प्रमंडल रक्सौल

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Out of site

People's protests are meant to be seen and heard, not hidden away

The Delhi Police's decision to denotify Jantar Mantar in the national capital as a site where protests can be organised has itself triggered a storm of protest over its sheer arbitrariness. The Delhi Police, which is under the Union Home Ministry, have told the Delhi High Court that Jantar Mantar was denotified as a protest site following a Supreme Court directive issued on October 9. The Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant had urged the Union government to identify an alternative protest site that is spacious and open. The order was passed while hearing petitions challenging the government's decision to restrict movement within and into the city to halt the October 10 protests demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Observations were also exchanged that protests in and around Jantar Mantar were a source of inconvenience for ordinary commuters. It is possible to argue that protesters cause traffic congestion and inconvenience. But those arguments are valid only as much as similar arguments that are usually raised against democracy itself. There is a reactionary view that democracy delays decision-making, elections disrupt development and economic activity, and that there should therefore be fewer elections and less politics. The BJP's push for simultaneous elections to Parliament and State Assemblies once every five years is based on the same logic, that at its heart questions the legitimacy of democracy itself. The argument against protests at Jantar Mantar does not hold water. It is antithetical to the concept of public deliberation and protest, which are central to democracy.

A centrally located site of protest is part of the urban space in most democracies, as in Washington DC and London. Public protesters are usually marginal groups who lack representation at the decision-making table. Street protest is actually an outcome of their lack of power, and an instrument for people with no other way of being heard. To keep them far away from the seat of power and render them invisible is a violent police argument against their very attempt to be heard and seen. The reason why a protester wants to be in Jantar Mantar is its proximity to the centre of power – it is located close to the Parliament complex, and the President's Estate. If, in the name of public order, they are pushed far away into the margins of the city, as is now being sought, it is equivalent to keeping them trapped in the very situation they are trying to escape. If protests can happen only far away from the seat of power, the logic can easily be extended to argue that people must stay at home and protest. That is not how a democracy works.

Double standards

The U.S. must stop moralising to the Global South for trading with Russia

Last year, U.S. President Donald Trump imposed an additional 25% tariff on India over India's oil purchases from Russia. Peter Navarro, Mr. Trump's trade czar, even called Russia's invasion of Ukraine "Modi's war", saying India was funding the Russian aggression through energy deals. Last month, Mr. Trump signed the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act into law, giving him the power to impose up to 100% tariffs on countries buying Russian energy, including India and China. And then, last week, Mr. Trump announced a deal to buy Russian diesel – releasing 300,000 tonnes immediately to the "American and global marketplace" followed by 5,00,000 tonnes in November. Immediately after the announcement, the Treasury Department suspended sanctions on Russian diesel exports until April 7, 2027. Mr. Trump's flip-flop is a lesson for countries such as India, which have been criticised and penalised for trading with Russia. The latest policy switch also exposes the incoherence in western strategic thinking. The West imposed sanctions on Russia's energy sector to weaken Vladimir Putin's "war machine". Four years later, the U.S. began bombing Iran. When the Iran war drove up fuel prices, Washington temporarily eased sanctions on Russian fuel before striking a deal with Moscow.

Beyond the hypocrisy and strategic folly of the U.S. decisions, Mr. Trump's diesel deal also marks the ineffectiveness of the western sanctions regime. When Russia attacked Ukraine in 2022, the West adopted a two-pronged response: weaken the Russian economy through sanctions and weaken the Russian military in Ukraine by arming Kyiv. The sanctions were a double-edged sword, hurting the Russian economy, but the curtailment of trade between Russia and Europe has also plunged European economies, particularly Germany, into deep crises. To offset the impact of the sanctions, Moscow looked east where China and India were willing to buy discounted Russian fuel. The episode also underscores the changes in the economic landscape. Mr. Trump's U-turn leaves Ukraine and Europe in a spot, at a time when Moscow is escalating its bombardment of Ukraine and testing NATO's resolve through grey-zone tactics. If Brussels thinks that prolonging the war would serve its strategic goal of bleeding Russia dry in Ukraine, it may be making a mistake, as Mr. Trump seems less interested in NATO's collective defence or in the defence of Kyiv. Instead, their focus must shift to finding a diplomatic way out. If Mr. Trump can reach a diesel deal with Mr. Putin amid the war, he should work with the warring parties, his allies in Europe and his new partner in Moscow, to secure a ceasefire and ease Russia-NATO tensions. In the meantime, the U.S. and Europe could stop moralising to the Global South for doing trade with Russia.

A contested UNSC seat poses a test for India

Suhasini Haidar

Following the conclusion of the 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA), held from September 8 to 28, 2026, the government must double its efforts to secure a non-permanent seat on the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) in next year's election. India's bid for the 2028-29 two-year term of the UNSC was launched by External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar this year, with voting in the UN General Assembly (UNGA) to take place in June 2027. As a result, Mr. Jaishankar was busier than usual during UNGA week, holding nearly 90 meetings over a 10-day stay in New York. Between now and next summer, India needs at least 129 affirmative votes in the 193-member Assembly to win.

This has not been as much of an issue on the eight occasions that India has won the seat over the past eight decades, becoming the Asia-Pacific grouping's consensus choice once every decade. Even Pakistan votes for India at the UNGA in these elections, and India returns the favour. With the full backing of the 55-member group, India won a record 187 of 191 votes in 2010 and 184 of 192 votes in 2020.

The bid for a ninth term

India's ambition to win a ninth term is guided by several factors – its terms were in 1950-51, 1967-68, 1972-73, 1977-78, 1984-85, 1991-92, 2011-12 and 2021-22. Its last tenure, in 2021-22, was disrupted by the COVID-19 pandemic, and the Narendra Modi government felt it had been unable to meet all its objectives. New Delhi may want to complete these objectives, including resolutions on terrorism and United Nations reform, before the Modi government's current term ends in 2029. With India's push for permanent membership of the UNSC still elusive, the government may wish to increase the frequency of its non-permanent tenures, keeping India at the centrestage of geopolitics from the UNSC's horseshoe table.

The difference this time, however, is that when India announced its candidacy for the 2027 election, Tajikistan was already in the fray and, according to the chart drawn up for the Asia-Pacific seat, was to be the consensus choice. On the two previous occasions when India had to contest an election – in 1975 against Pakistan and in 1996 against Japan – it lost. Decisions on consensus are made informally by diplomats at the UN, sometimes decades in advance for the 55-country Asia-Pacific grouping.

Like with all the other regional groups – African, Latin American and Caribbean (GRULAC), the Western European and Others Group (WEOG), and the Eastern European Group – a different number of seats fall vacant each year. When consensus breaks down, votes within the group are split, leading to a contest in the wider UNGA. From there it is a race for every country's vote; the rule that contestants must also win two-thirds of the assembly, or more than 129 votes, complicates the task. Given that the course is set, the Modi government has three options, each opening a differently difficult path. The first is to battle it out against Tajikistan on the global stage; the second is to convince the Tajik government to withdraw its candidature; and the third is for India to withdraw its own. Another option – to divide the two-year term equally between the two candidates – has been tried in the past, but these cases have been countries that are evenly matched in other respects.

It is a battle that can be avoided — the path to next year's UNSC election will not be a cakewalk, and India must consider its options

Battling it out

At first glance, India's advantage over Tajikistan seems glaringly obvious, given its size, economic standing and past record on the Council. However, UN insiders know that these are not the only criteria by which UNSC elections are won. To begin with, India's multiple terms on the UNSC may work against it, as there is a growing push within the UNGA to consider smaller countries that have never held council membership such as Tajikistan. In his UNGA speech, Tajik Foreign Minister Sirojiddin Muhriddin said that, more than status, his country's bid for a seat on the UNSC was about its responsibilities to the UN Charter and to "listen to all voices – large and small". This David-versus-Goliath pitch is attractive to other smaller states, especially those from the Global South that feel their lack of representation is unfair. Japan, for instance, which has served 12 terms on the UNSC, announced its candidature for the 2043 election in 2024, having previously declared its intention to contest the 2032 election.

The next important factor is how subregional blocs are likely to vote within the Asia-Pacific grouping. Tajikistan already has the endorsement of its own region, Central Asia, and possibly, by extension, that of several neighbouring countries. It also has the endorsement of the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation, a grouping of 57 member-states which would largely follow that position, although New Delhi may be able to win over some of its friends within the organisation. India is fairly confident of the votes of the Global North – the United States, Canada, Europe, Australia, New Zealand and allied countries – as well as those of Southeast Asian countries (the Association of Southeast Asian Nations or ASEAN), Caribbean nations represented by the Caribbean Community (CARICOM), and Pacific island countries (PIC). This means the battle ground that matters most is the Global South – Africa, South America and also South Asia.

The current mood among Global South countries, as reflected in a number of UNGA resolutions over the past year, has been decidedly against the big powers, the U.S. and Russia, and has been inordinately critical of Israel. During the 80th session, member-states voted overwhelmingly in favour of at least 13 resolutions criticising Israel. The UNSC elections this year were particularly instructive. For the Asia-Pacific seat, the UNGA voted for first-timer Kyrgyzstan over the western-backed Philippines. For the WEOG, Germany, which had never lost a UNSC election, lost to Portugal and Austria, ostensibly due to its stance in support of Israel. In the election for the President of the UNGA, too, the Bangladesh Foreign Minister, Khalilur Rahman, defeated his rival from Cyprus, another western-backed candidate. While India's assertion of strategic autonomy *vis-à-vis* the big powers may stand it in good stead, its diplomats may have to answer questions about India's own ties with Israel in recent years, particularly following Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Israel in February 2026.

Tajikistan or India bowing out

The next option, which has worked in the past, is to persuade Tajikistan to withdraw its candidature – India was able to negotiate with Kazakhstan in 2010 for the 2011-12 term, and Afghanistan in 2013 to step aside for the 2021-22 tenure. However, despite meetings between Mr. Modi and Tajik President Emomali Rahmon on the sidelines of the SCO Summit in Bishkek, and between Mr. Jaishankar and his Tajik counterpart during the UNGA session (both in September 2026), there has been no such announcement.

Even if Tajikistan decides to step aside after studying its chances, India must consider the message this would send to other Global South countries: that its second turn in a decade is more important than giving a smaller country its first opportunity to serve on the Council.

This leaves the third alternative, which would certainly make the world sit up: India could agree to step aside for Tajikistan, in order to return to the UNSC a year or two later with the full backing of the Asia-Pacific grouping. Such a move would acknowledge Tajikistan's special strategic relationship with India in the past, particularly its role in hosting an Indian Air Force base at Ayni and a medical base at Farkhor, strategically important in the Afghan conflict in the early part of this century, despite pushback from the U.S., China and even Russia. There is little evidence so far, however, that the Modi government, which announced its candidature with some fanfare, is considering backing down.

The path to securing another non-permanent seat on the UNSC next year is not easy. India's win can only be guaranteed by defeating the ambitions of its old friend and regional partner – the choice is between a Pyrrhic victory versus a tactical defeat. In the bigger war for India's rightful place as a permanent member of the UNSC – one whose voice represents the aspirations of the Global South – this is a battle that could be avoided.

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'Innovate today, nourish tomorrow' for food security

Konda Reddy Chavva
Officer-in-Charge, Food Agriculture Organisation (FAO) Representation in India

James Marc de Sousa-Shields
Country Director and Representative, International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)

Elisabeth Faure
Representative and Country Director, the World Food Programme (WFP) in India

The simple yet profound theme, "Innovate today, nourish tomorrow", for World Food Day 2026, observed on October 16, reminds us that the future cannot be built with the tools of the past alone. The need to scale up innovation is urgent, as 645 million people still face hunger, while one-third of the world's population cannot afford a healthy diet.

Three interconnected factors continue to push these numbers. Climate-related risks are reducing yields and disrupting growing seasons. Economic shocks and stubborn food-price inflation are eroding purchasing power. Conflict, war and civil strife tear up harvests, displace farmers, disrupt supply chains and destroy the very institutions that protect people from hunger.

From scarcity to surplus and nutrition

Over the decades, India has emerged as a food-surplus nation and one of the world's largest producers of foodgrains, milk, pulses, fruits and vegetables. One of the decisive factors in this transformation from scarcity was the 'Green Revolution'. The introduction of high-yielding varieties, backed by expanded irrigation and assured prices, increased cereal production, which became the basis for India's public distribution and nutrition schemes.

India's abundance in food production has become the foundation of the world's largest food safety net. Under the National Food Security Act, 2013, India provides a legal entitlement to subsidised foodgrains to up to 75% of its rural population and 50% of its urban population, reaching approximately 81 crore people. Since January 2024, the government has provided these foodgrains free of cost under the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana, a guarantee that has been extended until 2028.

This architecture rests on the Targeted Public Distribution System, strengthened by digitised ration cards, Aadhaar seeding and the One Nation One Ration Card portability scheme, which lets migrant workers draw their foodgrain entitlements anywhere in the country.

As countries across the Global South grapple with climate change, conflict and economic uncertainty, India offers lessons that can be adapted to their needs

India's transformation in food security and nutrition is being driven by innovation. The government is focusing on technology, data and finance to make farming more resilient, resource-efficient and viable, while improving access to and the efficiency of food safety nets.

Complementing efforts

It is at this intersection that the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO), the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) and the World Food Programme (WFP) are complementing India's efforts by providing technical expertise, developing solutions and strengthening institutional capacities.

On the farm, the FAO is supporting digital agriculture by developing advisory road maps and building the capacities of frontline extension workers. In livestock and dairy, FAO's Clean Milk Scorecard gives farmers a digital tool to assess cattle management, hygiene and milk production practices and provides actionable feedback. These tools translate technical knowledge into actionable advice, supporting better farm-level decisions and improved productivity. The FAO is also working to address food loss, a challenge with implications for nutrition, resource efficiency, climate action and farmers' incomes. Its work includes measuring losses, assessing their environmental impacts and identifying pathways to valorise them through composting, bioenergy and recycling.

On financing and investment, the IFAD focuses on the first mile of food systems, where risks are highest and private investment is thinnest. Its "financing plus" approach integrates support across the value chain – from production and market access to finance and small-scale infrastructure – and is designed to crowd in domestic public and private capital, rather than substitute for it. Every dollar IFAD has invested in India has leveraged more than three dollars in total investment. Across IFAD's global portfolio, projects with strong private-sector participation have delivered income gains of 64%, four times higher than those without such participation. IFAD is now beginning to lend directly to the private sector to bridge this gap, and India has one of its largest pipelines of such operations in Asia and the Pacific.

On access and availability, the WFP, the world's largest humanitarian organisation and the winner of the 2020 Nobel Peace Prize, has worked in India for over 63 years. It now focuses on enhancing the efficiency of the public food distribution system through innovations such as Grain ATMs, supply chain optimisation and the incubation of solutions through the Public Services Lab at the Indian Institute of Technology Delhi. The WFP also works to improve the nutritional effectiveness of food assistance, particularly for children and pregnant women. This includes assessing food baskets, recommending dietary diversity and integrating nutrition considerations, including the incorporation of nutrient-rich millets and other nutri-cereals.

India's blueprint

India's experience is increasingly relevant beyond its borders. Its innovations have been shaped by constraints, including fragmented landholdings, monsoon-fed agriculture, multilingual populations and limited resources. As nations across the Global South face climate change, conflict and economic uncertainty, India offers principles to adapt.

The future requires us to look beyond sufficiency towards better nutrition, scalable innovations and equitable food systems built around climate-resilient and biofortified crops, nutritionally diverse diets and value chains that reward smallholders. Innovation must remain pro-smallholder and pro-woman, drawing deeply on traditional knowledge even as it embraces scientific advances.

On this World Food Day, we reaffirm our shared resolve with India: to innovate today, and in doing so, to nourish tomorrow.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The ECI's missing voice

The Election Commission of India (ECI) is a constitutional authority entrusted with safeguarding the integrity of the electoral process. Yet, when its Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls exercise provokes widespread protests and questions, the ECI's own voice appears conspicuously muted, while the government steps forward to defend it. Has the ECI become so reticent in asserting its autonomy that it needs the executive to speak on its behalf? An autonomous constitutional body must be capable of explaining its decisions to the people of India, defending its methodology with evidence, and addressing legitimate objections directly.

R. Narayanan,
Navi Mumbai

Flagrant double standards

United States President Donald Trump's triumphant announcement securing Russian diesel imports marks a brazen display of geopolitical hypocrisy. For months now, Washington has hectored emerging economies such as India and been brandishing punitive tariffs over energy ties with Moscow. Yet, facing domestic inflation and fuel pressures, the U.S. readily carves out exemptions for itself.

The Global South must firmly call out this exceptionalism: rules cannot exist solely to restrain sovereign developing nations while the superpower flouts them at will.

Gopalaswamy J.,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Can wildlife thrive in India without active human intervention?

Qamar Qureshi

Retd. Professor, Wildlife Institute of India

Uma Ramakrishnan

Professor, National Centre for Biological Sciences, Bengaluru

PARLEY

On October 2, a three-year-old tigress was released into the Buxa Tiger Reserve in West Bengal marking the beginning of a phased programme to reintroduce tigers in the reserve and establish a viable, self-sustaining population there. Similarly, as part of Project Cheetah, cheetahs were reintroduced in Madhya Pradesh in 2022. This begs the question: can wildlife thrive in India without active human intervention? Qamar Qureshi and Uma Ramakrishnan discuss the question in a conversation moderated by **Jacob Koshy**. Edited excerpts:

Recently, *The Economist* provoked backlash in India with a backhanded compliment: that India had conserved its tigers despite being a largely poor country. Historically, does conservation follow countries attaining a degree of wealth? Is India an exception?

Qamar Qureshi: India's relationship with nature has evolved through three historical phases. Before British rule, India had a largely agrarian, forest-based economy in which nature was closely integrated with people's lives and livelihoods. Colonial rule fundamentally altered this relationship through new technologies, agricultural expansion and a belief that humans could overpower nature, contributing to substantial wildlife loss. After Independence, India inherited a mixture of traditional and Western attitudes. Colonial rule left India impoverished and deprived forest-dwelling communities of many of their traditional rights. Despite government efforts, these communities remain dependent on forests for survival.

Uma Ramakrishnan: Biodiversity conservation is not the preserve of wealthy countries. Several relatively poor nations, including Costa Rica, Brazil, Rwanda and Colombia, have prioritised conservation as part of their development trajectories. Conservation can also generate revenue through biodiversity-related tourism, as Costa Rica demonstrates. Conservation is also driven by emotion and a philosophical concern about the destruction of nature. The modern Western conservation movement drew impetus from works such as Paul Ehrlich's *The Population Bomb* and Rachel Carson's *Silent Spring*, while conservation science developed further in the 1980s through concepts such as minimum viable population sizes and organisations such as the International Union for the Conservation of Nature.

How does conservation science in India decide which species deserve priority, given the focus on tigers and lions while vultures and caracals receive less attention?

A cheetah resting at the Kuno National Park, Madhya Pradesh in 2025. PTI

QQ: Conservation operates through two mechanisms: hope for a better future and guilt over the destruction of nature and the extinction of species. It is also political, with science providing the evidence to support action. We must be cautious against the growing tendency to turn national parks into safari parks; this was an explicit warning made in the 1970s, when the then government launched Project Tiger. Tiger conservation is often misunderstood as focusing only on tigers. The exercise of surveying and evaluating nearly four lakh square kilometres across India, compared with the roughly one lakh square kilometres occupied by tigers, is intended to inform conservation decisions across biogeographic regions. Protecting tiger habitats also benefits other species occupying the same ecosystems. Flagship species such as the tiger attract public and political attention as well as funding; however, a rare frog threatened by a mine in Maharashtra may attract little concern. The tiger thus serves as a symbol that amplifies the conservation message.

Does the evidence show that protecting a flagship species also benefits the wider ecosystem, or do other species fail to flourish despite that protection?

UR: Protecting a flagship species such as the tiger does not necessarily benefit every ecosystem, since different habitats have distinct communities of carnivores, herbivores and birds. The tiger serves as a flagship species by attracting protection, while the scientific rationale for protecting top predators rests on their ability to regulate ecosystems – their removal has been shown to cause ecosystem disruption in several parts of the world, though not specifically in the case of tigers. Grasslands and human-dominated landscapes, for instance, may be better represented by wolves or other top predators than by tigers.

> Interventionist approaches such as captive breeding and reintroduction may be necessary to prevent some species from going extinct, but their success is far from guaranteed
>
> UMA RAMAKRISHNAN

Given historically low tiger numbers in parts of the Northeast, are active interventions such as tiger reintroductions necessary?

QQ: Conservation cannot follow a single model across India's diverse ecosystems. Wolves, for instance, are a landscape species that cannot be protected through protected areas alone. India spends roughly ₹3,500 crore annually on conservation, against a requirement of ₹9,500–₹10,000 crore. Although tiger reserves receive relatively good funding, other protected areas face significant shortfalls. India's extensive forest-management workforce is an advantage, but its colonial-era management systems are unevenly distributed, particularly in the Himalayas, deserts and Northeast. 'Active management,' is increasingly necessary because human activity has altered natural systems. Natural processes such as flooding sustain ecosystems in the Terai: without periodic floods, landscapes such as Kaziranga, Dudhwa and Valmiki would be fundamentally different. Yet preventing floods is often a human priority, illustrating the trade-offs conservation entails.

We must also avoid conservation models that rely on fenced enclosures. Species such as the Great Indian Bustard require landscape-level protection rather than conventional protected areas. Sanctuaries that were created for bustards, including in Gujarat and Andhra Pradesh, failed to prevent their disappearance because conservation planning did not adequately account for the ecological role of grazing or the needs of local communities. In some cases, restrictions led to increases in blackbuck populations that damaged crops, antagonising people who had tolerated or protected the birds. Bustards survived in landscapes partly because of local people's support, and conservation must work with communities rather than alienate them.

Is interventionist conservation necessary now to prevent species from going extinct?

UR: Interventionist approaches such as captive breeding and reintroduction may be necessary to prevent some species from going extinct, but their success is far from guaranteed. While the Mauritius kestrel is an example of successful reintroduction (in Mauritius), other programmes have had mixed or disappointing results. Moreover, captive breeding requires substantial effort and investment. Some species, such as the saola of the Annamite Mountains (Vietnam and Laos), may already have dwindled to numbers too low for captive breeding, leaving their genomes as the principal record of their existence. Conservation cannot save every species, particularly when so little is known about biodiversity. India, for instance, lacks basic data on insect abundance, making it difficult to establish whether insect populations are undergoing widespread declines. Protected areas cover only about 5% of India's land, well below international recommendations, underscoring the need to safeguard larger landscapes. However, given that people have long inhabited many of these areas, conservation must adopt different models suited to different contexts. The captive breeding for the Great Indian Bustard is a necessary experiment and parallels with vulture conservation, where reintroduction efforts have revealed unexpected behavioural challenges that need to be understood.

QQ: Protecting sufficiently large areas is essential, particularly because scientists do not yet know enough about many species and ecosystems to identify every conservation priority. With India's protected areas averaging roughly 200 sq km, safeguarding larger landscapes can serve as a form of insurance against future ecological risks, even when the full benefits are not yet understood.

What changes are needed to improve conservation science and wildlife biology?

UR: India's Wildlife (Protection) Act is structured primarily as a punitive law, with research activities such as collecting samples often treated in the same way as hunting, making permits necessary even for scientific work. Despite efforts over the past two decades to explicitly facilitate research under the Act, these changes have not materialised. This disproportionately affects those without institutional privilege or the resources to navigate the system. Conservation science needs to accommodate a wider range of researchers, replacing excessive top-down control with a system that enables diverse participation.

To listen to the full interview
Scan the code or go to the link
www.thehindu.com

NOTEBOOK

The calculations women make

Women journalists have to balance the demands of reporting with the risks of working on the ground

Lavpreet Kaur

A string of sexual assault and harassment cases in India over the past few weeks has led to a familiar cycle of outrage: protests, marches, television debates, social media campaigns, and demands for accountability. Reporting on these cases, I have found myself thinking about the calculations women constantly make to remain safe.

While reporting on the alleged gang rape of a 17-year-old at Astha Kunj Park in south Delhi last month, I spent hours speaking to students, women, and residents. On September 23, students of Lady Shri Ram College for Women and Delhi University had held a women-only march to raise concerns about safety. By 6.30 p.m., I was walking back from the march towards Nehru Place metro station, barely 650 metres away. About 200 m from where the march had ended, a man standing on the footpath looked me straight in the eye and began touching himself.

I could still hear the slogans behind me – "azadi, azadi" – growing louder. Police personnel were on the streets, "managing" the protest.

I kept walking.

Earlier that day, the women I spoke to said harassment on the roads was hardly unusual. "Men often engage in obscene sexual behaviour near Moolchand metro station and on the road towards college. This not only scared me, but also my family. They bought me a car so I can avoid travelling through these stretches," a student said. Some students avoid going to this metro station altogether and take a 10-minute auto ride to get to another station.

Women journalists make similar calculations. When I first had to go for a meeting with a police officer in Delhi, I wore jeans, boots, and a top. "If you go like this, they will think you are too fashionable and it might be a distraction for them," a colleague told me. "Wear something Indian." Another said, "Sleeveless will not look good." Since then, what I wear to work has sometimes depended on whether I have a meeting with a police officer.

Last month, when a building collapsed in Satya Niketan, killing seven people, I was at the site until 11.30 p.m. I was repeatedly told, "You should go home. It is late." Later, beneath the Durgabai Deshmukh South Campus metro station, where 150-200 students had gathered, I weighed the importance of the story against the risk of travelling alone at night. The apprehension did not feel misplaced: around midnight, another man exposed himself in front of me at a metro station.

Over the past week, as protests demanding the resignation of the Chief Election Commissioner unfolded in Delhi, I faced a familiar dilemma. When a situation escalated, should I move towards the crowd to document a detention or stay back and risk missing the moment? "*Madam, aap door hatt jayiye* (Madam, please stay at a distance)" was a common refrain.

Several protesters and detainees, including journalists, alleged that they had been manhandled; police personnel, in some instances, explained that physical force became "necessary" when people refused to move. A woman police officer told me that demonstrators sometimes refused to get up when asked to leave, forcing personnel to lift them. On ground, the line between what is dismissed as an inevitable part of crowd control and what a person experiences as physical intimidation can become difficult to establish.

A photojournalist based out of Gujarat, who had been considering coming to Delhi to cover the protests after seeing their scale, found herself hesitating over a question that seemed painfully basic: "Is it safe to go to protests alone?"

When I decided to pursue journalism in 2020, leaving behind what was considered a dream job for an engineering graduate, my mother worried that the profession was not safe for a woman. Six years later, when she hears me talk about crime scenes and late-night assignments, I realise how little that fear has changed. I have another story to chase, another call to make. She, on the other hand, has only one question for me after every assignment: Did you get home safely?

lavpreet.kaur@thehindu.co.in

PICTURE OF THE WEEK

In full bloom

Watery harvest: A man navigates a small wooden boat through a pond to harvest lotus flowers during the festive season, in Nadia district, West Bengal, on October 14. PTI

FROM THE ARCHIVES
The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 16, 1976

Widespread heavy rain in Tamil Nadu

Madras, October 15: Madras and several parts of Tamil Nadu to-day recorded heavy rain marking the onset of the North East Monsoon over the State right on time.

A deep depression has formed in the Bay of Bengal and the Meteorological authorities have forecast widespread rain for the next two days.

According to a special weather bulletin issued to-night, the deep depression lay centered about 700 km, south-east of Madras at 5:30 p.m. to-day. It is likely to intensify further into a cyclonic storm and move in a west-north-westerly direction.

Widespread rain with scattered heavy to very heavy fall is likely to occur along and off the coastal districts of Tamil Nadu during the next 48 hours. Widespread and isolated heavy rain is also likely in the remaining parts of Tamil Nadu. Squally weather, wind speed exceeding 65 km. per hour is likely along and off Tamil Nadu coast during the same period.

Local cautionary signal No. III has been hoisted in all Tamil Nadu ports. Madras and neighbourhood areas will experience intermittent rain showers which will be at times heavy, accompanied by gusty winds.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 16, 1926

British policy in China

Rugby, October 15: A statement on the British policy in China was made by Mr. Miles Lampson, British Minister–designate to China at the annual dinner of the China Association last night. He said he was authorised to say the Government sympathised with the Chinese people during their present troubles and the tribulations through which they were passing and had lost no opportunity of showing their sympathy in a practical manner while observing strict impartiality towards the contending factors.

From Page One

Special summary revision to begin soon

In its order to the Chief Electoral Officers of the States and Union Territories where the exercise will begin, the Commission said that through the SSR it aims to "facilitate the enrolment of eligible electors with reference to the qualifying date of January 1, 2027 along with seeking advance applications for the three subsequent qualifying dates of April 1, July 1 and October 1, 2027."

17 States and UTs

The ECI directive said that the SSR will be held in Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Goa, Gujarat, Kerala, Lakshadweep, Madhya Pradesh, Manipur, Puducherry, Punjab, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and West Bengal.

In States/UTs where the SIR is going on or has just been completed, the SSR schedule will be announced later.

These are Andhra Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh, Chandigarh, Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu, Haryana, Jharkhand, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, NCT of Delhi, Odisha, Sikkim, Tripura, and Telangana.

For Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, and Ladakh, where SIR has not been done, the schedule for roll revision will be announced after considering the weather conditions.

Goods exports jump 23.04% in September

Gold and silver imports declined by 81.27% and 49.11%, respectively, to $1.8 billion and $665 million during the month. Inbound shipments of crude oil, on the other hand, rose by 30.76% to $18.34 billion.

Brent crude oil prices have been hovering over $100 per barrel during the last few weeks.

Cumulatively, during April-September this fiscal, exports jumped 18.51% to $259.89 billion, and imports climbed 16.31% to $437.53 billion. The deficit during the first half of 2026-27 widened to $177.64 billion as compared to $156.88 billion during April-September 2025-26.

Exports are maintaining their growth trend, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal said in a press briefing on trade data.

He expressed the hope that if the trend continued, the country's merchandise exports would cross $500 billion. They were at $442 billion in 2025-26.

As per government estimates, services exports stood at $36.35 billion in September, and imports were at $19.44 billion.

Services exports

On services exports, the secretary said the rise in oil prices due to the West Asia crisis has impacted the exports in areas, including travel and tourism.

Commenting on the data, Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO) president S.C. Ralhan said exporters continue to respond to global uncertainty with agility, strengthening their presence across markets and product categories.

"This strong first-half performance provides a firm foundation to advance towards India's $1 trillion export ambition. The priority now is to translate this momentum into sustained orders and deeper market penetration. With an enabling policy environment, India can expand high-value and technology-intensive exports, build on its traditional strengths and strengthen its participation in global value chains," he said.

PM launches development projects in Ladakh

Press Trust of India
LEH

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday said special attention is being given to the youth of Ladakh so that they receive quality education, gain opportunities to learn new technologies and not depend on other cities.

Virtually inaugurating five development projects covering airport infrastructure and strategic road connectivity in Ladakh worth around ₹3,350 crore, Mr. Modi also said that proposals to establish satellite campuses of IIT Jammu and IIM Jammu are being advanced and through these academic centres, the youth of Ladakh will be able to access better opportunities in their own region for higher education and research.

The Prime Minister also said that another chapter is being added to Ladakh's progress and development today, and he was happy to be part of it virtually.

The projects include a new passenger terminal at the Kushok Bakula Rimpochee Airport in Leh. It incorporates geothermal energy to enhance energy efficiency and reduce its carbon footprint, reflecting the importance of sustainable infrastructure.

Talks between govt., Ladakh groups remain 'inconclusive'

Next round of discussions on Oct. 22 in Delhi; the Home Ministry made a presentation with details on the way forward during the meeting in Leh but key groups submitted their own draft proposal

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

Ladakh's civil society groups and local leaders on Thursday termed the fresh round of talks with a team of the Union Home Ministry in Leh "unsatisfactory and inconclusive" over demands of Statehood and Sixth Schedule, as the stakeholders shared fresh drafts with each other to pave the way for the next round of talks on October 22 in New Delhi.

The meeting was attended by the members of Leh Apex Body (LAB) and Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA), amalgams of socio-religious groups in the region. Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk, BJP leader Tashi Gyalson and Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council, Kargil, Chief Executive Councillor (CEC) Mohammad Jaffer Akhoon also attended the meeting.

The Ministry made a 15-page presentation with details on the way forward. However, the members of key groups, the LAB and KDA, raised questions and submitted their own draft.

"We also shared our draft with the Ministry, which gave a presentation on its draft. There were gaps between the two drafts and did lack consensus. We expect a fresh response of the Ministry to our draft to reach a consensus. We will also study and prepare our response to the Ministry draft," said Chering Dorjay Lakrook, co-chairman of the Leh Apex Body (LAB), which is an amalgam of religious and social organisations.

Clear call: Civil society groups have sought a legislature for Ladakh and special provisions under Article 371. FILE PHOTO

Mr. Lakrook said the main demands of having a legislature for Ladakh and special provisions under Article 371K "will see no dilution". "We stand by the understanding reached in the previous meetings. We hope the Centre keeps its promise," he said.

Another round of talks will be held on October 22 in New Delhi, according to the leaders of the amalgams. "We will not say the meeting was a failure but [rather] a continuation. The Ministry's draft was not satisfactory. We expect a revised draft to be shared by the Ministry with Ladakhi groups by October 18, given the huge differences between the two. We hope the Ministry will narrow down the differences before the October 22 talks. Otherwise, we were perplexed to see the Ministry draft," Mr. Wangchuk said.

Asgar Ali Karbalai, co-chairman of the KDA, termed the Ministry's draft "unsatisfactory". "It does not match the demands of Ladakhis. We will continue to seek democratic and constitutional rights and guarantees," Mr. Karbalai said.

Meanwhile, BJP leader Tashi Gyalson said the meeting had pushed for a "conclusion of a resolution after so many years of deliberations". "The Ministry's 15-page draft and the suggestive points of the KDA and LAB were discussed in the meeting. The next round of talks will be in New Delhi," Mr. Gyalson said.

The talks between Ladakh and the Centre have witnessed many ups and downs in the past six years. Ladakh was carved out as a separate Union Territory in 2019 from the Kashmir division, as J&K's special status was scrapped.

In the face of protests from Ladakhi civil society groups since 2019, a major breakthrough was achieved in July this year when the Centre suggested it was considering a customised *sui generis* model, most suitable for Ladakh, under provisions of Article 371 of the Constitution and a legislature for the region.

Ladakh was never a part of China, says LAB leader

The Hindu Bureau
SRINAGAR

Leh Apex Body (LAB) co-chairman Chering Dorjay Lakrook on Thursday "strongly condemned" the recent statement of China on Ladakh, and pledged to see China-occupied Aksai Chin as part of India.

"We strongly condemn and reject China's statement on western Ladakh. China should be careful with their remarks. Never in recorded history Ladakh was a part of China. We appeal to the Government of India to condemn it in strongest terms," said Mr. Lakrook, who also heads the Ladakh Buddhist Association (LBA).

Mr. Lakrook said people of Ladakh were "living happily with India". "We will not give up an inch, including Askai Chin, which is under illegal occupation of China," he added.

Konchok Stanzin, ex-councillor from the Chushul constituency, described Ladakh as "an integral part of India".

Deldan Namgyal, ex-MLA from the Nubra valley, said, "Locals always saved Ladakh from China, which is enemy of our spiritual guru Dalai Lama. We are with Bharat Mata and stand with the Government of India."

House panel questions Centre, States on issues in SC scholarship schemes

Abhinay Lakshman
NEW DELHI

The Public Accounts Committee of Parliament on Thursday grilled the Union government and several State governments over their responses to gaps, including "fraud markers", in the implementation of pre- and post- matric scholarships for Scheduled Caste students identified by the Comptroller and Auditor General of India.

The committee, headed by Congress MP K.C. Venugopal, is likely to move privilege notices against the Chief Secretaries of six States who were supposed to appear before it on Thursday to explain the gaps flagged in the 2025 CAG report but failed to do so, *The Hindu* has learnt.

K.C. Venugopal

Further, with the Union government responding that the implementation burden was on State and Union Territory administrations, the committee has given the Union Social Justice and Empowerment Ministry one month's time to submit a detailed action-taken report on each of the issues flagged by the CAG.

CAG report

In its 2025 report, the CAG audit had flagged a plethora of issues related to the pre-matric and post-matric scholarships.

These included 40.75 lakh beneficiaries from as many as 14 States receiving scholarships with delays ranging from one to 90 months; over 3.5 lakh beneficiaries not receiving their scholarships at all; over 5,700 cases of scholarships being disbursed without proper checks of income eligibility; over 6,000 cases of non-SC beneficiaries receiving the scholarships; and issues related to beneficiaries receiving double, short, and excess payments.

During the PAC hearing, the Chief Secretaries of Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka, Punjab, Odisha, Bihar, and Madhya Pradesh were supposed to appear for briefing the Members; however, none of the States had deputed the respective officials, sources told *The Hindu*.

The committee also pointed out during the hearing that the shift to the DBT method had resulted in significant drops in the number of beneficiaries in both the pre-matric and post-matric scholarships for SC students.

Parents of Ankita Bhandari demanding justice for their daughter in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

Congress writes to Murmu on 'VIP link' to Ankita's murder

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, on Thursday wrote to President Droupadi Murmu, urging her to ask the Centre to reconsider Dushyant Gautam's appointment as Sikkim Governor until the ongoing CBI probe into the alleged 'VIP' angle in the 2022 Ankita Bhandari murder in Uttarakhand is completed.

Ankita, a receptionist at a resort in Uttarakhand's Pauri district, was murdered by Pulkit Arya, son of a BJP leader, and his two aides. The case drew widespread attention amid allegations that she was killed after refusing to provide "special services" to a 'VIP' . Her parents have alleged that Mr. Gautam was the 'VIP'.

Mr. Gandhi said the appointment raised concerns because Article 361 of the Constitution provides immunity to the Governors from criminal proceedings while they hold office. He argued that the appointment could complicate efforts to establish accountability in the case.

"I know that Governors are appointed on the advice of the Council of Ministers, led by the Prime Minister. PM Modi has proved his utter disregard for women's safety by advising Mr. Gautam's appointment. However, by long convention, the President has the right to warn the government, and Article 74(1) gives you the power to ask for advice to be reconsidered. That is why I write to you, as a last resort," Mr. Gandhi wrote.

He highlighted the struggle of Ankita's parents for justice, noting that they had been protesting against the appointment.

Despite the convictions in the murder case, Ankita's family and supporters have continued to demand a thorough investigation into the alleged 'VIP' connection.

Mr. Gautam has denied the allegations and filed a defamation case.

Congress flags govt. 'silence' on Rubio's visit to India

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Thursday asked why the External Affairs Ministry was "silent" about a proposed meeting between the U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio and External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar in Mumbai.

U.S. Ambassador to India, Sergio Gor, had said that Mr. Rubio would meet Government of India officials in Mumbai.

Congress general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh said that what was extraordinary was Mr. Gor's statement that they "expect the Minister Dr. Jaishankar to be joining" them along with other individuals.

"Since when has the announcement of India's Minister of External Affairs' meetings within India been outsourced to somebody other than the official spokesperson of the MEA?" Mr. Ramesh asked.

BJP slams Rahul's remarks calling for 'political resistance'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Thursday questioned remarks on "political resistance" by Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, and accused him of promoting anarchy under the guise of democratic protest.

At a press briefing, BJP spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari referred to a purported statement by Neha Bora of the All India Students' Association, which he described as advocating a "Bangladesh-style Gen Z movement in India", and sought clarification from Mr. Gandhi in that regard.

The Congress leader had repeatedly been using the term "political resistance" over the past few days, Mr. Bhandari said, but his "intention is not democratic protest, but to undermine India's democracy through anarchy".

Pradeep Bhandari

During the October 12 march, the AISA leader was projected as one of its prominent faces, he said. "This indicates that her views are aligned with those of Rahul Gandhi," alleged Mr. Bhandari, adding that, in Bangladesh, extremist groups had attempted to destabilise the system through mob action and disorder with the objective of regime change.

Mr. Gandhi and his allies were now engaged in a similar effort because they had been unable to bring their family back to power through democratic means, he claimed.

MoD signs ₹4,106-cr. deals for IAF satellite, torpedoes

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Ministry of Defence on Thursday signed contracts worth approximately ₹4,106 crore for a dedicated communication satellite for the Indian Air Force (IAF) and *Varunastra* heavy-weight torpedoes for the Indian Navy, in a push to strengthen indigenous defence capabilities.

According to the Ministry of Defence, the contracts cover the acquisition of GSAT-7C, valued at ₹2,563 crore, from New Space India Limited (NSIL), Bengaluru, and *Varunastra* heavy-weight torpedoes worth ₹1,543 crore from Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL), Hyderabad.

The GSAT-7C satellite, indigenously designed, developed and manufactured, will enhance secure, resilient and seamless communication capabilities for IAF assets, strengthening the force's operational effectiveness.

Senior officials from the MoD, IAF, Indian Navy, and industry representatives during the signing of contracts in New Delhi. PTI

The dedicated satellite communication capability is expected to improve the Indian Air Force's ability to maintain reliable communications in support of its operational requirements, it added.

The second contract is for *Varunastra*, an indigenous ship-launched anti-submarine warfare torpedo developed by the Naval Science and Technological Laboratory (NSTL). Equipped with advanced manoeuvring capabilities, the heavyweight torpedo can engage enemy submarines at long ranges, enhancing the Indian Navy's underwater warfare capabilities.

The contracts were signed in New Delhi in the presence of A. Anbarasu, Additional Secretary and Director-General (Acquisition), Department of Defence.

Both agreements are aimed at advancing domestic defence manufacturing and promoting self-reliance in critical technologies, in line with the government's Aatmanirbhar Bharat and Make in India initiatives.

APPEAL

Ms.Anamika, Fortis Memorial Research Institute UHID No.13952527, 6 years is a known case of Thalassemia Major. She has a Potential Matched Sibling Donor & requires Stem Cell Transplant as Curative Therapy. The estimated cost of the transplant is approximately Rs.20,00,000/-.

Please send donation however small by Cheque/D.D/M.O Fav. **Save Poor Lives** A/c Anamika, **Our A/c Details:** S/B A/c No. 20000913487. S.B.I. R.A.Puram, IFSC CODE:SBIN0001855. Please Donate by G-pay No.9884607377, UPI Id: savepoorlives@oksbi. Donations are exempted under 80G of I.T.ACT.

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Enlighten us on the prohibitory orders, preserve all CCTV footage: SC to Centre

Orders were a 'ghost' as of now, says Bench; court issues notice to Election Commissioners to respond to Opposition's plea on SIR and asks authorities to preserve all footage related to protest; CJI asks Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas to file a petition over alleged assault by the police during Delhi march

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday directed the Union government to "enlighten" it about the prohibitory orders slapped on Delhi that led to mass detentions of people, particularly journalists, lawyers and protesters, during the October 10 demonstrations to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

"We want to be enlightened about the prohibitory orders issued under Section 163 BNSS (Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023)," Justice Joymalya Bagchi, part of the two-judge Bench headed by the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, said.

Petitioners have complained that there cannot be Section 163 orders in contiguous areas, and these orders have not been not made public.

The prohibitive orders were a "ghost" as of now, Justice Bagchi said, and the court would bring them under constitutional scrutiny after the government's response in an affidavit. The court passed a general order to the authorities to preserve "all CCTV footage" concerning the protest, including of detention centres where people had been kept for hours.

The court issued notice to Mr. Kumar and the two Election Commissioners, Sukhbir Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, to respond to a petition filed by Opposition leaders led by Rahul Gandhi, for a full disclosure of the special intensive revision exercise records.

The petition, represented by senior advocates Kapil Sibal, A.M. Singhvi and advocate Prasanna S., further sought an independent probe into allegations that Mr. Kumar had acted in a unilateral and arbitrary manner during the massive exercise that has so far left about 13 crore people without the power to vote.

Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas, who was present in the crowded court room, intervened to narrate how he had been "pounced upon" by security personnel while addressing the media on the streets. He had written to the Chief Justice about it, he said. The CJI asked him to file a petition.

Hitting the ground: Student being detained during a march over the SIR issue in New Delhi on Thursday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

The Bench directed the Centre to explain the denotification of Jantar Mantar on a petition which said the move was meant to distance dissent away from the power centres in the national capital. But the court refused to pass any interim orders on the issue without first hearing from the authorities, who said the denotification was not based on a Supreme Court order of October 9, but after getting expert opinion.

Senior advocate Mukta Gupta, appearing for Swaty Singh, the petitioner in the Jantar Mantar plea, said protesters must be within earshot of the people in power, and Jantar Mantar was proximate to institutions of authority.

Justice Bagchi responded on the distance factor by remarking that "we have to keep in mind the advances in technology", to which senior advocate N. Hariharan submitted that in that case "we can address the court from Kerala, why come here [to the court room]".

The court also issued notice to the Centre, the Delhi Police Commissioner, and Mr. Gandhi on a petition filed by advocate Digant Mishra and others. They have sought *suo motu* criminal contempt action against Mr. Gandhi and other Opposition leaders for leading a "political procession" into the Supreme Court precincts on October 12. Senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia, representing the petition, said the attempt was to browbeat the judiciary.

"Nobody can browbeat the judiciary," Chief Justice Kant said. The court ordered the CCTV footage of the Supreme Court premises to be preserved.

When senior advocate A.N.S. Nadkarni, representing petitioner Bhanu Sanoriya, sought a direction that all who hold protests must take personal responsibility for the ills that fall on others, senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan countered that such a liability must work both ways. "The police also must be accountable," he said.

The Delhi Union of Journalists, represented by senior advocate C.U. Singh, alleged that the devices of journalists professionally covering the protests were seized by security personnel.

Mr. Mehta denied the submission. The court directed the government to "make good the statement in an affidavit".

Senior advocate Indira Jaising, for the Network of Women in Media, India, said women journalists were detained and these incidents must be investigated by an independent committee.

"Women journalists have a right to work. They are particularly vulnerable to abuse, particularly by male policemen. Form a committee headed by a woman chairperson, maybe a woman Supreme Court judge, in accordance with the Vishakha guidelines on sexual harassment at workplace," Ms. Jaising submitted.

The court *prima facie* agreed with her suggestion, but Mr. Mehta said the authorities must be given time to respond to the petition.

Actor Imran Khan told to leave India over CEC protest

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

Imran Khan

Actor Imran Khan has been issued notice for violating the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, and has been asked to leave India by October 28, the Mumbai Police said on Thursday. Mr. Khan is a foreign national.

The action comes after he participated in the October 10 protest in Mumbai, seeking the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) in Mumbai issued the notice to the actor. Deputy Commissioner of Police, Special Branch 2, is the designated Foreigners Regional Registration Officer. "Mr. Khan's acts are in violation of visa conditions and the provisions of the Foreigners' Act. *Suo moto* action has been initiated in the matter. Law will take its due course. Process is going on," a senior officer told *The Hindu*. Under provisions of the Act, foreign nationals do not have the fundamental right to protest or participate in political activities in India.

The actor is considering filing a writ petition against the notice.

"Money is coming from Pakistan, foreign countries are powering this. These foreign nationals are trying to spread anarchy in the country. I had filed a complaint against American citizen Imran Khan," said BJP leader Kirit Somaiya.

NCP(SP) leader Supriya Sule said everyone has the right to protest. "Several of our friends live in foreign countries. They participate in protests. Nobody throws them out of the country," she said. Shiv Sena UBT leader Sanjay Raut said several celebrities hold NRI status. "Imran Khan participated in the anti-CEC protest. If he has been asked to leave for supporting the young generation, then the government is scared," he said.

Protester may require ear surgery after police assault

Ashna Butani
Nikhil M. Babu
NEW DELHI

Fidal Royas

Fidal Royas travelled from Keralam to Delhi to fight for democracy and demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. He returned home 11 days later to seek treatment for severe ear injuries that may require surgery after having been hit, kicked, and slapped while detained by the Delhi Police on October 11.

The 27-year-old reached Delhi on the night of October 1 and participated in the protest the next day, and then again on October 10. He was detained on both days, but did not face any assault. On October 11, however, as the police cracked down on attempts to mobilise protest across the national capital, he was injured after being "hit and slapped multiple times on his face and ear". He was allegedly attacked after the police spotted him recording a video about police violence.

Hit many times

The medical report states that he was hit multiple times on his right cheek, hand, back, and all over the body. He has been diagnosed with normal to mild hearing loss due to a perforation in his right ear. He has been given medication. The doctors will confirm if he needs surgery within the next two weeks.

On October 11, Mr. Royas was detained from Connaught Place and held in a bus. "By that time, the police had started hitting people and someone was making a video of it and I was talking in that video about the attack. The police saw this and they took the bus to a place about five minutes from there," he said.

"As soon as I stepped out, they started hitting me. Five or six policemen surrounded me and started kicking me with their boots," Mr. Royas alleged. When they got back inside the bus, he was slapped across his ears again.

When he was taken to Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital, there were delays in getting medical reports. "Since treatment was not completed, we decided to go to Keralam and do the rest of the treatment," he said.

ECI gave no SOPs for auto-generated Form 7s

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

Left out: People submit appeals at tribunals in West Bengal after their names were deleted from the rolls. FILE PHOTO

With thousands of names deleted from electoral rolls during phases 2 and 3 of the special intensive revision (SIR) using auto-generated Form 7s digitally signed by Electoral Registration Officers (EROs), it has now emerged that this exercise is being carried out by State poll authorities without the Election Commission of India (ECI) issuing any written protocol or Standard Operating Procedure (SOP).

Form 7 is the official voter application form issued by the ECI to object to a proposed entry or request the deletion of an existing name from the electoral rolls.

While there is no provision for EROs or Assistant EROs (AEROs) to file Form 7 themselves under electoral rules, States such as Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand and West Bengal have witnessed poll officials using this route to omit names from rolls for unresolved logical discrepancies and in cases of voters found to be "unmapped".

According to several State electoral officials *The Hindu* spoke with, the ECI's software, ERONet, automatically generated these Form 7s when officials deleted voters during the SIR hearings. The auto-generated forms came with the officers' digital signatures.

In Delhi for example, *The Hindu* has reported earlier that EROs and AEROs were named as 'objectors' for many forms filed against electors in draft roll. All these electors had been flagged for notices over either a 'logical discrepancy' or 'no mapping' in the draft roll published on August 31. Reports have said that more than 87,000 names in Uttar Pradesh and more than 95,000 in Uttarakhand were deleted through this method.

However, according to sources, there was no written communication or SOP which was shared with the election authorities in the States in this regard.

The ECI was yet to respond to an official query in the matter.

Who can file Form 7

According to the Manual on Electoral Rolls, 2024, there is no provision for the ERO to file a Form 7. The ERO who is the adjudicator in the process can, however, delete a name found ineligible.

The rules say that a Form 7 can be filed only by a person whose name is already included in the roll in which the name objected to appears. In cases of death, Form 7 can come from a family member, a local elector or the Booth Level Officer (BLO). Booth-level agents (BLAs) of recognised parties may file no more than 10 forms a day, and cross-verification by the ERO or AERO is required if a BLA files more than 30 in the revision period. Recently, the ECI has also brought in restrictions on the number of such forms an individual can file following an uproar over bulk filing of Form 7s in many States.

As far as the powers of the ERO are concerned, they include receiving and screening the form, maintaining lists of Form 7 applications in Form 10, and displaying them on his or her office noticeboard. They must personally cross-verify deletions where the same person is the objector in more than five cases.

Though there is no general rule on auto-generating Form 7, the term finds a mention only under the Photo Similar Entries (PSE) verification process in the manual.

HC dismisses plea against CJP's protest in Delhi today

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Thursday refused to restrain the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and its founder Abhijeet Dipke from holding a protest at Connaught Place's Central Park on October 16, even as it took on record the police's assurance that all possible steps would be taken to regulate and control protesters.

A bench of Acting Chief Justice Nitin Wasudeo Sambre and Justice Sanjay Sharma heard a plea by a Connaught Place vendor seeking directions to the police to regulate the protest.

The petitioner's counsel submitted that traders and vendors would be left "on the streets" if another weekend is lost to closures due to protests in central Delhi during the festive season.

Central Park closed ahead of 'Tricolour rally'

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

CJP's Abhijeet Dipke and AISA leader Neha Bora address media at the Press Club in New Delhi on Thursday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Ahead of the *Lehra Do Tiranga* (Wave the Tricolour) demonstration called by youth organisations on Friday , the New Delhi Municipal Council announced that Central Park in Connaught Place will remain closed to the public on Friday and Saturday, citing "administrative reasons".

This comes as youth groups, including the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and the All India Students' Association (AISA), at a joint press conference on Thursday appealed to the public to gather for a mass flag-hoisting demonstration at the Central Park on Friday, as part of their ongoing agitation seeking the rollback of special intensive revision of electoral rolls and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

The organisations condemned the police action against CJP leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka for carrying the National Flag to the Jantar Mantar protest site on Tuesday and called on students, workers, farmers, traders and members of the public to join the *Lehra Do Tiranga* programme.

CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke questioned Prime Minister Narendra Modi's support for Mr. Kumar, alleging that restrictions on protests and the detention of demonstrators raised concerns about the government's intentions.

"Why is the Prime Minister shutting down Delhi to protect one man? Delhi has been turned into an India-Pakistan border, with railway and Metro services suspended after our October 10 protest call. What does Gyanesh Kumar give Modi in return for this protection?" Mr. Dipke said.

"Unfurling the *Tiranga* is not a crime", he said. "If the government wants to detain this many citizens, Opposition leaders, and students, let it declare an Emergency outright."

The groups also demanded an end to police action against demonstrators and the restoration of Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site.

'Nationwide struggle'

AISA president Neha Bora said the campaign to protect voting rights was a nationwide struggle involving ordinary citizens, not any single political party or organisation. She added that protests would continue despite alleged attempts to intimidate demonstrators and said the movement was expanding to cities including Mumbai.

Reacting to the closure of Central Park, Mr. Dipke, in a late-night press conference, said, "Is the government going to shut 100 places if we decide to unfurl the flags at 100 locations? Why are they so scared?" He said that following the path of Mahatma Gandhi and Babasaheb Ambedkar, people will gather at 5 p.m. at Central Park with the National Flag peacefully and protest against the SIR.

Over 100 detained in Delhi

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Protests against the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and Chief Electoral Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar continued in the national capital for the sixth consecutive day on Thursday, with members of the All India Students' Federation (AISF) and the All India Youth Federation (AIYF) taking out a 'Tiranga march' through Connaught Place. Youth organisations said around 100 protesters, including women, were detained during the march, though the Delhi Police did not release an official count.

No list yet of 1.22 cr. Maharashtra voters issued SIR notices

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

The Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Maharashtra has not yet published the list of 1.22 crore voters in the State who were issued notices, as part of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, for 'logical discrepancies' or for being 'unmapped' in previous SIRs.

As per the notification issued by the Election Commission of India (ECI) for Phase 3 of the SIR, the CEO of every State has been directed to publish on their websites the lists of persons to whom notices were generated for being unmapped or for logical discrepancies.

Asked about the delay, sources in the CEO's office said the list is to be published by the EROs (Electoral Registration Officers). "The process of publication is on at their level," an official said

There are 59.75 lakh unmapped people and 62.48 lakh people whose names have been flagged for logical discrepancies in the State, taking the total figure to a whopping 1.22 crore.

States like Karnataka, Telangana, Delhi, where the figures are considerably lower, have already published their lists.

Meanwhile, the Maharashtra CEO on Thursday announced special camps to be held in the State on October 17, 18, 24, and 25, for the inclusion of new or excluded electors.

People have been asked to check their names in the draft electoral roll and file their claims and objections by October 26.

INBRIEF

KMC scrubs 'rainbow' paint off two flyovers after accident

The Kolkata Municipal Corporation on Wednesday night tried to scrub off the "rainbow" paint from two flyovers after videos of motorcycles skidding on the freshly painted Chingrighata flyover went viral on social media. Last week, the Gariahat and Chingrighata flyovers were painted in shades of pink, orange, green and yellow as part of a beautification drive launched by the West Bengal government. Urban Development Minister Agnimitra Paul had described the initiative as a symbol of brotherhood, love and public trust. "The paint that was used was supposed to be anti-skid paint. But since a few motorcycles still fell, we are now removing the paint," Ms. Paul said.

J&K HC bars motorboats on Dal lake; eyes green fix

The Jammu and Kashmir High Court on Thursday barred the use of fuel-powered motorboats and jet skis on Dal Lake and directed the government to explore the possibility of using solar-powered e-engines. "The court is not hesitant to observe that solar boats and electric boats could be a solution for balancing the equities between tourism and the sustenance of lakes," a Division Bench of Chief Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati and Justice Rajesh Sekhri said. However, the court exempted the boats used by the administration and the authorities for the purpose of emergency services, law and order, and disaster management.

Land shortage cripples Agriculture Ministry's weather network rollout

Project is a year behind deadline, with over 96% of planned rain gauges and weather stations yet to be installed; after six States had already issued tenders, private partners say IMD retrospectively amended the 2023 manual, insisting that sensors be installed on the ground, not on rooftops

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

An ambitious public-private partnership project by an Agriculture Ministry body to install automatic rain gauges and automatic weather stations in States is proceeding at a crawl, with completion rates in the single digits and at least a year behind deadline. Over 96% of planned sensors are yet to be installed.

The reason, companies tasked with the implementation say, is a paucity of land to install these weather stations and an alleged "retrospective" insistence by the India Meteorological Department (IMD) that these sensors be set up on the ground rather than on rooftops.

The Weather Information Network and Data System (WINDS) is a programme to set up a nationwide network of weather sensors to supply hyper-local weather data. This is mainly to aid in computing insurance estimates and payouts under the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY). It is run by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare, and executed through the Mahalanobis National Crop Forecast Centre (MNCFC).

Under the WINDS network, the States, through their implementing private partners, are required to set up the sensor network. *The Hindu* could confirm that three companies – Skymet Weather Services; Ingen Technologies Private Limited; and Azista Industries – were collectively asked to instal 1,197 automatic weather stations (AWSs) and 49,313 automatic rain gauges (ARGs), or about 50,500 sensors in all.

An ARG measures rainfall only, though about 10% of ARGs at the gram panchayat level also carry a temperature sensor. An AWS measures rainfall along with air temperature, relative humidity, wind speed, and wind direction. Data from these sensors flow into data centres run by government agencies, to prepare hourly, daily, and fortnightly forecasts.

Rain gauge units must be installed on the ground to ensure that the data collected are accurate, say IMD officials. FILE PHOTO

Sites rejected

According to documents viewed by *The Hindu*, Uttar Pradesh was to have 27,487 ARGs – over half the ARG target – followed by Uttarakhand (7,983), Odisha (7,286), Assam (2,140), and Himachal Pradesh (about 3,550).

For AWSs, Odisha's target was the largest at 434, ahead of Assam (196), Uttar Pradesh (157), and Kerala (148). According to a status update on September 9 – the latest that *The Hindu* was able to confirm – the network has delivered 113 AWSs (9.4% of target) and 1,730 ARGs (4%), leaving a shortfall of about 48,700 (96%).

The bottleneck is mostly site selection rather than hardware, the documents reveal. Of the 27,644 sites in Uttar Pradesh, 16,478 were rejected. In Odisha, 5,666 of 7,720 sites were rejected, while 524 of 946 sites were rejected in Kerala. The documents also flag hundreds of "duplicate sites" that were approved at the panchayat and block level but need re-checking, sites pending clearances, and those which the States have yet to share with the implementing partners.

Retrospective changes

A representative of one of the private partner companies, who asked not to be named, told *The Hindu* that the delays stem from a shortage of suitable land and from the requirement that rain gauges be placed on the ground rather than on rooftops. He blamed changes made to the WINDS guidelines "retrospectively."

The manual published on September 1, 2023 allowed an ARG to be placed on the roof of a single-storey building where siting requirements could not be met or in flood-prone areas, he claimed.

About two-and-a-half years later, and after six States had already issued tenders or work orders, the Agriculture Department amended the manual on the IMD's advice on December 3, 2025, to retroactively limit rooftop ARGs to just 10% to 15% of the total, he said.

IMD officials contend that the requirement that ARGs and AWSs be located on the ground is "essential" to ensure that the data collected are accurate.

"The underlying principle - and this is a requirement of the World Meteorological Organisation whose guidelines we adhere to - is that sensors must be on the ground and only in exceptional situations be situated on rooftops. Height significantly affects weather data," S. Hosalikar, a former senior meteorologist with the IMD and a member of the 2023 committee, told *The Hindu*.

The 2023 manual sets no numerical cap on rooftop units. This only appears in the 2025 amendment which specifies a 10% cap. It also requires that rooftop installations be allowed only if States issue a justification note saying there is no suitable ground space. In flood- or landslide-prone regions, the ceiling is 15%, with prior State recommendation and approval sent to the WINDS Committee.

"A consistent network of ground-based sensors is necessary to ensure standardised data, which is difficult to achieve if sensors are on rooftops (with variable heights). India lives in its villages and it should not be that challenging to get small plots of land," IMD Director-General M. Mohapatra told *The Hindu*. He underlined that the IMD was only a technical partner for the project and was not administering it.

The Hindu reached out to Soumya Bandopadhyay, director of the MNCFC, seeking a comment but did not get any response till the time of going to press.

Marginal rise in joblessness rate in urban India: NSO

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Unemployment Rate (UR) in the country stood at 5% in September, stable compared to August, according to the Periodic Labour Force Survey conducted by the National Statistics Office. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation said on Thursday that the rural UR remained "broadly stable" at 4.2%, against 4.1% in August, while urban UR marginally rose from 6.8% in August to 6.9% in this month. "Compared with September 2025, the overall UR declined by 0.2 percentage points and reached at 5% in September 2026. Rural UR declined by 0.4 percentage points, while UR in urban areas remained broadly stable" the Ministry said.

Indian envoy rebukes U.S. lawmaker over electoral roll remarks

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI

Hours after U.S. Congresswoman Pramila Jayapal extended support to the ongoing protests against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) by the Election Commission of India, the Indian Ambassador to the U.S., Vinay Mohan Kwatra, said Ms. Jayapal's comments amounted to "unacceptable interference" in India's "internal affairs".

Ms. Jayapal had said the SIR was similar to President Trump's plans for U.S. elections, allegedly aimed at removing parts of the U.S. electorate that was unlikely to vote for Mr. Trump.

"The remarks by @RepJayapal on India's electoral and political processes are unacceptable interference in India's internal affairs.

Indian envoy termed Jayapal's criticism as 'unacceptable interference in internal affairs'

India is a vibrant democracy, with robust independent constitutional institutions," Mr. Kwatra said in his remark posted on social media platform X.

"I am deeply concerned about the actions of the Indian government to purge 130 million people from the voting rolls," Ms. Jayapal had earlier said.

"Non-violent resistance movements are essential in these moments and I stand with the Indian people who are engaging in non-violent protests to counter anti-democratic efforts in India," the Congresswoman said.

Kolkata's Sonagachi inaugurates Durga Puja, marks 14 years of defying stigma

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

Sonagachi, India's largest red light area in Kolkata, inaugurated its 14th Durga Puja on Wednesday amid continued opposition from local people. The Durbar Mahila Samanwaya Committee (DMSC), a collective of sex workers, continues its struggle for rights in the face of persistent social stigma.

"People always thought sex workers are sub-humans, why do they need to celebrate Durga Puja? Even to get this much space we had to go to the High Court. But problems are far from over, even now locals find new problems with our puja every year," Bishakha Laskar, secretary of DMSC, told T*he Hindu* during the inauguration ceremony.

The Durga Puja inauguration ceremony at Sonagachi, Kolkata, India's largest red light area. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

She said that on the day of the inauguration some local people alleged that their stage was bigger than permitted and tried to create a scuffle.

Ms. Laskar added that neither local people nor neighbourhood clubs were willing to cooperate with them. She said that the sex workers were often judged and looked down upon when they visited other pujas, so they wanted to start their own, despite facing considerable resistance.

"We organise these events because it is also our safe space. But, one day we hope to become part of the mainstream so that we do not need separate pujas for marginalised people like us," Ismail, the son of a sex worker, said during the ceremony.

A guest at the event highlighted that a society cannot progress if they do not offer rights to sex workers and treat them as equal citizens. The organisers said the number of participants and guests had increased in recent years. Several MLAs, Ministers, social activists, college students, and residents now visit the puja to pay their respects, indicating a wind of change.

Interestingly, the Durga idol remains incomplete without a little clay from the courtyard of sex workers. Kumartuli, the city's prominent potters' colony, is a stone's throw away from Sonagachi, and every year artisans traditionally collect clay from there to make the idols. Yet, the women whose courtyards contribute to their making have often felt unwelcome at the pujas where the idols are worshipped.

Rajnath Singh to represent India at SCO PMs' summit

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh will represent India at the upcoming two-day meeting of the Council of Heads of Government (Prime Ministers) of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) in Dushanbe, Tajikistan, on October 19 and 20, while Prime Minister Narendra Modi is expected to participate virtually, a senior government official said on Thursday.

The meeting will be held under Tajikistan's SCO chairmanship for the year and is expected to focus on practical cooperation among member states, particularly in trade, and commerce.

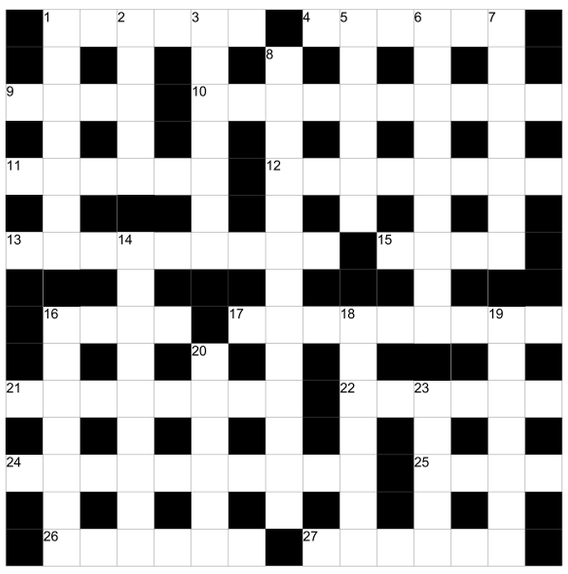
The official said Mr. Singh would also hold a bilateral meeting with Tajikistan during the visit.

THE HINDU CROSSWORD + 14925

(set by Crossant)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



ACROSS

1. Is he this upset? Acting amateurish (6)
4. Stick with this as a means of persuasion (6)
9. Attendant's salary reduced by wife following suggestion of partner (4)
10. One supplying electrically operated switch controlling resistance (10)
11. Spear cut head of African antelope (6)
12. One uses energy to mould polymer (8)
13. And for us — loose baggy pants (4,5)
15. Backstage kisses? (4)
16. Man in a city in an island nation (4)
17. Man U is good or abysmal — one doesn't know (9)
21. A weapon is pulled by Lieutenant, creating panic (8)
22. 10 animated epics — Beowulf to begin with (6)
24. Trip is for a non-conformist (4,6)
25. Leaders of Arab nations expecting war again (4)
26. Artist comes back with suggestions for shows (6)
27. Father of British actor Gary? (3,3)

DOWN

1. Check tour — very short distance covering Vatican city (7)
2. Real fan sadly leaves empty football stadium (5)
3. Model construction set in holy city now reduced (7)
5. Hurried with a bit of bounce and reverse swing, nearly clipping top of pad (6)
6. Hair perhaps from a rope? (4,5)
7. Throwing out husband's worthless, broken tools (7)
8. Questioning destruction of Goan territory (13)
14. Royals are playing for 12 months (5,4)
16. Retro hit song — "Killer" maybe (7)
18. Said to cover part of moon's path (7)
19. A large number of youth supporting University representative (7)
20. Only female dropped from new spy film (6)
23. Please plan with time for bit of relaxation (5)

SUDOKU

		2		6	1	9		
	8					5		
5					7			
	6	7			9		3	
	9			5			7	
	5		8			2	6	
			4					2
		1					9	
		5	9	3		6		

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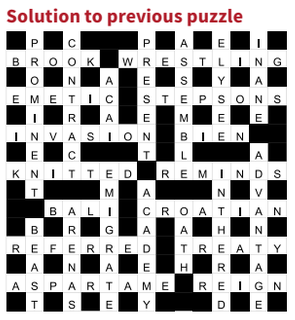
DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★☆☆

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

4	7	6	9	5	2	8	3	1
5	9	3	1	8	4	6	7	2
2	8	1	6	7	3	9	5	4
1	2	8	4	6	5	7	9	3
7	6	9	3	1	8	4	2	5
3	5	4	2	9	7	1	6	8
6	4	5	7	2	1	3	8	9
9	3	2	8	4	6	5	1	7
8	1	7	5	3	9	2	4	6

FAITH

Importance of agriculture

In Kondrai Venthan, poet Avvaiyar says wealth acquired through agriculture is never lost. Farmers are as important to human life as an axle is to a vehicle, said R. Narayanan in a discourse. Considering the importance of agriculture, Pongal is called Uzhavar Thirunaal in Tamil Nadu – the day of farmers. There is also a separate celebration for the cattle, because bullocks were used to plough the land in the past. Thiruvalluvar describes how to till the land to ensure maximum produce. He says that if one ploughs the land thoroughly, and then dries the soil before sowing seeds, even a handful of manure will not be needed for the crops.

Thiruvalluvar sees the land as a girl, and says that if a man is lazy and whines about being poor, then mother earth will laugh at him mockingly. The earth is given by Thiruvalluvar as an example of patience. He says that just as the earth bears those who dig her, so should we be patient with those who criticise us.

Appar was devoted to Lord Siva, with no thoughts for anything but attaining the feet of the Lord. He has used many metaphors about agriculture in his Thevaram verses. He compares one's heart to land that is cultivated. In one padhigam he says that if one sows the seed called desire (here the desire is to attain Lord Siva), if one removes the weeds known as falsity, if one irrigates the land with patience, if one constructs a fence called good conduct, then the crop that results will be reaching the feet of Siva. Thus, using a metaphor related to agriculture, Appar helps us comprehend how to get out of the cycle of births and deaths.

INBRIEF

BEML, Czech team discuss potential collaboration

State-owned BEML discussed opportunities for potential collaboration with a delegation from the Czech Republic led by Karel Havlíček, First Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Industry and Trade of the Czech Republic. The strategic engagement was aimed at deepening collaboration and "opening avenues for stronger linkages between businesses, technology providers, and advanced engineering enterprises from both countries," according to a statement.

SEBI to partly reverse derivative settlement rules

India's markets regulator said on Thursday it will use volume-weighted average prices from the final 30 minutes of regular trading to settle expiring stock and index derivatives contracts, reversing its decision use closing auction prices. The closing auction session, introduced on August 3, will continue to determine the closing prices of applicable cash-equity securities, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) said in a circular. REUTERS

ITAT orders ₹13,000-crore tax relief to Maruti Suzuki India

Maruti Suzuki India informed the exchanges on Thursday that the Income Tax Appellate Tribunal (ITAT) had ruled largely in its favour in tax matters covering eight financial years, from FY2013-14 to FY2019-20 and FY2021-22. The order is expected to have a positive tax impact, including interest, of approximately ₹13,000 crore. MSIL expects to reduce its contingent liability by about ₹6,300 crore, primarily through a reduction in the interest component.

Two-thirds oil imports from just 3 nations

While Russia's share in India's oil imports fell to 44%, from a historic high in July, share of both the U.S. and UAE surged, resulting in cumulative shares of the three countries reaching an all-time high; American oil came at a substantial premium compared with the average price India paid

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

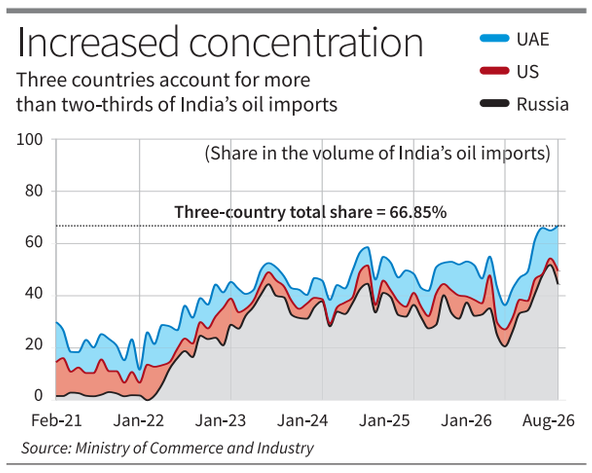
In a sign of increasing concentration of India's oil supplies and its limited options to source from, latest data shows that more than two-thirds of the country's oil imports came from just three countries – Russia, the U.S., and the UAE – marking a record high share.

Notably, Russia's share in India's oil imports fell to around 44% in August 2026, the latest month for which official data is available, from a historic high of 51% in July.

Data shows that India's oil imports from both the U.S. and the UAE surged in August, with the American oil coming at a substantial premium compared with the average price India paid for oil imports.

India's total oil imports stood at 191.2 lakh tonnes in August 2026, which was 10.3% lower than in July, but 3.4% higher than in August last year. However, the elevated price of oil has meant that India's oil import bill was nearly 25% higher in August this year than in the same month last year.

Within this, Russian oil accounted for 84.8 lakh tonnes of Indian oil imports, or 44.3% of the total.



In terms of India's oil import bill of $12.2 billion in August 2026, payments to Russia accounted for 44.5%. That said, India imported 23% less oil from Russia in August 2026 than in July, although this figure was still 22.5% higher than in August last year.

India's elevated oil imports from Russia have been a sore point in its relations with the U.S. and its President Donald Trump, who in September signed into law an Act that could see tariffs of up to 100% being levied on countries that import large amounts of Russian oil and gas, as India does.

On the other hand, India's oil imports from the U.S. once again surged in August 2026 to 9.7 lakh tonnes, making up 5.1% of India's total oil imports that month. In terms of quantity, this was nearly 82% higher than in July, and more than 130% higher than in August last year.

The data also shows that India paid an average of $810.6 per tonne of oil to the U.S., much higher than the average price of $640 per tonne it paid across all its oil imports in August. Oil from the U.S. has been costlier than average since June 2026.

Notably, India's oil imports from the UAE also jumped in August 2026 as the two countries established alternate supply routes through ports relatively un-impacted by the war in West Asia.

Oil imports from the UAE, at 33 lakh tonnes, made up 17.4% of India's total oil imports and 16.9% of its oil import bill.

Jio Platforms to focus on technology monetisation, targets debt-free status

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Jio Platforms Ltd. (JPL) will focus on monetising its existing infrastructure and expanding services rather than relying primarily on tariff hikes to drive growth, Managing Director Akash Ambani said on Thursday.

Speaking at the company's pre-IPO press conference, he identified mobility, home, enterprise and international monetisation of its technology stack as four key growth engines.

"Our proprietary end-to-end technology stack has given us the ability to

Akash Ambani

play across the value chain and a potential for India to become an exporter of technology rather than an importer of technology," he said.

JPL plans to commercialise its technology stack overseas through partnerships, operating as a managed-services provider to telecom operators rather than selling hardware or software licences.

The company is seeking to raise over ₹30,000 crore through what is expected to be India's largest-ever initial public offering (IPO). Almost the entire proceeds will be used to make JPL net debt-free, with future expansion funded through internal cash flows, Mr. Ambani said.

Highlighting its infrastructure, he cited over 3.6 lakh telecom towers and more than one million kilometres of fibre. The company expects to roll out 6G through a software upgrade rather than fresh infrastructure investment.

JPL's revenue rose from ₹1.09 lakh crore to over ₹1.46 lakh crore in three years, representing a compound annual growth rate of 15.8%. EBITDA rose from ₹54,000 crore to ₹76,000 crore, while the EBITDA margin improved from 50% to 53%.

In mobility, JPL expects to add 100 million first-time mobile subscribers and migrate 240 million 2G users to 4G and 5G networks over the next five years.

India-U.S. trade deal's first tranche 'finalised'

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The first tranche of the India-U.S. trade deal has been "finalised", Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal said on Thursday at an event in Delhi. He added what remained were the "final contours" and legal vetting, and that the deal would be implemented once there was clarity on India's competitive edge over its peers.

Mr. Goyal's comments come soon after Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said negotiations on the deal had "plateaued", with little room for further give and take. Before that, U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer remarked that while the two countries were nearing the end of negotiations, he did not "think there's something imminent".

Separately, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal also spoke optimistically about the deal with the U.S. "We are in a very good zone," Mr. Agrawal told reporters on Thursday.

'There is parallel work being done in the U.S. also to get back the tariff structure and based on some of the outcomes under Section 301, we would sign the deal,' he added.

Wipro Q2 net slips 1.4%, large deals dive

Mini Tejaswi
BENGALURU

Wipro Ltd. reported a 1.4% year-on-year (YoY) dip in net profit to ₹3,201 crore in Q2FY27 (4.7% sequentially) amid a sharp contraction in large deal bookings and flat constant-currency revenue growth.

Gross revenue rose 9.1% to ₹24,752.7 crore (1.1% sequential dip).

Workforce slid by 6,716.

Total project bookings stood at $2,595 million, down 22.9% sequentially in constant currency terms. Large deal bookings slid 58.6% to $674 million.

Wipro's strategic investments were starting to deliver results, strengthening ability to win in new markets, add clients and expand existing relationships, said Srini Pallia, CEO and MD.

"At the same time, our consulting-led, AI-powered strategy is helping us create larger transformation opportunities."

Aparna Iyer, CFO, said IT services operating margin expanded 0.5 percentage points sequentially to 16.5%.

Wipro's workforce slid by 6,716 sequentially to 2,36,328 as of September 30, which the company attributed to routine realignment with demand, supply and flat utilisation.

Sensex, Nifty surge 2%, rupee stronger

Gowri Lakshmi
MUMBAI

Benchmark indices Nifty 50 and BSE Sensex extended rally and ended 2% higher compared with the previous close. The Sensex ended 1,533 points or 2% up at 74,315 while the Nifty 50 closed at 22,997, up 374.65 points or 1.6%.

The indices defied other Asian markets dragged

Rupee closed 0.1% higher

down by speculation over AI stocks, concerns over rising U.S. inflation and a likely interest rate hike by the U.S. Federal Reserve.

"AI deceleration in stocks globally, positive corporate earnings especially in banking so far and an anticipation of further rate hike by Fed has turned out to be a blessing in disguise for Indian markets," V. K. Vijayakumar, chief investment strategist at Geojit Investments said.

However, analysts said a sustained rally for the stock market may be unlikely unless the Iran-U.S. conflict is resolved and till the crude continued to trade over $100/barrel,

Rupee boost

The Indian rupee also strengthened for the fourth consecutive trading day following a weaker dollar, closing at 95.5 against the greenback, up 0.1%.

Essar Oil bags five coal bed methane blocks

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Essar Oil & Gas Ltd. has secured five coal bed methane (CBM) blocks under the government's bidding rounds of 2025 and 2026, adding 1,281 sq. km. of acreage across West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh and Telangana.

The blocks hold an estimated 6.6 trillion cubic feet of gas-in-place resources, strengthening the company's presence in India's unconventional gas sector.

Essar has secured two blocks each in WB's Raniganj and Telangana's Godavari Valley, and one in MP's Singrauli. The firm already holds about 500 sq. km. of acreage in WB's Raniganj, with the two newly-awarded blocks adding another 330 sq km. India has an estimated CBM resource base of 2,600 billion cubic metres (BCM).

Coal Bed Methane is an unconventional source of natural gas trapped within coal seams, unlike conventional gas, which accumulates in the pore spaces of reservoir rocks.

Kingfisher: HC asks why claim more post ₹14,131-cr. recovery

Krishnaprasad
BENGALURU

Observing a consortium of banks already recovered ₹14,131.6 crore assets from fugitive businessman Vijay Mallya against an outstanding of ₹6,203 crore extended to the now-defunct Kingfisher Airlines, the High Court of Karnataka questioned the banks' action of continuing to claim over 2.09 crore United Breweries Ltd. (UBL) shares held by him and his son before they were attached by the authorities.

The court noted Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman had informed the Lok Sabha on December 17, 2024, that assets worth ₹14,131.6 crore, besides UBL shares, was restored to the consortium.

A Division Bench made the observations while allowing two petitions filed by Diageo Holdings Netherlands B.V and setting aside the 2017-18 orders passed by the Debt Recovery Tribunal and Debt Recovery Appellate Tribunal, which had the consortium attach

The High Court of Karnataka

1,04,86,666 UBL shares held by Mr. Vijay Mallya and 1,04,64,288 shares jointly held by him and son Siddhartha Mallya.

The Bench observed, "We are also of the view that it is Vijay Mallya's flamboyant lifestyle, excessive personal indulgence and personal vanity are coming in the way of giving quietus to the claims of the consortium of banks against the loan of ₹6,203 crore advanced to the defunct Kingfisher Airlines Ltd."

However, the Bench added "it is for the consortium of banks and the Government of India to give quietus to proceedings."

SC voids Yes Bank's $883 mn AT-1 bond write-off

Reuters
NEW DELHI/MUMBAI

India's Supreme Court on Thursday set aside Yes Bank's write-off of ₹84 billion ($883.70 million) in additional tier-1 bonds, dealing a blow to the lender and regulators that had defended the 2020 wipe-out.

Reuters had reviewed a copy of the order.

Yes Bank, in which Japan's Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation now holds a 24% stake, was declared insolvent six years ago. Under a restructuring scheme, new investors were brought in and its AT1 bonds were written off, while equity holders faced only a three-year lock-in on 75% of their shares.

AT1 bonds are high-risk debt instruments that offer higher returns but can be written off or converted into equity when a bank comes under stress.

Yes Bank's AT1 bondholders challenged the write-off and the Bombay High Court ruled in their favour in 2023. Yes Bank, the RBI and the Union government appealed that ruling.

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
MARKETING DEPARTMENT **e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE**

e-Tenders are invited for supply of **1) 3,20,000 Kgs of Cane Jaggery or Cane Gur 2) 90,000 Kgs of Cardamom (Elachi) 8 mm size CGEB Variety through e- tenders to the Marketing Department, T.T.Devasthanams,.** For Tender notice and tender details log on to the web site **http:// www.tirumala.org** and **https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in.** For further details contact phone numbers: **0877-2264079, 2264555, FAX No: 0877-2264554.**

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.221) Date:15-10-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER P.W.D. ELECT. DIVISION, SECTT, JAIPUR.

File No.1720 Date: 09-10-2026

SHORT TERM NIT No 18 / 2026-27

Bid for one Electric work for invited from interested bidder upto 06:00 PM Time, Date 25.10.2026. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in) of the state; and Public Work Department website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 272.41 Lacs.

UBN NO. PWD2627WSOB14764 Executive Engineer,
PWD, Electric Division Sectt
DIPR/C/17662/2026 Jaipur

कार्यालय नगर परिषद बून्दी

क्रमांकः– 8394 दिनांकः– 12.10.2026

–:: निविदा सूचना ::–

नगर परिषद बून्दी द्वारा जारी निविदा संः न0प0बू0/निर्माण/2026–27/8378 दिनांक 12/10/2026 की निविदा दिनांक 21/10/2026 से दिनांक 02/11/2026 06.00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन विक्रय की जावेगी। उक्त कार्य की BG (Bank Guarantee) दिनांक 03/11/2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे दिनांक 03/11/2026 को 6.00 बजे तक जमा करवाई जा सकती है। निविदा दिनांक 04/11/2026 को 04.00 बजे ऑनलाईन खोली जावेगी। विस्तृत शर्ते व विवरण निविदा **sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर **DLB2627WSOB21964**, तथा कार्यालय समय मे किसी भी कार्यदिवस को नगर परिषद मे देखा जा सकता है। आयुक्त

राज.संवाद/सी/26/11896 नगर परिषद, बून्दी

THE RAJASTHAN SMALL INDUSTRIES CORPORATION LTD.
(A Government of Rajasthan Undertaking Concern)
Udyog Bhawan, Tilak Marg, C-Scheme, Jaipur-302005
Phone: 0141-2227267Fax: 0141-2227257 **Website:**http://industries.rajasthan.gov.in/rajsico
E-mail:rajsico@rajasthan.gov.in CIN- U91110RJ1961SGC001118

CORRIGENDUM
RSI2627SLOB00026

RSIC invited bids vide NIT No. 27/2026-27 for Expression of Interest for leasing out the Ground Floor of Rajasthali Mall, Jaipur. Pursuant to the decisions recorded in the Pre-Bid Meeting, the following amendments are hereby made in the tender document:

1. Permission for Restaurant:
   Permission to open/operate a restaurant at the leased premises is allowed. However, the common areas such as gallery, passage, parking area, etc. shall not be permitted to be used for restaurant purposes.
2. Gestation/Renovation Period:
   A gestation period of two months shall be provided to the successful bidder for renovation/development of the premises. No rent, electricity charges or other applicable charges shall be levied during this two-month gestation period.

All other terms and conditions of the NIT shall remain unchanged.The last date and time for submission of bids has been extended till 1 PM on 22.10.2026.

Raj.Samwad/C/26/11989 **Managing Director**

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.
(Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of Kerala)
THYCAUD P.O., THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 695014
0471-2945600, 2945646), CIN. U24233KL2007SGC021616
E-mail: admin.kmscl@kerala.gov.in, website: www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in

No. KMSCL/Admn/23/2026 Dated : 14.09.2026

E-Tender Notice- Courier Services

E-tenders are invited from competent courier agencies for the supply of medicines and other related items from various District Drug Warehouse, Karunya Drug Depots and Karunya Community Pharmacies of Kerala Medical Services Corporation Ltd. The tender amount is Rs. 14,514/- (including GST) and the last date for submission of e-tenders is **24.10.2026.** For more information, visit **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in**

(Sd/-) Managing Director

COCHIN PORT कोचिन पत्तन प्राधिकरण Cochin Port Authority
Chief Engineer's Office
Cochin - 682009

E- TENDER NOTICE

Online Bids are invited for the following:

T10/T-2117/2026-C Dated 19/10/2026 Reconstruction of Marar Road and G.V. Iyyer Road with CC Paver Blocks, RCC Drains, Box Culverts, Utility Ducts etc., at W/Island	₹ 8.45 Cr. + GST	Available from 19.10.2026 onwards
T10/T-2118/2026-C Dated 16/10/2026 Reconstruction of deck slab of Q5 to Q9 Berths and Construction of a Mooring Platform at Ernakulam Wharf	₹ 50.77 Cr. + GST	Available from 16.10.2026 onwards

For details, visit - www.cochinport.gov.in or www.tenders.gov.in or www.tenderwizard.com/COPT

Sd/-
CHIEF ENGINEER
(Ph. No. 0484-258 2400/2404)

WEST BENGAL STATE ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED
(A Government of West Bengal Enterprise)
Registered Office: Vidyut Bhavan,Block-DJ, Sector-II, Bidhannagar, Kolkata-700091
CIN: U40101WB2007SGC113474 • web: www.wbsetcl.in

WBSETCL

NIT No.: CE(P)/WBSETCL/Line Pkg-C11 (2nd call)/26-27/32 Date: 16.10.2026

Under the jurisdiction of Chief Engineer (Procurement)

Work Details, Route Length & Completion Period	Description of Work
PROJECT-I	E-Tender is invited for construction of 400 kV D/C Transmission Line with twin HTLS (equivalent to Quad Moose) to make LILO of one circuit of Arambag-New PPSP 400 kV D/C at proposed Generation Station of JSW (Salboni).
RL = 68 K.M. OH (approx.) SC = 1.8 K.M. OH (approx.)	
24 months from the date of placement of LOA	

Bid documents can be downloaded from 16.10.2026, 11:00 A.M. and bids shall be submitted online up to 03:00 P.M., 11.11.2026. Visit the following websites - www.wbtenders.gov.in, www.wbsetcl.in for details.

ICA- T19113(3)/2026

DUBAI

India opens additional control room in Mecca to assist pilgrims

REUTERS

India has established an additional control room in Mecca to assist its Umrah pilgrims affected by flight disruptions between India and Saudi Arabia, the Indian Consulate in Jeddah has said. Indian nationals requiring assistance can contact the Mecca control room at +966 553646966, the consulate said in a post on X. PTI

WASHINGTON

Trump scraps plan to livestream execution after broad backlash

AFP

The firing squad execution of Nidal Hasan, a convicted military base shooter, will not be livestreamed, U.S. President Donald Trump announced on Thursday, cancelling a contentious plan by Secretary of War Pete Hegseth. Hasan "will die, as scheduled, by firing squad, but this event will not be streamed," Mr. Trump said. AFP

NEW YORK

Teen arrested in U.S. for plotting attack on Hindu place of worship

AFP

Alexandros Paporakis, 19, of Palatine village was arrested on October 11 for allegedly plotting to carry out a "mass shooting" at a Hindu place of worship in the U.S. State of Illinois, with investigators recovering a manifesto expressing white supremacist ideology and references to violence against people of Indian descent. PTI

SEOUL

N. Korea holds first underwater missile tests in nearly three years

AP

North Korea performed its first underwater-launched missile tests in nearly three years on Wednesday, likely from an as-yet-deployed submarine that it says is designed to launch nuclear weapons. The official *KCNA* said that the military tested two types of strategic cruise missiles in the country's eastern waters. AP

Russia restarts diesel exports after Trump deal: Kremlin

Reuters
MOSCOW

The Kremlin said on Thursday that Russian diesel had begun to reach global markets following an agreement with U.S. President Donald Trump.

Mr. Trump said last week that Russia had agreed to supply diesel to global markets in an effort to lower fuel prices, while Moscow partially lifted its ban on diesel exports from October 10 following the agreement.

"The diesel has started reaching global markets and is expected to have a positive effect on stabilising oil markets, although it will not be enough to fully stabilise them," Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov told presspersons.

Ukraine pounds Russian oil sites as U.S. relations teeter

Brief energy truce over, says Zelenskyy; he adds that Ukraine will resume strikes on Russian oil refineries as Moscow continues attacking; Lavrov calls Kyiv's attacks 'direct challenge' to Trump

Associated Press
KYIV

Ukrainian drones attacked a refinery in Russia's Ryazan region early Thursday, hours after Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said that a brief truce spurned by Moscow was over amid deepening tensions with Washington.

The drone strike started a fire at the refinery about 300 km southeast of Moscow, Russia's Defence Ministry and Ryazan Governor Pavel Malkov said. Russia's *Astra* online news outlet posted what it said was a photograph of the blaze.

Rising tensions: Fire and a thick plume of smoke rise in the vicinity of the Ryazan oil refinery in Ryazan region of Russia in May. REUTERS

A senior Ukrainian official confirmed that Ukraine had hit the refinery. The strike could further complicate Kyiv's relations with U.S. President Donald Trump, which have soured again in recent days.

Mr. Zelenskyy was outraged by Russia's continuing aerial bombardment of his country's energy infrastructure in apparent defiance of Mr. Trump's demand on Sunday for both sides to halt those attacks. He added that that Ukrainian attacks on Russian oil refineries would resume.

Conflicting accounts

The Ukrainian government said that it was heeding the ceasefire, but Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov said on Thursday that Ukraine never stopped its strikes on refineries that have hurt Russia.

Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov labelled Ukraine's strikes on oil facilities as a "direct and crude challenge to President Trump".

Israel says commercial goods will not enter Gaza

Associated Press
JERUSALEM

Displaced Palestinian children receive food from a charity kitchen at the Nuseirat refugee camp in the central Gaza Strip. AFP

Israel said that commercial goods will no longer enter the Gaza Strip, cutting off a key source of food and shelter supply for the war-torn territory as hungry Palestinians face the approach of winter.

COGAT, the Israeli military body that oversees humanitarian affairs in Gaza, announced the suspension of commercial goods in a Wednesday statement. It was not clear whether they made the decision. COGAT said it was relaying a statement from Gaza merchants, a claim Palestinians refuted.

The move stands to immediately reduce Gaza's supplies, because the closed-off territory is completely reliant on whatever goods Israel allows in through border crossings. The suspension also raised fears about affordability, with humanitarian workers saying a combination of aid and a robust commercial market is needed to keep prices under control.

"The humanitarian sector on its own cannot meet the needs of all the people," said Shaina Low, a spokesperson for the Norwegian Refugee Council, an aid group.

The world's leading authority on food insecurity reported earlier that conditions in Gaza had improved since famine was declared in the territory in August 2025, but were still at crisis levels.

Netanyahu rival vows to end Hamas rule within 18 months

Agence France-Presse
ISRAEL-GAZA BORDER

Israeli Opposition politician Gadi Eisenkot, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's main rival in upcoming elections, vowed on Thursday to end Hamas rule in Gaza if he wins office following the October 27 vote.

"Today I give a public commitment: from the moment I enter the Prime Minister's Office, within 18 months Hamas will no longer rule the Gaza Strip," the leader of the centre-right Yashar party said at a press conference near the war-ravaged Palestinian territory.

Gadi Eisenkot

He said he would achieve this either by implementing U.S. President Donald Trump's ceasefire plan, which provides for the gradual disarmament of Hamas and a transfer of power, or through "creative operations" by Israel's military aimed at destroying the Palestinian movement's military wing.

Yemen's Houthis hit presidential palace in Aden; four killed

Agence France-Presse
ADEN

The Houthis (Ansar Allah) launched a deadly missile attack on Thursday on the presidential palace in the Yemeni government's interim capital of Aden, as Saudi Arabia blamed Iran for the recent dramatic escalation in the long-running war.

Government military sources in Yemen said at least four people were killed and 10 wounded in Thursday's strikes on Aden's Al-Maashiq palace, which also serves as the government's headquarters in the divided country's south.

Yemeni Information Minister Moammar al-Eryani said the Prime Minister and Cabinet Ministers were safe, adding the attack had been carried out with five missiles. A government Minister said on condition of anonymity that Prime Minister Shaya al-Zindani had been present at the time, but "was not harmed in any way".

Earlier on Thursday, the Saudi-led military coalition fighting Houthis said it had intercepted a cruise missile in the Medina region – home to one of Islam's holiest cities, but the Houthis denied carrying out any such attack.

Medina is one of Islam's holiest cities alongside Mecca.

34 children, teacher killed as school roof collapses in northwest Pakistan

Press Trust of India
PESHAWAR

At least 34 children and a teacher were killed when the roof of a private school collapsed on Thursday in Peshawar, the capital of Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, hospital authorities and police said.

The incident occurred in Dir Colony in the congested inner city area, Peshawar Capital City Police chief Mian Saeed said. Thirty students were present in classrooms on the upper floor of the Al-Khair School when the roof collapsed, he said.

The owner, who was operating the institution as an education trust, has been arrested, he said, adding that the roof of the three-storey building was poorly constructed.

Army soldiers and rescue workers gather after a school roof collapse in Peshawar, Pakistan, on Thursday. REUTERS

Thirty-two children and a teacher were brought dead to the Lady Reading Hospital (LRH) in Peshawar, hospital spokesperson Muhammad Asim said.

Mr. Asim said 20 injured children were also brought to the LRH hospital. Most of them were discharged after first aid. Three critically injured children, who sustained head injuries, had been admitted to the hospital, he added.

Peshawar Deputy Commissioner Afaq Wazir said all people trapped beneath the debris have been rescued. He also ordered a probe into the building collapse.

According to the city police chief, the building was located in narrow streets, which made rescue operations difficult. He said the authorities will examine which building regulations had been violated and conduct a proper inquiry into the incident.

Building and roof collapses are common in Pakistan and are often attributed to poor safety standards and the use of substandard construction materials.

WEIGHTY ISSUES

The Player-of-the-Match trophies are a bit heavy, says Hope

NAGARA GOPAL

To be honest, those (PoM trophies) are a bit heavy and we got to look at luggage weight. I think we're gonna have some problems when I go back home with those awards — West Indies captain Shai Hope after claiming his second award in the series in the fourth T20I against India in Hyderabad to go with the one in the third ODI.

POSITIVE SIGN

'Tilak and Nitish absorbing pressure was great to see'

AP

A resurgence from local boys Tilak Varma and Nitish Kumar gave India hope in the fourth T20I before things fell apart. "When Tilak and Nitish were batting, we were still in the game. That is a great thing to have after losing five wickets... having that kind of control, two young cricketers taking on the pressure," said Sanju Samson.

ELITE COMPANY

Paul becomes first WI bowler to claim multiple five-fors in T20Is

NAGARA GOPAL

Keemo Paul became the first West Indies bowler to claim multiple five-wicket hauls in T20Is. He took five for 41 against India in the fourth T20I to join an elite group from Full Member nations to achieve the feat. The list includes Lasith Malinga, Umar Gul, Tim Southee, Bhuvneshwar Kumar and Mustafizur Rahman.

CALLING IT A DAY

Punam Raut retires from all forms of international cricket

GETTY IMAGES

Indian women's team's top-order batter Punam Raut on Thursday announced her retirement from all forms of international cricket with immediate effect. The 37-year-old Punam played four Tests, 73 ODIs and 35 T20Is, scoring 3282 runs with four centuries, between 2009 and 2021. She also claimed four wickets.

Aggressive Norgaard takes the lead on a rain-hit opening day

The Dane shoots six-under 66; McKibbin, Detry and Chacarra tied for second spot; McIlroy in joint 13th place; Om Prakash best among the Indians with a four-under-par 68; 12 players do not get to tee off as nearly five hours of play lost

GOLF

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

Danish golfer Niklas Norgaard sprang a surprise to take the sole lead on the opening day of the DP World India Championship at the Delhi Golf Club on Thursday.

On a rain-affected day, nearly five hours of play were lost. Norgaard, however, navigated the challenging conditions well to card six-under-par 66 to climb to the top of the leaderboard.

Norgaard went for broke in the first hole. After a pinpoint tee shot, he followed up with an impressive approach and sank a six-foot putt to return an eagle. The 34-year-old, who started on the back nine, explained his aggressive approach. "I hit a five-iron off the tee. As I walked up, I thought I had played a little too conservatively before, so I wanted to just go for it."

Norgaard finished the round with two straight birdies.

Seizing the initiative: Norgaard got going in challenging conditions. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Fan favourite Rory McIlroy had an uneventful round, shooting a two-under-par 70 to lie tied 13th.

The lengthy rain delay appeared to disrupt McIlroy's rhythm. The Northern Irishman returned to his hotel during the break before making his way back to the course when the rain subsided.

Detry... lying tied-second.

"It took me a little while to get going again," McIlroy said.

The six-time Major champion was not overly concerned about his position. "The leaders have not gotten too far ahead. There is a lot of golf left," he added.

McIlroy's chief rival in the Race to Dubai, Eugenio Chacarra, fared better, moving into a tied second place with a five-under-par 67.

Chacarra held the outright lead heading into the ninth and final hole, but a late bogey – caused by pulling his tee shot left into the unforgiving rough – derailed his charge.

Second in the Race to Dubai standings, the Spaniard is also managing pain after breaking a toe a couple of weeks ago. "I'm still taking some medicines, but I'm feeling better every day," he said.

It was a great day for Om Prakash Chouhan, who carded a four-under-par 68 to emerge as the best-performing Indian. "I had just one simple plan today – do not miss the fairway," the experienced professional said.

For the 12 players who did not get to tee off, a long day of 36 holes awaits on Friday.

The scores (top five): Niklas Norgaard 66; Tom McKibbin, Thomas Detry, Eugenio Chacarra 67; Scott Jamieson, Ewen Ferguson, Robert Macintyre, Om Prakash Chouhan, Marcus Armitage, Adrian Meronk 68.

McIlroy-Reed mend fences after rift

Water under the bridge: Reed and McIlroy have put their LIV-PGA rivalry behind them. FILE PHOTO

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

The tense relationship between Rory McIlroy and Patrick Reed appeared to ease as the two golfers exchanged pleasantries at the Delhi Golf Club during the DP World India Championship here.

The rift began a few years ago when Reed moved to LIV Golf while McIlroy remained fiercely loyal to the PGA Tour.

Things got ugly, at least by genteel golf standards, at the 2023 Hero Dubai Desert Classic, when McIlroy appeared to ignore Reed at the practice range. Reed responded by flicking a LIV-branded tee towards McIlroy. McIlroy later revealed that he was miffed at being served a subpoena by Reed's lawyer on Christmas Eve, some months earlier.

Speaking after carding a two-under-par first round on Thursday, McIlroy suggested that it was best to leave the past behind. "There are no lawsuits anymore, so that helps (laughs)," he said.

The Northern Irishman, who is currently battling Reed in the Race to Dubai, added that he respected the way his rival had returned to the fold. Earlier this year, Reed quit LIV Golf, which perhaps helped clear the way for the two golf giants to find common ground.

"Patrick has put his head down and let the clubs do the talking. Patrick and I have had some battles over the years, and I respect him as a competitor. The character he has shown in coming back to the PGA Tour has meant a lot to the guys on the Tour. He has done it the right way. That speaks a lot about who he is and how he has evolved," McIlroy said.

PGTI plans to hike prize money next season: CEO

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

The Professional Golf Tour of India (PGTI) plans to increase the prize money in its events next season, PGTI CEO Amandeep Johl said. "We are going to switch from having the week-in-week-out tournaments. We will have the smaller tournaments in 'B' cities. We want to have bigger tournaments – ₹1.5 to ₹2 crore prize money upwards. The plan is to upgrade the existing tournaments," Johl said on the sidelines of the DP World India Championship.

"We want to make them higher prize money tournaments, with more world-ranking points, and then provide an opportunity to the youngsters who miss out on qualifying school," Johl said. He added that two ADT events, set to be held in February, have nearly been finalised.

Johl. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Smriti eyes winning start to her captaincy journey

ZIMBABWE IN INDIA

Press Trust of India
RAIPUR

India will look to refine its T20 game as the era of new captain Smriti Mandhana begins with a three-match series against Zimbabwe here on Friday. It will be the first time India and Zimbabwe face each other in a bilateral assignment.

India recently reaffirmed its dominance at the Asian level but it remains a work in progress on the global stage.

On the batting front, the team is struggling to maintain momentum in the middle overs after the flying starts provided by Smriti and Shafali Verma. The No. 3 spot has become a case of musical chairs and the form of Smriti's predecessor, Harmanpreet Kaur, is a concern.

Playing as a specialist batter, Harmanpreet will be under more pressure to deliver.

The fielding has let India down on a number of occasions while the recent rise of Nandani Sharma has been a big positive in the bowling department.

Spin has traditionally been India's strength with the young Shree Charani standing out and veteran all-rounder Deepti Sharma also troubling the batters. The fresh faces in the squad are Niki Prasad and Jintimani Kalita.

The proven pair: Smriti and Shafali have done the heavy lifting for India more often than not. BCCI

The series presents an ideal opportunity for a high-on-confidence Zimbabwe, which beat the West Indies in an ODI last month. It will be captained by Josephine Nkomo.

The teams (from):

India: Smriti Mandhana (Capt.), Shafali Verma (Vice-capt.), Niki Prasad, Harmanpreet Kaur, Anushka Sharma, Richa Ghosh (wk), G. Kamalini (wk), Deepti Sharma, Prema Rawat, Shree Charani, Nandani Sharma, Kranti Gaud, Arundhati Reddy, Jintimani Kalita, Minnu Mani.

Zimbabwe: Josephine Nkomo (Capt.), Beloved Biza, Chipo Mugeri-Tiripano, Kelis Ndhlovu, Michelle Mavunga, Francisca Chipare, Olinder Chare, Kudzai Chigora, Nyasha Gwanzura, Nomvelo Sibanda, Loryn Phiri, Chiyedza Dhururu, Modester Mupachikwa, Tendai Makusha, Sharne Mayers.

Match starts at 7 p.m.

Bowlers shouldn't be too hard on themselves on bad days: Paul

WI IN INDIA

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

At the Rajiv Gandhi International Cricket Stadium, a 10-over-old ball tends to stick in the surface, fertile ground for a clever bowler to deploy his variations and potentially change the face of the game.

For West Indies, in its series-levelling win here on Wednesday, Keemo Paul was that man.

'Execute or be executed,' were his famous words to the Windies during the India series and he did just that. In his sensational five-wicket haul in the fourth T20I, Paul first removed a marauding Sanju Samson and Ishan Kishan in the span of four balls, using his pace to cramp the batter and drawing out edges before snapping up the key scalp of Nitish Kumar in the 19th to effectively snuff India's hopes of an unlikely win. He dismissed Prince Yadav and Axar Patel to get to the milestone a few deliveries later, becoming the first West Indian bowler to register multiple five-fors in T20Is. He also became just the second man to claim a five-for against India in the format, following compatriot Obed McCoy (six for 17 in Basseterre, 2022).

Strike force: Paul scalped key wickets. NAGARA GOPAL

"We have some pretty long team bowling meetings. So we don't take that (success with the ball) for granted. I knew what I wanted to do, I knew what my field setting was, and I knew my plan," he said, adding, "Obviously, I won't share my plan (with you), but I think I executed pretty well tonight."

A lack of dew in the second innings worked right into the visitors' plans, Paul acknowledged.

"From the batters' perspective, after the first five overs, the message we got was it was a pretty good wicket. One or two balls were gripping, but other than that, it was pretty good. Normally, we weren't getting any grip, but it actually worked here. The game plan was to stick bowling into the wicket as long as possible."

The 28-year-old, whose promising career has seen its share of injury interruptions, also declared that "bowlers shouldn't be too hard on themselves" on bad days given the nature of wickets the format now gets.

"The margin for error is very, very thin. It all comes down to execution. It's just about one day at a time. It's all about the process. Once you try to stick to the team plan as much as possible, I don't think the (coaching) staff would have a problem (if it doesn't work out in the end)".

Chola Chiefs returns to winning ways

APL

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

Chola Chiefs ended a five-match losing streak, beating Prithviraaj Yodhas in a shootoff in the Archery Premier League Season 2 at People's Plaza on Thursday.

Chiefs were on course to seal the contest in straight sets, when their recurve archers Yuktha Sri and Marcus D'Almeida landed the arrows into the seven-ring, giving Yodhas a way back into the contest.

A superb 10 from Gatha Khadake in the fourth set levelled the scores. Alejandra Usquiano, who shot 80 out of 80 in regulation time, and Yuktha Sri did not falter in the shootoff to give Chiefs their second win.

Later, Mighty Marathas got off to a nightmare start as it was unable to shoot its final arrow in both the first and second sets, with Alejandra Valencia and Mrinal Chauhan succumbing to time pressure. While it bounced back to take the third set, Rajputana Royals emerged 6-2 winner. Tokyo Olympic champion Mete Gazoz delivered a 10 with his last arrow for Royals.

In the final match, Chero Archers sailed past Kakatiya Knights in three sets.

The scores:
Chola Chiefs tied with Prithviraaj Yodhas 4-4 (76-72, 78-77, 72-75, 74-77). Chiefs won 2-0 in shootoff.
Rajputana Royals bt Mighty Marathas 6-2 (77-65, 75-66, 73-76, 77-74).
Chero Archers bt Kakatiya Knights 6-0 (76-73, 77-76, 75-74).

Perfect outing: Usquiano shot 80 out of 80 in regulation time and then delivered in the shootoff for Chiefs. ARCHERY PREMIER LEAGUE

INBRIEF

Greco-Roman wrestler More wins silver at u-23 Worlds

Vishvajit More on Wednesday became the first Indian Greco-Roman wrestler to win a silver medal at the u-23 World championships in Las Vegas. More, has two bronze medals in his collection, was gunning for a historic gold but lost a fiercely fought 55kg final 12-13 to Georgia's Koba Karumidze. More, who had opened his campaign with a close 10-8 win over Mexico's Isaac Marin Mata, beat Iranian u-20 world champion Armin Shamsipour 8-1 in the quarterfinals before prevailing 7-4 in the semifinal against Russia's Malik Gigiev.

Breetzke replaces Stubbs in SA squad for second Test

South Africa has called up Matthew Breetzke and dropped Tristan Stubbs from its squad for the second Test against Australia in Gqeberha, coach Shukri Conrad said on Thursday.

The squad: Temba Bavuma (Capt.), Marques Ackerman, David Bedingham, Matthew Breetzke, Corbin Bosch, Gerald Coetzee, Simon Harmer, Marco Jansen, Keshav Maharaj, Aiden Markram, Wiaan Mulder, Senuran Muthusamy, Anrich Nortje, Dane Paterson, Kagiso Rabada, Ryan Rickelton, and Kyle Verreynne.

Vinicius to miss Clasico after getting four-match ban

Real Madrid winger Vinicius Junior will miss the upcoming Clasico in LaLiga against Barcelona after being issued a four-match suspension on Wednesday following his red card for hair-pulling against Villarreal last week. The Spanish football federation's disciplinary committee confirmed the Brazilian will be banned for several matches including the visit to face league leader Barca on October 25 for both the red card and his subsequent protests. As well as the Clasico, Vinicius will be unavailable to face Sevilla (Sunday), Racing Santander (November 1) and Valencia (November 7) in LaLiga.

Satya packs off Aarav; Ribhav stays on course for double

Satya Chintagunta knocked out No. 1 seed Aarav Challani 4-6, 6-4, 6-1 in the boys' under-14 quarterfinal of the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship in New Delhi on Thursday. Under-18 champion Ribhav Saroha continued his bid for a double crown, advancing to the under-16 semifinals with a 6-2, 6-2 win over P. Nallagundla.

Other results (quarterfinals):
Under-16: Boys: Yashwin Dahiya bt Yaj Malik 6-3, 6-1; Vivaan Mirdha bt Harsh Marwaha 6-4, 6-4; Kushagra Arora bt Monodip Dey 6-2, 4-6, 6-1.
Girls: Aaradhya Meena bt Shravee Deore 3-6, 6-4, 6-3; Akshita Antil bt Pooja Nagaraj 6-4, 1-0, retd.; Ranjhana Sangram bt Rishita Yadav 7-5, 6-3; Khushi Kadian bt Aahida Singh 6-3, 5-7, 7-6(2).
Under-14: Boys: Puneeth Manohar bt Adeshbir Ghuman 6-3, 6-1; Sujai Pothula bt Nibras Hussain 6-3, 6-4.
Girls: Siddhi Pandey bt Saatvi Mardaniya 6-4, 6-1; Aaradhana Tehlan bt Purvi Patwa 1-6, 6-3, 6-0.

Delhi HC proposes grievance redressal cell in Hockey India

The upcoming Hockey India elections will be conducted under the observation of Supreme Court Justice (retd.) A.K. Sikri after the Delhi High Court named him for the role while listening to a petition by president Dilip Tirkey. Justice Amit Mahajan on Thursday proposed the constitution of a Grievance Redressal Cell (GRC) within Hockey India to address any issues arising in the matter and proposed the appointment of Sikri as its chairperson. While the detailed order was yet to be received, the proposal appears to contemplate an institutional mechanism for the consideration and redressal of grievances. The composition, terms of reference, jurisdiction, and operational framework of the proposed GRC, together with the status of the proposed appointment, would be subject to the court's further directions and any formal order. Tirkey had filed the petition last week seeking judicial intervention in the election process, claiming they were announced by executive board meetings deemed illegal and without his approval as per the Hockey India bye-laws.

Bhuvneshwar will have a big impact: Southee

The former Kiwi pacer feels the experienced India swing bowler will fire on all cylinders in his comeback series, predicts New Zealand to edge the visiting side in the Test assignment

CRICKET

Sankar Narayanan E.H.

Tim Southee is an authority on swing bowling.

Ahead of India's multi-format tour of New Zealand, the former Kiwi pacer shared his thoughts on all things fast bowling and much more.

On Bhuvneshwar Kumar's recall to the Indian T20I squad, Southee said: "He'll be thrilled to have another opportunity, which he probably didn't think was going to come. He's a very skilful and experienced bowler. And Bhuvneshwar probably knows his game better than he ever has. He's still bowling extremely well in the best franchise competition in the world, the IPL... he'll have a big impact."

Age no bar: Bhuvneshwar has shown that he is not done yet at the top level. FILE PHOTO: K.R. DEEPAK

Bumrah factor

For all of Jasprit Bumrah's global dominance, New Zealand has been a bugbear for the pace ace in the longest format. He has lost all five Tests, returning nine wickets at an average of 45.44 (career: 19.79) and strike-rate of 92.8 (42.8).

"New Zealand has played Bumrah incredibly well in Test cricket. I don't think Bumrah has played in an Indian team that's beaten New Zealand. I'm a big fan of Mohammed Siraj and the way he bowls. He could be a handful if he can get his length right. There's a lot to like about Siraj in particular. There's no reason why the other bowlers in and around Bumrah won't be able to trouble the New Zealand batters," Southee said during a virtual interaction on Thursday.

On the challenges facing India's top-order in early-season Kiwi conditions, Southee said: "When you're playing in India, arguably the easiest time to bat is with the new ball before it starts to turn. In New Zealand, it's almost the other way around... the hardest time to bat is with the new ball."

The 37-year-old also gave his prediction for the two-Test series.

"There will be a bit of weather around.. I'll go 1-0 to New Zealand."

(Watch India tour of New Zealand live and exclusive on Sony Sports Network and Sony LIV starting October 22).

Keepsake: PM Modi being presented a signed jersey by Harmanpreet Kaur as Smriti Mandhana looks on. X@NARENDRAMODI

PM meets Asian Games medal winners

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday met India's Asian Games medal-winners, including the gold-winning men's and women's cricket teams, at the Major Dhyan Chand Stadium here and was presented with memorabilia ranging from signed jerseys to a bow from 17-year-old archery sensation Kumkum Mohod.

India won 85 medals at the games, including 21 gold. "You have made 140 crore Indians proud. The biggest success is to make the tri-colour fly highI congratulate you on behalf of the entire country," the PM said in his address to the medal winners.

LIVE TELECAST

Golf: DP World India Championship, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 12 p.m.
Archery Premier League: Sony LIV, 7.30 p.m.
ISL: Sony LIV, 7.30 p.m.

Miller-Uibo targeting 400m world record

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

Miller-Uibo.

The mention of Shaunae Miller-Uibo elicits memories of her famous dive across the finish line to win gold in the women's 400m at the 2016 Rio Olympics. It helped the Bahamian track and field sprinter, who specialises in the 200m and 400m, pip Allyson Felix by 0.07 seconds for the yellow metal.

A decade has passed, but Miller-Uibo, who is in India for the first time in her capacity as an international ambassador for Sunday's Vedanta Delhi Half Marathon, remembers the moment vividly.

"I remember that when I had covered the first 100m, I felt very great. But with 50m to go, I did not have anything left to give. I heard everyone's footsteps around me. I saw Allyson in my (peripheral) view and that is what had me leaning towards the line," she took a trip down memory lane at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium here on Thursday evening.

She went on to defend her gold medal five years later at the Tokyo Olympics. She also won gold at the 2022 Eugene World Championships. However, the 32-year-old isn't done yet, never mind that she is now the mother of two children.

With the World Championships slated for 2027 followed by the 2028 LA Olympics, Miller-Uibo, whose personal best in 400m is 48.36 seconds, is still targeting the world record. That belongs to East Germany's Marita Koch, who was timed at 47.60s in 1985. In the 200m, Miller-Uibo's personal best is 21.74 seconds while Florence Griffith-Joyner (21.34s) holds the world record.

"I had two babies. One in 2023 and another in 2025. I have been building back up ever since. This season went really well for me. I was trying to shake off the rust. It is about setting new goals for myself. I would like to give a crack at the world record. I feel I am more than capable of doing it," she asserted.

Batting remains an area of concern for Tamil Nadu

RANJI TROPHY

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

Tamil Nadu's Ranji Trophy opener against Rajasthan, where it conceded an 89-run first-innings lead, offered both familiar batting concerns and reasons for optimism in the pace department.

Tamil Nadu folded up for 274 in reply to Rajasthan's 363. It needs its established batters to shoulder greater responsibility.

N. Jagadeesan (55) and Pradosh Ranjan Paul (58) batted together for nearly half of the second day, but neither converted his half-century into a substantial score. Jagadeesan, in particular, will rue his dismissal, holing out to long-off off left-arm spinner Kukna Ajay Singh.

Andre Siddarth has been a source of encouragement for Tamil Nadu across three consecutive seasons.

Known for his positive intent, the 20-year-old has shown he can play both counter-attacking and attritional innings, as his 192-ball 81 demonstrated. With a First Class average of 54.45, he has made a compelling case for consideration higher up the order.

Andre.
FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

The lower-order's lack of application, as pointed out by skipper Sai Kishore, has been a recurring problem in recent seasons

The side lost its last five wickets for 10 runs.

The lower-order's lack of application, as pointed out by skipper Sai Kishore, has been a recurring problem in recent seasons.

Mumbai, for instance, has benefited from the batting depth provided by Shams Mulani, Tanush Kotian, Shardul Thakur, and even Tushar Deshpande. Tamil Nadu needs similar contributions from its lower-order. Instead, Washington Sundar was left stranded as wickets fell at the other end.

On an initially placid surface, Saravana Kumar and D. Deepesh were workhorse-like.

The 37-year-old Saravana Kumar, playing only his third Ranji match, claimed three of the four wickets on the opening day and finished with figures of three for 68 in the first essay. He removed two well-set batters, Sumit Godara (49) and Rohan Rajbar (95), breaking both of Rajasthan's century partnerships.

Wicketless for 18.5 overs, debutant Deepesh persisted with the short ball and claimed three wickets in his next eight deliveries (three for 89), triggering a collapse.

His pace and bounce are valuable assets, while Gurjapneet Singh's return should make the pace attack more potent.

Treesa-Gayatri in last eight, Srikanth and Ashmita exit

Press Trust of India
ODENSE (DENMARK)

The Indian women's doubles pair of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand entered the quarterfinals of the Denmark Open Super 750 badminton tournament with a 21-16, 21-17 win over Indonesia's Rachel Allessya and Rose Febi Setianingrum on Thursday.

K. Srikanth went down to World champion Alex Lanier 11-21, 21-15, 21-15 in the pre-quarterfinal while Ashmita Chaliha lost to Japan's Akane Yamaguchi 18-21, 10-21.

AROUND THE CITY

TN escapes with a draw against Saurashtra

NATHAM: Tamil Nadu drew with Saurashtra in their Col. C.K. Nayudu Trophy (u-23) match at NPR College ground on Thursday. Chasing a target of 295, Tamil Nadu, which had taken the first-innings lead, was 45 for seven in its second essay when play was called off due to bad light after the eighth mandatory over.

Harvansh (Saurashtra, 192).

Earlier, Saurashtra, resuming at 165 for two, declared at 397 for five, with overnight batter Harvansh Singh compiling a patient 192 (289b, 13x4, 10x6).

The scores:

Saurashtra 201 in 85.3 overs & 397/5 decl. in 101.3 overs (Harvansh Singh 192, Raxit Mehta 54, Ansh Gosai 61, Devansh Garaiya 57 n.o.) drew with TN 340 in 105.3 overs & 45/7 in 32 overs (Maurya Ghoghari 4/11).

State para swimming on Sunday

CHENNAI: The 12th senior State para swimming championships will be held at the T.R. Paarivendhar Aquatic Complex, SRM Institute of Science and Technology (SRMIST), Kattankulathur, on October 18. Those born on or before 2008 are eligible. For details, contact 80723 68367/96433 36485.

PSG eases past Man City; Real rallies to beat Roma

CHAMPIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
MANCHESTER

Reigning champion Paris Saint-Germain romped to a 4-2 victory against an embattled Manchester City in the Champions League on Wednesday while Bradley Barcola scored his first Liverpool goals with a hat-trick in a 6-3 win over LASK in Linz.

Elsewhere on a prolific night of European action, Real Madrid came from 1-3 down to beat Roma 4-3 and Aston Villa demolished Fenerbahce 6-0.

There was a dramatic denouement in Italy, where a Marten de Roon goal and a Donyell Malen brace had Roma 3-1 up against Real. However, the visitors, who had seen Kylian Mbappe score on his 100th Champions League appearance, produced an incredible late fightback.

Artist at work: Dembele nods home PSG's second. GETTY IMAGES

Carlos Espi pulled one back and Brazil forward Endrick equalised before Antonio Rudiger grabbed a last-minute winner for Jose Mourinho's men.

The results: Feyenoord 3 (Zechiel 20, Hadj Moussa 52, Sanchez 81-og) bt Como 2 (Diao 18, Douvikas 90+3); LASK 3 (Ljubicic 63, Flecker 74, 77) lost to Liverpool 6 (Araujo 22, Barcola 24, 37, 66, Frimpong 51, Koumas 72); Aston Villa 6 (Manzambi 12, Jackson 31, 39, Barkley 68-pen, 72, Abraham 90) bt Fenerbahce 0; Bodo/Glimt 1 (Sjovold 52) bt Borussia Dortmund 0; Manchester City 2 (Haaland 53, 75) lost to Paris Saint-Germain 4 (Doue 13, Dembele 15, Vitinha 32, Aklioucheh 63). Real Betis 3 (Ezzalzouli 47, Hernandez 74, Isco 84-pen) bt Porto 2 (Veiga 55, Samu 61); Roma 3 (De Roon 20, Malen 51, 57) lost to Real Madrid 4 (Mbappe 25, Espi 82, Endrick 85, Rudiger 90); Shakhtar Donetsk 3 (Pedrinho 34-pen, Vinicius Tobias 80, Mendoza 86) bt AEK Athens 1 (Majer 28); Slovan Bratislava 0 lost to Stuttgart 3 (Undav 29, Cruz 65-og, Demirovic 90).

Ministry reviews Asian Games show, demands results and future-proofing

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

The one-day conclave to review India's performance at the recent Asian Games and seek accountability was held here on Thursday.

While the ministry sources insisted that there were no fireworks, the national sports federations were made clear that there was no excuse for below-par performances, and that the NSFs need to deliver results.

Building bench strength: Mandaviya wants India to stop relying on a few proven performers. FILE PHOTO

The day-long review meeting saw NSFs making presentations, analysing their respective performances and providing insights into future planning. The meet was also chaired by Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya and attended by Indian Olympic Association president P.T. Usha, sports secretary Hari Ranjan Rao, Target Olympic Podium Scheme (TOPS) CEO N.S. Johal.

Calling on NSFs to take more responsibility for India's sporting show, Mandaviya reiterated the need to work with further synergy and stressed on the fact that India needs to stop relying on a handful of proven champions.

"How long will Mirabai Chanu alone keep winning medals for us? We need to produce 10 more Mirabai Chanus.

"Every federation must take this responsibility seriously. We have to identify talent, provide the right training and create an environment in which athletes can progress to the highest level," he said.

The review not only addressed the issue of injured athletes travelling to Aichi-Nagoya – raised by Usha – but also tried to assess preparations for major upcoming events, including the 2028 Olympics, Commonwealth Games and Asian Games in 2030. Shooting, athletics, boxing, archery and squash were represented, among others.

The Sports Minister also emphasised the need for more tertiary sports experts including psychologists and mental trainers and urged NSFs to conduct more competitions and assess gaps in performance and administration.

"The minister was very clear that there is no dearth of resources and that NSFs can no longer complain about financial support.

"They have to deliver on the ground, not just make presentations," a ministry official said.

IndianOil
CIN : L23201MH1959GOI011388

Business Development, New Delhi

Date Corrigendum

Hiring of Contractor for Laying of PE Pipeline Network, LMC & DMA Works for PNG Connections in Coimbatore GA

CPP Portal ID: 2026_IOCL_852845_1

With reference to the Tender published on 02.10.2026, the cut-off date of 15.10.2026 is hereby extended to 22.10.2026. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

CENTRE FOR MATERIALS FOR ELECTRONICS TECHNOLOGY (C-MET)
(Scientific Society, Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology, MeitY, Govt. of India)
Panchawati, Off. Dr. Homi Bhabha Road, Pashan, Pune-411 008, INDIA
TENDER NOTICE

Advt. No. PN/ADM/TEN/002/2026

Sealed Tenders are invited under Two Bid System (Part I-TECHNO-COMMERCIAL BID & Part II - FINANCIAL BID) from reputed Indian Manufacturers / Indian Agent of Foreign Equipment Manufacturer for the "Supply, Installation, Demonstration and Training" of the following Scientific Instrument. Prospective bidders are requested to submit separate bid in sealed envelope according to Tender Reference Number.

Tender Reference No.	Brief Description of Stores	E.M.D. (Either in Rs. or US $)		Cost of Tender Fee (Either in Rs. or US $)	
		In Rs.	In US $	In Rs.	In US $
PN/ADM/PUR/035/2025	Green Tape Stacker	8,70,000.00	9,112.00	2,000.00	21.00
PN/ADM/PUR/038/2025	Gas Sorption Analyzer (Gravimetric)	4,50,000.00	4,713.00	2,000.00	21.00
PN/ADM/PUR/043/2025	Microwave Synthesizer	2,25,000.00	2,357.00	2,000.00	21.00
PN/ADM/PUR/007/2026	HR-XRD System	13,50,000.00	14,139.00	2,000.00	21.00

Last Date of Issue of Tender Document : 30.11.2026
Last Date for Submission of Tenders : 01.12.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.
Date of Opening of Technical Bids of Tender : 01.12.2026 at 15.00 Hrs.

For details, please visit our website http://www.cmet.gov.in. The Tender document can be obtained either from the In-Charge Administration, C-MET, Pune on payment of requisite tender fee by Demand Draft drawn in favour of 'Centre for Materials for Electronics Technology, Pune' OR may be downloaded from our website. In this regard, tender document fees to be deposited in the form of Demand Draft at the time of submitting technical bid. Tenders submitted as per the terms & conditions mentioned in the Tender Document only will be accepted. C-MET will not be responsible for postal or any other delay and reserves the right to reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reasons.

(Sd/-) **In-Charge Administration.**

Government of Rajasthan
Commissionerate of Horticulture
Pant Krishi Bhawan, Janpath, Jaipur-302005
Email: jdh.ext.hort@rajasthan.gov.in
Phone No. 0141-2227606, 9414213718, 9414257584

No.: F 5(12) CH/ PDMC-MI/ Auto-Fert-Bid/ 2026-27/151 Date: 30.09.2026

Notice Inviting Bid

The Commissioner, Horticulture, Commissionerate of Horticulture invites e-bids from eligible bidders for **Rate contract for implementation of automation & fertigation programme on farmers field in the state of Rajasthan. Estimated cost for the procurement is rupees 1875.00 lakh only.** Detailed bid document, can be downloaded from the State E-Procurement portal www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in or from the state procurement portal www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in or from department website www.agriculture.rajasthan.gov.in from 30.09.2026 at 6.00 PM and the bids can be submitted online up to 21.10.2026 by 2.30 PM.

DIPR/C/17683/2026 **Commissioner Horticulture**

INDIAN RAILWAY FINANCE CORPORATION
Future on Track

Propelling Progress. Creating Value.

Extract of Statement of Unaudited Financial Results for Quarter & Half Year Ended on 30th September, 2026
(Pursuant to Regulation 47 of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015)

HIGHLIGHTS - H1

TOTAL REVENUE	PROFIT AFTER TAX (PAT)	NET WORTH	EPS	INTERIM DIVIDEND
₹ 16,127.52 Crore	₹ 3,885.69 Crore	₹ 60,573.35 Crore	₹ 2.97 Per Share	₹ 1.15 Per Share

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INDIAN RAILWAY FINANCE CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Navratna CPSE under Ministry of Railways)
CIN: L65910DL19860GOI026363
Regd. Office: UG Floor, East Tower, NBCC Place, Bhisham Pitamah Marg, Pragati Vihar, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003
Phone: 011-24361480, Email: investors@irfc.co.in, Website: https://irfc.co.in/

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Note: Shareholders are requested to update their KYC, Bank mandates, Nominee & contact information and to claim their unpaid / unclaimed dividend, If any by writing to company at its Registered Office or email at investors@irfc.co.in or to RTA of the company at irfcinvestors@beetalmail.com. Dividends if not encashed for a consecutive period of seven (7) years lying with the Companies unpaid dividend accounts, are liable to be transferred to the Investor Education and Protection Fund ("IEPF") along with the shares in respect of such unclaimed dividends.

Scan the QR code to view full results

By order of the Board
Sd/-
(Manoj Kumar Dubey)
CMD & CEO
DIN : 07518387
Date : 15-10-2026
Place : New Delhi

TAMIL NADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED
Kagithapuram – 639 136. Karur Dist. Tamil Nadu

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

TNPL invites Tender for the following:

Tender No	Material Description	Due Date
262713 004420	Steaming (Non-Coking) Coal in Bulk (Imported) with 4200 GAR of Indonesian origin.	26.10.26

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPL Website and NIC Portal only. For further details, Please visit websites: **www.tnpl.com/ https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**

DIPR/ 3159 /Tender/2026

TAMIL NADU NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY
(A University established by Tamil Nadu Act No.9 of 2012)
Navalurkuttappattu, Dindigul Main Road, Tiruchirappalli – 620 027,
Tamil Nadu, India. Phone Off: 0431-2692102;
E-mail: noscsc@tnnlu.ac.in ; Website: www.tnnlu.ac.in

INVITATION OF APPLICATIONS / NOMINATIONS FOR THE POST OF VICE CHANCELLOR

The Search cum Selection Committee constituted under the Tamil Nadu National Law University Act, 2012 invites applications/ nominations from eminent academicians in the field of Law for appointment to the post of **Vice Chancellor**. The last date for submission of application/ nomination is **16.11.2026**. For details, please see **tnnlu.ac.in**

Date: 16.10.2026
DIPR/897/DIS/2026

Search cum Selection Committee

Government of Odisha
Department of Steel & Mines

ADVERTISEMENT FOR APPOINTMENT OF FUNCTIONAL DIRECTORS IN ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED.

Date: 14/10/2026

OMC, a Gold category and largest State PSU in Mining Sector in the Country, undertakes exploration, mining and trading of iron, chrome, bauxite, manganese & limestone ores. The Corporation has achieved an annual turnover of Rs.25,270 Crore in the FY 2025-26. Inspired by the vision to be one of the most admired and largest mining companies in India, OMC has utmost focus on sustainability, mineral resource augmentation and cutting-edge technology.

The Public Enterprises Selection Board (PESB) is seeking qualified and experienced candidates for the following posts of Functional Directors for Odisha Mining Corporation Limited (OMCL) in its Corporate Office located at Bhubaneswar in the Scale of Pay of Rs.1,35,100-2,16,800/- & applicable DA. The post carries HRA, Medical Allowance, Perks, etc. at par with an Officer of OMC in CGM in E-8 rank. Pay Protection will be allowed to the selected candidates from the Central or State Governments/CPSEs/ State PSUs or any other government organizations.

Sl. No.	Name of the Post	No. of Post to be filled up	Qualification
1	Director (Operations)	01	Full time B.E/ B.Tech. Degree in Mining Engineering (obtained through regular mode only) with 1st Class Mines Manager's Certificate of Competency with good academic record from a recognized University/ Institution.
2	Director (Human Resources)	01	Full-time Master in Business Administration / P.G. Diploma in Management with specialization in Human Resources or Full-time Post Graduation in Personnel Management & Industrial Relations with good academic record from a recognized University/Institution.
3	Director (Finance)	01	CA / ICWA or Full-time Degree of Master in Business Administration (MBA) /Post Graduate Diploma in Management with specialization in Finance with good academic record from a recognized University/ Institution.

Detailed requirement for the above positions along with the application formats are available in Steel & Mines Department, Government of Odisha website **https://steelmines.odisha.gov.in** and Directorate of Mines & Geology, Odisha website **https://www.odishaminerals.gov.in** as well as in the website of OMC Ltd. **https://omcltd.in** The following notifications may be referred to :

- Notification No. 10248/SM dated 14.10.2026 for the post of Director (Operations)
- Notification No. 10249/SM dated 14.10.2026 for the post of Director (Human Resources)
- Notification No. 10250/SM dated 14.10.2026 for the post of Director (Finance)

Complete application in the prescribed format with enclosures and a passport size photograph should be sent to the Special Secretary (FE) to Government in Steel & Mines Department, Odisha, Bhubaneswar-751001 by Speed post/Registered Post/e-mail (e-mail id : **dsmsec.or@od.gov.in**) only to reach by **Dt.30.11.2026**. Envelope containing the application should be superscribed as **"Application for the post of Director (Operations), OMCL" / "Application for the post of Director (Human Resources), OMCL" / "Application for the post of Director (Finance), OMCL".** Outstation candidates appearing the interview will be provided Economy Class Air fare for to & fro journey on submission of original documents.

Sd/- Addl. Chief Secretary to Government,
Steel & Mines Department, Lok Seva Bhawan,
Bhubaneswar-751001, Email - dsmsec.or@od.gov.in

30001/128/2627 OIPR-30001/30005/1/26-27/0098

aries

Aryabhatta Research Institute Of Observational Sciences (ARIES), Manora Peak, Nainital, Uttarakhand – 263001

Admission to the ARIES PhD Program for the January 2027 academic session. PhD degree will be awarded by AcSIR. Online application closes: 31 October 2026

For further details, visit:

https://aries.res.in/opportunities/phd-program

Registrar

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER,
KANUPUR IRRIGATION PROJECT
AT/PO-BASUDEVPUR, DIST-KEONJHAR, ODISHA, PIN-758047
e-mail: ccekipbpur@gmail.com

"e"- PROCUREMENT NOTICE - Bid Identification No.: CCE, KIP (KCD-II)-14/2026-27

(Pertaining to Kanpur Canal Division-II, Rimuli)

1.	Name of the Work	As per Detail Tender Call Notice
2.	Total No. of Package	03 (Three) Nos. of individual Work
3.	Estimated Cost	349.57 Lakh to 493.97 Lakh
4.	Period of completion	As per Detail Tender Call Notice
5.	Class of Contractor	"A" Class
6.	Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal	Dt.16.10.2026 from 10.00 Hours to Dt.30.10.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
7.	Last date / Time for receipt of bids in the portal	30.10.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
8.	Date & Time of Opening of Tender (Technical Bid)	31.10.2026 at 11.00 Hours
9.	Name and address of the Officer Inviting Bid	Er. Mahendra Kumar Behera Chief Construction Engineer, Kanupur Irrigation Project, At/Po.- Basudevpur, Dist.- Keonjhar, Odisha - 758047.

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal **"https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in"**

(Er.Mahendra Kumar Behera)
Chief Construction Engineer,
Kanupur Irrigation Project, Basudevpur, Keonjhar, Odisha

32001/1063/2627 OIPR-32001/32376/1/26-27/0010

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, PODAGADA DAM DIVISION
AT/PO-KHATIGUDA, DIST-NABARANGPUR, PIN-764085.
Email I.D - eepodagadadam@gmail.com

PAPER PUBLICATION NOTICE

e-Tender Call Notice No.: EEPDD-05(01)/2026-27, Date : 13.10.2026

Bid Documents consisting of work, Estimated Cost of bid document, time of completion, Class of Contractors and the set of terms and conditions of contract and other necessary documents can be seen in Govt. Website i.e.**www.tendersodisha.gov.in** .

1.	Name of the Work	:	Service Providers
2.	No. of Works	:	01(One) Number
3.	Estimated Cost	:	Rs.1,10,66,697/- (Excluding GST)
4.	Eligibility of the bidders	:	Registered & licensed security service agencies as per Detail Tender Call Notice.
5.	Period of completion	:	212 (Two Hundred Twelve) Days
6.	Date of Clarification	:	21.10.2026 to 31.10.2026 Only During Office Hour.
7.	Time for receipt of bid in the portal	:	From 21.10.2026 (11.00 AM) to 04.11.2026 (up to 5:00 P.M)
8.	Date & place of Opening of the bids On-line	:	05.11.2026 (11:00 A.M) O/o The Executive Engineer, Podagada Dam Division, At/Po: Khatiguda, District: Nabarangpur, Pin- 764085, Odisha
9.	Name and address of the Tender Inviting Authority (TIA)	:	Executive Engineer, Podagada Dam Division, At/Po: Khatiguda, District: Nabarangpur, Pin- 764085, Odisha

Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal **http://tendersodisha.gov.in**

Executive Engineer, Podagada Dam Division, Khatiguda

32001/1060/2627 OIPR-32001/32095/1/26-27/0007

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, गोरखपुर
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Gorakhpur
(स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय भारत सरकार द्वारा स्थापित एक स्वायत्त निकाय)
(An autonomous organization under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India)

Last date of online Receipt of Application: 14/11/2026 **Dated:15/10/2026**

FACULTY APPOINTMENTS

Professor/Additional Professor/Associate Professor/Assistant Professor

Offline applications from eligible Indian citizens/other citizens as permissible under the applicable Act/ Rules are invited to fill up following faculty posts in All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Gorakhpur (Uttar Pradesh):

Sr. No.	Subject	Professor	Additional Professor	Associate Professor	Assistant Professor
1.	Anaesthesia	01 (OBC)	-	-	-
2.	Biochemistry	01 (ST)	-	-	-
3.	Cardiology	01 (UR)	-	-	-
4.	Cardiothoracic Surgery	-	-	01 (UR)	01 (SC)
5.	Dermatology	-	01 (OBC)	-	-
6.	ENT	01 (SC)	01 (SC)	01 (ST)	-
7.	Gastroenterology (Medical)	01 (EWS)	-	01 (OBC)	01 (OBC)
8.	General Medicine	01 (UR)	-	01 (UR)	04 (03- EWS, 01- OBC)
9.	Hospital Administration	01 (UR)	-	01 (OBC)	-
10.	Medical Oncology	-	-	-	01 (OBC)
11.	Microbiology	01 (ST)	-	-	-
12.	Neonatology	-	-	-	01 (ST)
13.	Nephrology	-	-	02 (01-SC, 01-EWS)	-
14.	Neurology	-	-	02 (01-OBC, 01-UR)	01 (SC)
15.	Neurosurgery	-	-	01 (ST)	-
16.	Nuclear Medicine	01 (OBC)	01 (OBC)	01 (UR)	01 (OBC)
17.	Ophthalmology	01 (EWS)	-	-	-
18.	Pathology	01 (SC)	01 (SC)	-	-
19.	Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation	01 (UR)	-	-	-
20.	Psychiatry	01 (OBC)	-	-	-
21.	Pulmonary Medicine	-	-	01 (SC)	-
22.	Radiology	-	01 (OBC)	02 (01-UR, 01-OBC)	04 (02-OBC, 01-SC, 01-ST)
23.	Radiotherapy	01 (SC)	-	-	-
24.	Surgical Gastroenterology	-	-	02 (01-ST, 01-EWS)	-
25.	Transfusion Medicine and Blood Bank	01 (OBC)	-	-	-
26.	Trauma and Emergency Medicine	-	-	-	03 (01-EWS, 01-SC, 01-ST)
27.	Urology	01 (EWS)	-	02 (01-UR, 01-SC)	-
Total		**16**	**05**	**18**	**17**
Grand Total		**56**			

The above vacancies are provisional and subject to variation. The Executive Director, AIIMS, Gorakhpur reserves the right to change the number of the vacancies including reserved vacancies as per the Govt. of India rules/circulars. **Application form along with department wise details of seats, reservation, terms and conditions etc. of the various posts are available on institute's website www.aiimsgorakhpur.edu.in**

All the applicants are advised to check AIIMS, Gorakhpur website www.aiimsgorakhpur.edu.in on regular basis for any further updates.

SD/-
Executive Director
AIIMS, Gorakhpur

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From ‘go-slow’ to top gear — Hope’s metamorphosis

On this white-ball tour of India, he has clearly been the point of difference between the two teams; questions need to be asked of India’s preparedness. Of their game plans, of what they have discussed behind closed doors, of the routes they have unlocked to block his progress

K.R. DEEPAK

R. Kaushik

We are at Eden Gardens, the theatre of dreams, of hopes and aspirations, of ambition and desire. Except that, on this night, it is all this for India. For West Indies, it was the stuff of nightmare. In a must-win, virtual quarterfinal of the T20 World Cup this March, with the winner guaranteed a shot at England in the last four and the loser destined to take an early flight back wherever, Suryakumar Yadav’s men came through by five wickets in the final over, thanks to a stunning unbeaten 97 by Sanju Samson.

West Indies had posted a competitive 195 for four from their allotment on being put in, riding on a 25-ball 40 by opener Roston Chase, a blazing cameo (27 off 12) by Shimron Hetmyer, and unbeaten 30s by Rovman Powell and Jason Holder, who added 76 in just 35 deliveries. The finish was breathtaking as the power-packed Powell and loose-limbed Holder reeled off five sixes between them. The momentum was with the Caribbeans at the interval - runs on the board in a knockout fixture - but India at home? With 70,000 egging them on? It was an unstoppable force once Samson found his bearings and the rest batted around him.

At the end of the night, as the home fans and the Indians celebrated the fact that the hosts’ title defence was well on track, the West Indian captain fronted up at the mandatory media conference. He had had a laboured stay in the middle - 32 off 33 deliveries, three fours and a six - which meant that in the PowerPlay, despite not losing a wicket, the West Indies mustered only 45 runs.

On the back-foot

The disappointment on the skipper’s face was obvious. A semifinal slot had just slipped away, a shot at an unprecedented third title gone just like that. As he was licking his wounds, Shai Hope looked around at the packed press conference room where a constant buzz, the result of some 100 people packed into a small hall, was omnipresent.

If Hope was looking for familiar faces, he was in for a disappointment. A vast majority of the gathering was from the Indian contingent; there were a few from elsewhere but hardly a journalist from any of the Caribbean islands. One is not sure what Hope made of that, but as the press conference unfolded, he was in for a rude shock.

One question after another flew at the right-handed opener about his ‘approach’. About his strike-rate. About his inability to force the pace. About the fact that he had scored at less than a run a ball, that he hadn’t made the most of the field restrictions. It wasn’t one query. Or two. Or three. There was a sustained and barely concealed accusation - not intentional, certainly - that go-slow Hope had cost his team dearly.

Hope’s countenance went from mildly amused to somewhat unhappy to seriously shocked to downright frustrated at the unforgiving line of questioning. He managed to keep his calm around him, accepted that he could and should have scored at a faster clip, and when the Q & A finally drew to a close, he wore a bewildered look, shaking his head a couple of times as he walked off, accompanied by the media manager and security personnel.

Perhaps, those that asked those questions and those who were present at that press-do have forgotten that night, but it would seem as if Hope hasn’t. And so, he has embarked on a mission to comprehensively silence those who questioned his credentials and his ability that evening.

On this white-ball tour of India, Hope has clearly been the point of difference between the two teams. True, his side went down in the high-scoring One-Day International series 1-2, but the skipper had nothing to do with it, following up a century in game two with an unbeaten 162 in the dead rubber in New Chandigarh when West Indies mounted their highest successful run chase in ODI history.

Rich vein of form

That did nothing to sate Hope’s hunger. He has been an unstoppable force in the ongoing Twenty20 International series, with centuries in both of his team’s victories, in matches two and four respectively, that has left the showdown finely balanced at 2-2 going into Saturday’s decisive contest in Bengaluru. Since landing in India some three weeks back, Hope’s scores have been 12 (14b), 104 (94) and 162 not out (143) in the ODIs, and 52 (37), 102 not out (45), 5 (5) and 102 not out (50) in the four T20Is. Now, if this isn’t a sequence of extraordinary consistency married with electric firepower, nothing else can be.

Hope has eked out these runs without seeking recourse to the crude and the ugly. He has been wonderfully orthodox, using the straight field as his ally against pacers mainly but also against spin, and leaving the cute and the outrageously muscular to others, teammates and opponents alike. He has taken white-ball batsmanship at the top of the order to a lofty, almost unreachable plane, wowing the connoisseurs with his balance and timing and placement while at the same time wooing the new-age watchers more familiar to unfettered ball-bashing with his repeated trysts with the ‘maximum’ without losing shape when easily clearing the ropes.

Over the years, India have been guilty of letting one batter - at least - from the opposition ranks make merry in a series. The list is long and illustrious and includes, in recent times, the likes of Matthew Hayden and Michael Clarke and Ricky Ponting, Sanath Jayasuriya and Hashim Amla and Jacques Kallis, Saeed Anwar and even the likes of Rassie van der Dussen and Jimmy Adams, among others. Hope has comfortably, comprehensively, commandingly gate-crashed that group; after all, he does have more than 500 runs in seven limited-overs international innings, with four centuries - two apiece in each of the formats - and has the chance to add significantly more to add to that tally at the historically batter-friendly Chinnaswamy Stadium strip on Saturday night.

In and by itself, his batting, the volume of those runs and the luminescence with which they have come, has been staggering. Throw in the fact that he is the captain of the side *and* the wicketkeeper who opens the batting in T20Is and is almost right at the top of the order in ODIs, and those deeds are further burnished. If that were possible.

Absolute treat

Watching Hope at work has been an absolute treat. The languid grace that generally naturally comes to a left-hander is an inescapable facet of his time at the middle. There is a certain poetry in motion when he draws his left foot to the pitch of the ball and sends it searing through the covers towards the boundary with minimal effort which takes one’s breath away. When he decides to go aerial down the ground, you can rest assured that the ball is headed in only one direction. Twice in the first two ODIs, he fell to Kuldeep Yadav, trying to take on the wrist-spinner and putting the men inside the circle square and behind square on the off-side in business. Since then, he has hardly put a foot wrong.

Indeed, one can only recall one poor stroke from him in all these outings - the agricultural hoick against Arshdeep Singh in the third T20I in Indore when India defended a target with zeal and gusto. Trying to mow the left-arm pacer bowling from round the stumps with the new ball, Hope lost shape as he showed rare faith in power, the ball sneaking through his slog to hit middle-stump. Arshdeep, the Player-of-the-Match for his three wickets that tilted the balance India’s way, spoke at the end of the game of the specific ‘plans’ the Indians had for all the batters, including for Hope. Perhaps slighted that the Indians would believe they had found a chink in his armour, Hope countered in spectacular fashion in Hyderabad on Wednesday when he joined a small band with three or more T20I centuries.

Until Wednesday, only 13 batters had three hundreds, and only five others - Rohit Sharma and Glenn Maxwell (five each), and Phil Salt, Austria’s Karanbir Singh and Suryakumar (four apiece) - had more T20I three-figure knocks than Hope. Now, he is the latest among the 19 with three or more hundreds, and the odds on him moving level with the trio on four tons in Bengaluru will not be very long. Such has been his focus and his insatiable appetite that there is a touch of the inevitable every time he takes guard - not necessarily a century on each occasion, but definitely a knock of substance. And great style.

Shreyas Iyer and India’s bowlers must be sick and tired of the sight of Hope at the batting crease, but the fans clearly are loving what they are seeing. They have cheered on Hope with gusto, especially in Hyderabad where their ‘local’ heroes – Abhishek Sharma, Ishan Kishan and Nitish Kumar, all of Sunrisers Hyderabad fame - didn’t provide great joy on Wednesday. In recent times, Indian audiences have tended to greet opposition heroics with total and complete silence, unmindful of the beauty of a stunning innings or the artistry of a magical spell of bowling. That Hope has managed to win them over despite putting their own idols under the cosh is a great tribute to the 32-year-old’s presence in the middle and the humility with which he has gone about his job.

That said, questions need to be asked of India’s preparedness. Of their game plans, of what they have discussed behind closed doors, of the routes they have unlocked to block Hope’s progress. Clearly, whatever they have discussed isn’t working. Whether it is a failure of the tactical group - of Shreyas, head coach Gautam Gambhir and his army of support staff - or of the execution bunch - the Arshdeep-led bowling unit - is a moot point. On the whole, as magical as it has been watching Hope at work, balancing the felicity of a maestro with the precision of a surgeon, it reflects poorly on India that despite so much data and first-hand experience, they haven’t been able to find consistent means to nip Hope masterpieces in the bud.

Hope gets a leave of absence from the Test series in Bangladesh starting later this month, which means Saturday is his last international outing in the immediate future.

One final flourish, one last telling statement, to give West Indies a second bilateral series victory over India in three years (they won 3-2 in August 2023) is not in the realms of the fantastic.

THE GIST

- One question after another flew at Hope about his ‘approach’ after the T20 World Cup game. About his strike-rate. About his inability to force the pace. About the fact that he had scored at less than a run a ball, that he hadn’t made the most of the field restrictions
- He has been an unstoppable force in the ongoing Twenty20 International series, with centuries in both of his team’s victories, in matches two and four respectively, that has left the showdown finely balanced at 2-2
- Hope has eked out these runs without seeking recourse to the crude and the ugly. He has been wonderfully orthodox, using the straight field as his ally against pacers mainly but also against spin, and leaving the cute and the outrageously muscular to others

Shifting global focus towards inclusive assessment of threats to health

Launched at the recent World Health Summit in Berlin, a new report has flagged 17 interlinked catastrophic threats including pandemics, antimicrobial resistance, and AI, and has urged global leaders to stop treating these issues in isolation, and start viewing them as deeply interconnected economic, environmental, and national security challenges

On the lookout: Air pollution was listed among the 17 interlinked catastrophic threats that could shape global health through 2100 in a report by a new Lancet Commission. REUTERS

THE GIST

The threats flagged by the report include climate change, air pollution, antimicrobial resistance, childhood malnutrition, conventional conflict, declining development assistance for health, high alcohol use, high blood pressure, income inequality, low educational attainment, naturally occurring pandemics, obesity, poor mental health, smoking, and unhealthy ageing

The Commission analysed hundreds of risks across 204 countries and territories. A threat was classified as "catastrophic" if it could account for at least 1 billion DALYs (healthy years lost to illness, disability, or premature death) by 2100

A key, central argument of the report is that these threats amplify one another. For instance, climate change directly exacerbates childhood malnutrition, air pollution, antimicrobial resistance, and mental health issues

Ramya Kannan

A major new Lancet Commission has listed 17 interlinked catastrophic threats that could shape global health through 2100. Zooming out to take a bird's eye view of the possible threats, the Commissioners have counted amongst them – pandemics, obesity, antimicrobial resistance, nuclear conflict, and artificial intelligence.

Driven by the motive to move away from the intense focus on certain domains, the default mode that health care governance and activism has taken so far, the Commission took upon itself the task of freeing the world from being bogged down with single issues, though the benefits of that have been aplenty, the time had come to go beyond.

Launched at the recent World Health Summit in Berlin, the report urges global leaders to stop treating these issues in isolation, and start viewing them as deeply interconnected economic, environmental, and national security challenges. The Commission, "composed of 37 experts in health, economics, security, and technology, uses a foresight-driven, health-focused approach to identify 17 priority threats to human health." Not a crystal ball gazing exercise, it reportedly assessed threats by calculating the expected cumulative disease burden – measured as amenable disability-adjusted life-years from 2025 to 2100 – that can be reasonably altered through policy intervention. It lists two of these major catastrophic threats: nuclear conflict and malicious use of AI: as having extinction potential. Additional threats include climate change, air pollution, antimicrobial resistance, childhood malnutrition, conventional conflict, declining development assistance for health, high alcohol use, high blood pressure, income inequality, low educational attainment, naturally occurring pandemics, obesity, poor mental health, smoking, and unhealthy ageing.

While the report seeks to identify the threats to human health and survival, and could been seen as doomsdayist, in principle, it is not an apocalyptic forecast of unavoidable doom. The model it uses, as described here earlier, is "amenable" Disability-Adjusted Life Years (DALYs) – meaning it measures how many years of healthy life can still be saved if take decisive policy action is launched today. It predicts that high-income nations will see dominant health losses from non communicable risks such as obesity and poor mental health. On the other hand, low-income regions will bear the brunt of childhood malnutrition and the collapse of international aid.

The Commission analysed hundreds of risks across 204 countries and territories. A threat was classified as "catastrophic" if it could account for at least 1 billion DALYs (healthy years lost to illness, disability, or premature death) by 2100. These 17 threats were then categorised into a pyramid of severity, with extinction potential right on top (nuclear conflict and malicious AI) at Category 1, and then cascading down to Category 2 (major catastrophic threats) and Category 2 (environmental, social and health risks).

Although the likelihood of Category 1 dangers remains low, the report says, the scale of harm, should they be realised, would be apocalyptical. The bulk of the threats come under category 2, and include obesity, which represents the largest single potential health loss identified in the report. Addressing high body mass index (BMI), poor diet, and physical inactivity could prevent a massive 23.1 billion DALYs, the report says.

Similarly, improving global access to education could avert 16.1 billion DALYs, it claims. The income gap between the rich and poor represents an amenable health burden equivalent to 25 COVID-19 pandemics, it avers.

The report flags poor mental health rapidly rising in the higher income countries, as also the pressures on societies from ageing populations without adequate health support systems. While smoking, high blood pressure, antimicrobial resistance, alcohol use, child malnutrition and naturally-occurring pandemics are conventionally connected with health; climate change, conventional conflict and air pollution also find a place in the list. The withdrawal of international aid has been flagged: severe cuts to health aid from wealthy nations could cause 1.5 billion DALYs, with sub-Saharan Africa bearing 70% of this blow.

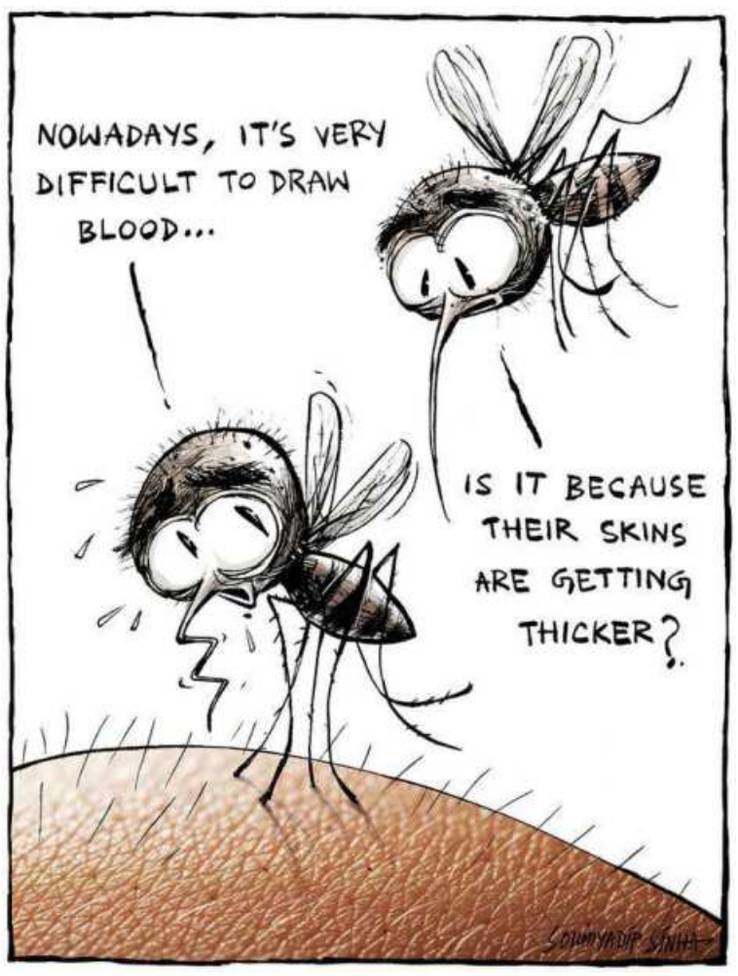
A key, central argument of the report is that these threats amplify one another. For instance, climate change directly exacerbates childhood malnutrition, air pollution, antimicrobial resistance, and mental health issues. Focusing on climate mitigation alone, without strengthening local healthcare infrastructure, again, will fail to stop the downstream health fallout. It also indicates that the estimated 1.89 billion DALYs saved by meeting climate targets is a conservative underestimation, accounting for direct heat and pollution harms. It advises nations to plan for unmodeled "invisible" consequent threats such as mass displacement, geopolitical instability, and drought.

However, the primary criticism against the Commission report is that it skirts acknowledging the current geopolitical crisis, the growing rise of intolerant governments, and the collapse of international collaboration between nations. Even recently, the terse flow of information from Russia where a suspected case of pneumonic plague death was reported highlights the frigidity between nations that prevents seamless global co-operation.

Though it does have a cascade of priorities, in effect the Commission does not attempt to present "a fixed ranking of threats or policy priorities." Instead, it makes it very clear that the analysis is a dynamic process and findings are amenable to change as and when evidence shifts. But the most important contribution that can be attributed to the Commission is how it managed to pivot the global approach to health threats – to move it from attention and focus on individual subjects to move to a larger consideration of all the complex factors impacting human health. Whether the global axis will now swivel on this pivot remains to be seen, given how complex a task this report has laid out for the world.

(ramya.kannan@thehindu.co.in)

HUMERUS



Indians with high socio-economic position are more prone to heart disease than the poor: study

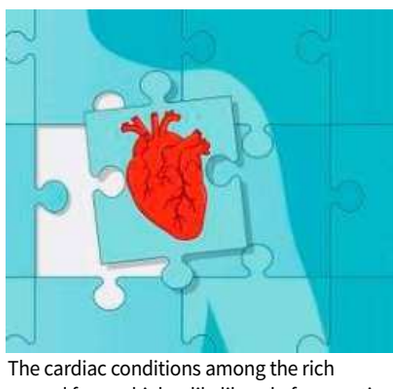
Divya Gandhi

A vast study of 65,364 Indians has revealed that people with a consistently high socio-economic position are more prone to heart disease than the consistently poor.

In fact, those with sustained life-course socioeconomic advantage had nearly twice (1.8 times) the odds of heart failure and 1.7 times the chances of a heart attack than those who experienced sustained socioeconomic disadvantage, found the study, published in the *American Journal of Preventive Medicine*.

The cardiac conditions among the rich in India ranged from a higher likelihood of congestive heart failure, heart attack, abnormal heart rhythm, heart diseases and composite cardiovascular disease.

For the study, scientist from the All India Institute of Medical Sciences, New Delhi and the Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health in Boston, studied Indians aged 45 and older, looking into their childhood too. The study sampled both rural and urban residents, men and women, and several religious and caste groups, and documented information on health, social, and economic indicators.



The cardiac conditions among the rich ranged from a higher likelihood of congestive heart failure, heart diseases and composite cardiovascular disease. GETTY IMAGES

The scientists studied heart health in the context of life-course socio-economic mobility, not just their static status: the categories included consistently high economic positions (in both childhood and adulthood); upward mobility (low economic status in childhood but high in adulthood); downward mobility (high economic status in childhood but low in adulthood); and consistently low economic position in both periods.

The understanding of how life-course social mobility is associated with heart disease and risk factors is crucial in tackling India's health, added the paper.

Several mechanisms may possibly contribute to the malaise, lead author Imnameren Longkumer, Narotam Sekhsaria Fellow at the Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health India Research Center and senior author S.V. Subramanian, professor of population health and geography at Harvard University said.

"Economic advancement can increase access to processed foods, refined carbohydrates, sugary beverages, and energy-dense diets, while occupational and domestic life may become less physically active," they said. This data, however serves as a snapshot of a country that is undergoing an epidemiological transition. As socioeconomic patterns change over time, cardiovascular disease and its risk factors become more widespread among disadvantaged groups as well, said Prof. Subramanian.

Financial impact

Another study published earlier this year in *Global Heart Journal* reflected on the catastrophic financial impact of heart disease among India's poor, who find themselves riddled in debt: the cost of treating heart failure patients with a single hospitalisation averaged ₹1.19 lakh.

Co-author Jeemon P., of the Sree Chitra Tirunal Institute for Medical Sciences and Technology, Thiruvananthapuram, told *The Hindu* that hospitalisation for cardiovascular disease is highly resource-intensive, and for many families, the financial consequences do not end when the patient is discharged. Although social health insurance schemes provide an important degree of financial protection, families may still have to bear a significant proportion of the total cost, said Dr. Jeemon.

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Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of children killed in school roof collapse in Pakistan

34 At least 34 children and a teacher were killed when the roof of a private school collapsed on Thursday in Peshawar, the capital of Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, hospital authorities and police said. The owner, who was operating the institution as an education trust, has been arrested, police said, adding that the roof of the building was poorly constructed. PTI

Increase in Delhi's tax revenue in first half of current year

3.5 in per cent. The Delhi government earned ₹2,030.38 crore in tax revenue in the first half of the current financial year, 3.5 per cent more than the same period last fiscal year, officials said on Thursday. The total tax revenue of the government stood at ₹32,547.70 crore as on October 9 this year, according to the official data. PTI

Unemployment rate among persons aged 15 and above in Sept.

5 in per cent. The overall unemployment rate among persons aged 15 years and above remained stable at 5 per cent in September 2026, a government survey released on Thursday said. According to the Periodic Labour Force Survey, the overall Unemployment Rate (UR) among persons aged 15 years and above remained steady at 5 per cent compared with August 2026. PTI

Barrels released from strategic reserves by Spain in October

4.4 in million. Spain will release 4.4 million barrels from strategic reserves in October, an Energy Ministry official said on Thursday without specifying what products will be released. The release is part of Spain's commitment in March to release oil products equivalent to up to 11.5 million barrels. This is the second release, after an initial release of 3.7 million barrels. REUTERS

Nepal's remittance inflow in the first two months of 2026-27

436.36 in NPR billion. Nepal received NPR 436.36 billion in remittances in the first two months of the current fiscal year, an increase of 23.9 per cent compared to last year. During mid-August to mid-September of 2026-27, remittance inflows stood at NPR 221.31 billion. PTI

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The debate over immunity to CEC, ECs

The SC has issued a notice to the Centre on a plea challenging Section 16 of the 2023 law, which grants CEC and ECs lifelong immunity for actions taken in discharge of official duties; the provision is more expansive than constitutional immunities provided to the President and Governors; as well as Parliamentary privileges granted to legislators

EXPLAINER

Rangarajan R.

The story so far:
The Supreme Court has recently issued notices to the Centre on a petition filed by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) challenging the lifelong immunity granted to the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners (CEC and EC) for actions taken in discharge of official duties.

What is equality before the law?
Equality is a fundamental right and part of basic structure of our Constitution. Article 14 guarantees that the State shall not deny to any person equality before the law or the equal protection of the laws within the territory of India. Equality before law is a component of the concept of 'Rule of Law' propounded by British jurist A.V. Dicey. It means that there will be absence of any special privileges in favour of any person; everyone is subject to same set of laws; and there will be no person above the law, irrespective of their status in the society. Equal protection of the law is an American concept, which implies that there will be equality of treatment under equal circumstances, both in privileges conferred and liabilities imposed by the laws.

What are constitutional immunities?
The Constitution does provide some immunities/privileges to certain offices. Article 361 provides certain immunities to the President and Governors. It states that there shall be no criminal proceedings and no process for arrest or imprisonment of President or Governor during their term of office. Even civil proceedings against President or Governor cannot be initiated except until expiration of 2 months' notice. These privileges were available to Governor General and Governors during the British

Association for Democratic Reforms has challenged the lifelong immunity provision in the SC. FILE PHOTO

rule. They have continued to exist under our Constitution to maintain the dignity of these high offices.

Article 105 and 194 provides the privileges for members of Parliament and State legislatures, which includes freedom of speech and vote. The Constitution also provides that till Parliament enacts a law to codify the privileges, the Houses and members will continue to enjoy the privileges that were enjoyed by the British House of Commons before the commencement of the Constitution. The Parliament has not enacted any law to codify privileges till date.

Diplomats and ambassadors of other nations enjoy immunity from civil and criminal jurisdiction under the Vienna convention. This is an international treaty that is applicable in more than 190 countries on a reciprocal basis.

What immunity do the CEC and ECs have?
The Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Terms of Office) Act, 2023 (CEC & EC Act) passed in December 2023 contains Section 16 that provides that no court shall entertain or continue any civil or criminal proceedings against any current or former CEC or EC for actions taken or purported to be taken in discharge of official duties.

Why should this provision be removed?
The immunity from arrest and criminal proceedings for the President and Governors is a colonial relic that has continued in our Constitution. It must however be noted that this immunity is only during their term of office. While Parliamentary privileges are an exception to equality, they are largely confined to actions inside the Houses of the legislature and to the period when the Houses are in session. Diplomatic immunity is based on functional necessity and reciprocity, in order to facilitate the smooth functioning of diplomatic relations.

The provision granting life-long and unconditional immunity to the CEC or ECs was not part of the original Bill that was introduced in the Parliament. Hence, there is no rationale provided for the inclusion of this clause in the 'Statement of Objects and Reasons' submitted along with the Bill at the time of introduction. This clause was added as an amendment on the day the Bill was passed in Rajya Sabha that was subsequently cleared by Lok Sabha and assented to by the President.

The Union Law Minister, while introducing this amendment had said that it was brought in to enable the CEC and ECs to discharge their functions in an unhindered and independent manner.

Equal protection of the law under Article 14 does provide for creation of separate classifications for the application of laws. However, the classification for equal protection of the laws should not be arbitrary or irrational. It must be based on intelligible and reasonable distinction. Further, the classification must have reasonable relation to the objective or purpose of the legislation.

There are various constitutional and statutory authorities who are required to discharge their functions in an independent manner. It includes judges, Comptroller and Auditor General, Public Service Commission Chairpersons and members, Lokpal and Lokayuktas, and Information Commissioners. None of these authorities enjoy such life-long and unconditional immunity for their official actions. The Election Commission (Conditions of Service of Election Commissioners and Transaction of Business) Act, 1991 which was the earlier law that governed the terms of office of the CEC and ECs did not contain such a provision. In view of these aspects, this provision of blanket immunity under the CEC & EC Act must not remain in the statute books.

(Rangarajan R. is a former IAS officer and author of 'Courseware on Polity Simplified'. He currently trains at Officers IAS Academy. Views expressed are personal.)

THE GIST

- The Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Terms of Office) Act, 2023 contains Section 16 which grants the CEC and ECs lifelong immunity for actions taken in discharge of official duties
- The provision was not part of the original Bill that was introduced in the Parliament. This clause was added as an amendment on the day the Bill was passed in Rajya Sabha, that was subsequently cleared by Lok Sabha and assented to by the President

Advancing the women-led development model

NCW's consultation on women's access to social, economic justice calls for a rethink of women's empowerment

C.B.P. Srivastava

The story so far:
The National Commission for Women (NCW) held a consultation on women's right to property and their access to social and economic justice. The idea is to ensure that inclusive growth becomes sustainable. This is another step towards endorsing the significance of women's empowerment. However, a pertinent question remains: why have women not been empowered so far, and do we really understand the meaning of women's empowerment? Is the concept rooted in economics, or is it a serious issue of internalised patriarchal attitude?

Distributive vs. compensatory justice
Until now, women's empowerment has remained confined to welfare schemes, reservation at different stages and protection against discrimination. This may constitute the delivery of compensatory justice, but it is not sufficient if the country intends to accelerate progress towards the goal of Viksit Bharat@2047. We need to create an environment in which the delivery of distributive justice assumes significance over compensatory justice. Though the Constitution provides for both forms of justice, it gives precedence to distributive justice to prevent the need to compensate. Following this constitutional approach, the concept of empowerment would be transformed from a welfare measure into a matter of right.

As a socialist principle, justice could be delivered through the equitable distribution of resources according to requirements, ensuring equality among equals and access to resources needed for development and growth. This concept is enshrined in the Directive Principles under Articles 38 and 39 of the Constitution, supported by Article 46. These provisions make the state accountable to ensure distribution of resources and prevent concentration of the means of production. The Supreme Court in *Air India Statutory Corporation v. United Labour Union* (1996) held that the Preamble and Articles 38, 39, and 46 aim to establish an egalitarian social order and that distributive justice is a foundational constitutional goal to restructure the economic order. Further, the apex court in *Consumer Education and Research Centre v. Union of India* (1995) emphasised that socio-economic and distributive justice are integral components of the right to life and human dignity under Article 21 of the Constitution.

Compensatory justice, on the other hand, could be seen through different lenses. For instance, Articles 17 and 23 of the Constitution deal with abolition of untouchability and human trafficking, *begar* and forced labour respectively, which are absolute rights to prohibit discriminatory exploitation of certain groups including women and children. In criminal law, statutory compensation for victims is provided under Section 396 of the Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita.

Women's property rights
The right to property is a fundamental human right, along with the rights to life and liberty, hence, it is acquired by all individuals irrespective of gender. Property is not merely an asset; it also strengthens social status, bargaining power and a person's capabilities. This is the reason why the Constitution, through Article 300-A gives the guarantee that no person shall be deprived of his property except by the authority of law. This provision is available to both men and women equally. The idea is to ensure substantive equality leading to gender justice. The Hindu Succession Act, 1956, and particularly its 2005 amendment, gave daughters equal coparcenary rights in Hindu joint family property. Endorsing this concept the Supreme Court in *Vineeta Sharma v. Rakesh Sharma* (2020) made it clear that a daughter is a coparcener by birth and that her right does not depend upon whether the father was alive when the amendment came into force.

On the other hand, the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955 and Special Marriage Act, 1954 in addition to the laws relating to maintenance, and inheritance have progressively strengthened women's legal position regarding their right to property.

However, despite these safeguards, women are not yet considered claimants to such rights, and the gulf between requirements and reality remains wide. The patriarchal mindset is the biggest culprit. Other factors include a social fabric not conducive for women in terms of rights, inadequate legal awareness among women and their limited access to justice. In this backdrop, it would be more appropriate to strengthen institutional mechanism necessary to effectively implement the existing policies and laws.

Concept of women-led development
To establish substantive equality, a paradigm shift is needed from viewing women as passive beneficiaries of welfare schemes to recognising them as drivers of social and cultural transformation. Property and inheritance records should be made gender sensitive, through digitisation of land records, simplified mutation procedures and automatic recording of women's shares, reducing dependence on intermediaries. Legal literacy among women must also improve through special campaigns involving Self-Help Groups, while effective access to free legal aid would enhance their legal awareness. Finally, women who have excelled in any field should be given leadership roles to demonstrate that they can lead institutions as effectively as their male counterparts. Thus, a shift from women-based to women-led development is not only necessary but should become the new paradigm.

(C.B.P. Srivastava is president, Centre for Applied Research in Governance, Delhi)

IN THE LIMELIGHT

The world of *Aaranya Kaandam* was packed with eccentric characters discussing pop culture, dark humour, sudden violence and narrative detours. FILE PHOTO

How Kumararaja changed the grammar of Tamil cinema

Kumararaja's films are gritty but playful, referential but rooted, violent but funny, pulpy but formally ambitious, entertaining and prompting introspection through their plots; his film *Aaranya Kaandam* won a National Award, but its more enduring legacy was the filmmakers it inspired

Sudhish Kamath

In 16 years, Thiagarajan Kumararaja has made just two films and one show for Prime Video. Yet few filmmakers have had a larger influence on the generation that followed him.

Watching Arun Matheswaran's *DC* and Karthik Subbaraj's *Dorothy* more recently, I was fascinated by the evolution of Tamil neo-noir and the influence Kumararaja has had over modern filmmakers for the last decade and a half.

When *Aaranya Kaandam* arrived in 2011, it seemed to have wandered in from another Tamil cinema. A gangster film with parallel tracks, no conventional hero, romance or even a moral centre, the world of *Aaranya Kaandam* was packed with eccentric characters discussing pop culture, dark humour, sudden violence and narrative detours. Kumararaja could cut from brutality to a retro song and somehow make the two belong together. The film won a National Award, but its more enduring legacy was the filmmakers who saw what it was doing.

Here's what's unique about his storytelling.

Straight into the plot

I remember asking him during an interview about his storytelling style, given that his plots always kick in during the very first scene – the first scene is his inciting incident, and characters are best discovered through what they do rather than who they are. When many Tamil films back in the day would start right before the interval with a line about how the real movie starts now, he would wonder, "What were you doing till now?"

Kumararaja's own cinematic diet included everything from Visu to Andrei Tarkovsky, and from Quentin Tarantino to

Thiagarajan Kumararaja. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Lars von Trier and Pedro Almodóvar. Drawing on these eclectic influences, he figured out an organic way to infuse the Tamil cinema he grew up watching, with neo-noir elements and existentialism. His films are gritty but playful, referential but rooted, violent but funny, and pulpy but formally ambitious. He entertains and provokes through his choice of plot.

Making it bizarre

Let the audience know right at the start that bizarre stuff will happen. What happens when a gangster goes limp? *Aaranya Kaandam*.

What happens when a man randomly dies halfway during sex with his secret lover? *Super Deluxe*, a film that kept foreshadowing the sci-fi twist all through. Even the *Modern Love* story he directed was supposed to be based on a true story. But reality doesn't excite him as much as how to make it bizarre. He asked himself: "How would Charlie Kauffman do it?" Today filmmakers wonder: "How would Kumararaja do it."

Embracing myth-making

Multiple storylines, different timelines, unpredictable character behaviour, drama and comedy, tears and laughs, opposite ideologies – dark and light, science and spirituality, karma and dharma, the gender politics between the masculine and feminine – all blend seamlessly into his craft. After all, he started as a dialogue writer for Pushkar and Gayatri with *Orum Po*, a skill he uses to stay in control of mood and meaning, a freedom that lets him tell only the interesting parts of the story, in the structure that best helps him play out the drama and the larger learning in the film. In books, they would make for separate chapters. But in the Kumararaja Universe, they are all next door. He plants Easter eggs and connections to make the "everything is connected" experience more fun for fans.

Cool retro music

Kumararaja's retro needle drops may have been inspired by Quentin Tarantino. Like Tarantino, Kumararaja has an ear for music – something catchy but forgotten, used in a new light. His script Summer Holiday for our collaborative experiment, *X - Past is Present* specified the song playing on the radio, what time it would get interrupted by a power cut and which part of *Aasaiya kaathula thoothu vittu* would play during the big reveal. The song lyrics are a part of the film's narrative. If Quentin finally convinced Ennio Morricone to compose for him, Kumararaja has Ilaiyaraja by his side, composing original music.

Playing with the form

It's not happening because it happens in real life. It's happening because these things happen in stories. And Kumararaja reminds you that it's all a story all the time –from the stylised interior design, the way the camera moves – sometimes pausing halfway into a voiceover as in *Aaranya Kaandam*, the meticulously planned needle drops, the referential scores – like the *nadaswaram* version of the Star Wars theme 'Flight of the Ex' (also to foreshadow the sci-fi twist most recently recycled by Karthik Subbaraj in *Dorothy*) or the passionate relationship people in his movies have with their movies. In *Aaranya Kaandam*, we learn that necessity is morality. The big message in *Super Deluxe* is that there is no message.

By 2026, the lineage has become almost literal as Arun Matheswaran directs Lokesh Kanagaraj himself as the romantic action hero of *DC*. One generation's filmmaker became the next generation's star.

The journey from *Aaranya Kaandam* in 2010 to *DC* in 2026 is therefore not simply a story about filmmakers influenced by Kumararaja. It is about how a set of once-unusual ideas – neo-noir, fragmented storytelling, tonal collisions, referentiality, dark humour and the romanticisation of violence through style – migrated from the margins into the mainstream.

Let's not forget the influence he has also had over collaborators. Post *Aaranya Kaandam*, Kumararaja worked as a writer with 11 filmmakers on my film *X-Past is Present*, four writers on *Super Deluxe* and four more directors on *Modern Love*.

Kumararaja may have made only two and a half films. But somewhere along the way, he helped give Tamil cinema a new language.

And three generations are still speaking it. True to his philosophy, Kumararaja himself doesn't think it's all that true. Everything is random. "You are giving me too much credit," he laughs.

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

"...and the funny thing is Sujatha told me that since it was my fault I should pay for the damage. I got really angry and told her that I wasn't going to pay. Did I do the right thing? What do you think?"

"What?"

"Did I do the right thing or not? I mean, do ..."

"...I am sorry. Could you run that by me again? I wasn't really...."

"...run? Run what? What are you talking about?"

"When you ask someone to 'run something by you again' what you want him to do is to repeat what he said."

"Really? So, if you say something and I am not paying any attention, can I say, 'I am sorry. Could you run that by me again'?"

"Yeah, I guess you could. When somebody gives you their telephone number or their address and you don't get it the first time, you can say, 'Could you run that by me again?'"

"In other words, it's a way of saying, could you please repeat what you said."

"Yes, that's right."

"Could you run that by me again? Seems a mouthful. I'd rather say, 'Please repeat it'. Much simpler."

"You have a point there."

"Have you seen the movie running in Sangeet?"

"You mean the horror film? Of course not! You know that horror movies just turn my stomach."

"Horror movies turn your stomach? In which direction?"

"Ha! Ha! Very funny! When you say that something turns your stomach, it means that it makes you sick. It disgusts or nauseates you."

"I see. The thing makes you feel so terrible that you feel like vomiting."

"That's right. For example, when I saw the boy lying there in a pool of blood, it turned my stomach."

"Gopa hadn't cleaned his apartment for several weeks. The moment I entered, the stench turned my stomach. How does that sound?"

"Sounds great."

"How about this one? The hypocrisy of our so-called leaders turns my stomach."

"Please, let's not talk about politicians. You need to have a strong stomach to talk about them so early in the morning."

"Have a strong stomach! Does that mean to see horrible things and not get upset or sick..."

"... that's right. Someone who has a strong stomach has the ability to do or see things that are unpleasant without feeling upset or sick."

"People working in slaughter houses must have strong stomachs."

"I don't think I can stomach any more of this. I am leaving."

"Leaving? But where?"

"I am having breakfast with Vyomakesh at the new Udupi restaurant."

"You two must have a cast iron stomach."

"Stomach again? What does cast iron stomach mean?"

"Well, when you say that someone has a cast iron stomach, it means he/she can eat anything and digest it."

"Sounds like my cousin Karthick. He can eat anything and digest it. Including his sister's cooking. I am sure he has a cast iron stomach."

Published in The Hindu on April 16, 2002

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

Some significant events occurred on October 15. Here is a quiz on observances, birthdays and everything else that happened on the day

K. Abhinaya

QUESTION 1

A revolutionary party was founded on this day in 1966 by Huey P. Newton and Bobby Seale. It was known for challenging police brutality among other things. Identify the party and where it was founded.

QUESTION 2

The final conference for a treaty to keep this continent free for scientific study was held on this day in 1959. Chile was one of the signatories. Is the statement true and name the treaty?

QUESTION 3

On this day, China became the third country to send a manned spaceflight. Identify the astronaut who was on the spaceflight.

QUESTION 4

A 1987 coup in this West African country led to the death of a far-left leader and President. The coup was led by his former friend and close ally. Name the country.

QUESTION 5

A symbol of bare-knuckle boxing, this boxer was one of the most popular heavyweight champions of his era. He was born on October 15, 1858. Name him.

Visual question: This popular American show, which premiered on this day in 1951, went on to become a very popular show and bagged five Emmy awards. Name the actors who played the starring roles. THE HINDU ARCHIVES

Questions and answers to the previous daily quiz: 1. 'Pooh' was inspired by this. **Ans: From a swan that Christopher Robin and his father encountered during their walks in the countryside**
2. The landscape that inspired the setting of his loved stories. **Ans: Ashdown Forest in East Sussex**
3. This name is painted over the door of Winnie-the-Pooh's house. **Ans: Mr. Sanders**
4. Location of the original stuffed animals that inspired Milne's stories and the character which was added by Queen Camilla in 2026. **Ans: New York Public Library and Roo**
5. The nook close to Piglet's home. **Ans: Thoughtful Spot**
6. Name the other two books book featuring the loveable bear and his friends and the hyperactive character debuted in the final work. **Ans: 'Now We Are Six', 'The House at Pooh Corner' and Tigger**
7. Ernest Howard Shepard's role in the Winnie-the-Pooh books. **Ans: He brought the characters to life with his illustrations**
8. This actor played the role of an adult Christopher Robin in the eponymous 2018 film. **Ans: Ewan McGregor**
Visual: The setting for this illustration from one of the original works. **Ans: Poohsticks**
Early birds: Tamal Biswas| Piyali Tuli| Sunil Madhavan| Aryan Wari| Dodo Jayaditya

Word of the day

Exonerate:
to free someone from accusation or blame

Synonyms: acquit, discharge, exculpate

Usage: *The new evidence helped exonerate the accused.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/exonerate

International Phonetic Alphabet: /ɪgˈzɒnəɹeɪt/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'